

Independent Medicare & ACA Agents — Deep Buyer Research

Health Insurance Ecosystem · the independent Medicare, ACA and health insurance agent or broker who buys leads · Researched 2026-09-25 · refresh due 2027-03-25 · Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/health-insurance-agents/research/>

104,229 documents in the shared corpus · 4,220 buyer documents in this page's voice · 550 ads to this audience of 4,366 read.

TLDR

- Who: 4,220 first-person agent documents (4,092 health / general agents, 76 life or final-expense agents talking about buying leads, 52 new or aspiring agents) from r/InsuranceAgent, agent Facebook groups, Insurance-Forums.com and agent YouTube. Property & casualty agents, call-center staff, vendors and recruiters are excluded.
- The lead is the whole job: Previous Solutions is the largest tab (440 documents bought leads from vendors, 141 aged leads, 164 transfers and inbound calls, 124 self-generated), and the top frustration after MLM recruiting is leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer (124 documents).
- What they pay (published prices, median of the vendors' ranges, Medicare Advantage): aged records \$1.00–\$6.50, shared \$15–\$31, exclusive \$35–\$75, T65 \$45–\$90, live transfers / inbound calls \$58–\$109 per call. The Lead Sources tab lists every price agents wrote themselves, with its link.
- What an enrollment is worth, and what each lead type costs to get one: \$725 for a new Medicare Advantage enrollment in 2027 (CMS maximum), \$363 a year after; Medicare Supplement about \$502 in year one; ACA \$20–\$30 per member per month. At published rates one MA enrollment costs the agent \$48–\$312 from aged data, \$233–\$437 from transfers, \$516–\$1,106 from exclusive leads and \$1,958–\$3,982 from shared leads. Self-generated Meta leads (the agent's own campaign, exclusive): \$764–\$2,484 at the published stage benchmarks, \$165 in ads at one agent's measured T65 campaign (352 leads, 12 enrollments and rising) (Metrics tab).
- Who sells to them: 550 agent-facing Meta ads — 298 from lead, transfer and call sellers and 127 from agencies and FMOs recruiting agents with leads included. The most-used hooks: name the audience, 'exclusive / verified / compliant', and 'inbound calls, no dialing'.
- The read for Vince (hypothesis): agents don't need more lead sellers; they need leads they trust. Two production routes clear the market: calling aged data into held appointments, and your own self-generated Meta campaign if it converts like the one measured agent campaign (\$5.67 leads, 19% reaching a real conversation). At the generic stage benchmarks Meta leads do not clear, so measure your first 300 leads before pricing. Consent to one agent, a verified phone and a written replacement policy answer the top complaint directly.

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Tab 1 — Fears

Agents state costs and results more than fears; a fear is counted only when a fear word and the subject sit in one sentence, so this tab is small and exact.

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Money spent on leads that don't pay back · 64 documents

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

↳ MonLower (39): "Feeling good about being independent and part of multiple agent associations. While this industry is far from perfect, this is the best place to be in my estimation. I feel bad for the SF agents that are up against serious changes. State Farm is quite offended by Progressive taking their spot and is looking to get more flexible to compete. My carriers have lowered commission rates, but often times will renege due to our agencies ability to place with other carriers. Overall, comp has decreased in my 15 years but not to the point of being unsustainable. A few percentage points with most large carriers."

↳ Splodingseal (19): "It's a shit or get off the pot approach. They want agents that are hungry to write as much business as possible and to get rid of Bob and his secretary that kinda coast along only writing as much as he needs to keep the lights on."

↳ firenance (18): "Independents are more insulated as carriers tend to influence performance with contract terminations or adjusting profit share or bonus commission metrics. They don't like you, they just fire you."

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

↳ Heavy_Following_1114 (19): "You view it as a job, not a career, You have an income requirement that's initially unattainable, You're intimidated by being undercut, You don't have a solid support system, You need to be nurtured, You're not driven enough, You never learned sales and marketing, You don't forge good enough relationships with clients, You don't study enough, You don't adapt, You're not an effective communicator, You aren't familiar with the markets, You don't have enough confidence in your products, You don't have a mentor, You don't market online, You don't do enough prospecting, You don't try hard enough, You don't stay on top of trends, You don't use new technology, You don't network enough, You don't treat your role as a business, Your expectations are too big from the start, Your expectations are too small from the start, You didn't get a quality education and training, You aren't focused enough, You didn't save enough money to support yourself while you grow a book, You're using dead-end leads, You don't have the right mindset, You're not qualifying your clients, You're too emotional, You're easily intimidated, You're not hungry enough to succeed, You're selling insurance and not solutions, You don't know how to set appointments, You're not a good presenter, You're not picking the right carriers for your prospects, You're not locking down the markets, You're not offering enough value, You don't have enough practical knowledge, You're focusing on the wrong things, You have too much freedom, You're limiting yourself, You're not making good first impressions, You're not following up enough, You're following up too much and scaring clients away, The job is too stressful, You lack patience, You're not making yourself available enough for your clients, You're not being proactive, You're not participating enough in your community"

↳ ThatWideLife (12): "There's one main reason why agents leave, they are in poverty with a full time job. Insurance is great for those who live with parents and have minimal bills. I'd say for a majority of people, they don't have a year to sit back and hope they start making money."

↳ [deleted] (10): "Selling isn't for most people. Selling insurance isn't for most sales people.. selling life insurance isn't for 99% of licensed insurance agents.. I just started a few months ago and I write 5K issued AP per week on a bad week, 7K -8K on average weekly with a high of 11K weekly... this sht isn't rocket scientist like everyone makes it seem. It's ad spend, closing ratio and systems."

"Legit life insurance wfh job I recently took a job with primerica not realizing it was an mlm after the fact I'm following through and getting my licensing because they provided that but after that does anyone have any legit recommendations for an entry level wfh not mlm insurance company I don't mind them being 1099 but I don't want to have to spend a lot on leads when I'm just learning"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 42 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f816tw/legit_life_insurance_wfh_job/

↳ joeboo5150 (31): "Probably an unpopular opinion here, but WFH when you are new to the industry and have no experience is a bad idea. You need to be in the office of whoever you are working for, learning, watching other agents and staff, asking questions, soaking up everything you can. Once you know what you are doing, working from home is perfectly fine as a producer. I always tell my producers that I don't care when or where they sell, as long as they're selling. It's totally up to them. But it's going to take 5x as long for you to learn and get comfortable while working from home, in my experience. If you want to be selling and making money as quickly as possible, you don't want to start out working from home."

↳ Traditional_Bad3852 (7): "I've been doing health insurance from home for about 3 years so I was just trying to transition into it but I understand what your saying it just wouldn't be possible with my schedule I'm doing all of this when I get off of my current job because I've only found 1099 if I were to find a salary office I would gladly take it"

↳ joeboo5150 (7): "Gotcha. I assumed you were new to the industry since you are just now getting licensed."

Compliance, CMS and losing a contract or license · 11 documents

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

"Hi David! I always appreciate your videos, so thank you for making them and sharing your knowledge so freely and often. I passed the AHIP but haven't had really any training on how to sell Medicare plans, which is frustrating because I don't want to be out that test money and not using that knowledge to help people. I do telesales for FE and plan to for Medicare but I'm nervous about all the upfront compliance stuff (like fitting in SOA over the phone for example). I have reached out to my agency about it but haven't had any assistance as of yet. Any chance you're planning on a video like this, or have a start to finish example of a Medicare call that could help put me at ease to get started?"

— YouTube · How A Career Selling Medicare Policies Works · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2Smzwhbqfw&lc=UgzJ1e_zsWcOx83Umx4AaABAg

↳ @TheDIGAgency (2): "We have that for agents in my Medicare agency. Also, consider looking for an agency that will actually support and train you. Agencies have to earn their overrides if they want to survive."

↳ @reoman8179 (2): "@TheDIGAgency any recommendations on IMO/FHO's?"

"L&H broker considering transition to commercial P&C... Opinions? I currently broker Medicare plans as an independent agent. I do remote sales and do very well relative to most in the industry. I have some lead gen systems in place that I am confident can transfer to any other sales role. However, my one concern is the endless compliance regulations for selling Medicare plans to seniors. With almost every way of contacting a prospect being uncompliant, I can't help but worry that in the future one slip up could cause me to lose my business that I have gained over years of selling. I do ethical business and I will not screw someone over to make a commission, but I am looking for something else with less regulation on how I acquire a client, that also pays residuals and decent upfront commission. I am not going to go captive, I am a commission only type of person, I want to lose big and win big. I'd rather put in the work to own my book of business and get my full commission. Anyone with experience in independent commercial P&C brokering with some insight on my next steps or where to learn more? How is compliance and regulations in that sector? Is there anything better than commercial P&C as far as commission and residuals? I only mention commercial because I heard that can be big money. Let me know opinions and if there are any other commission only sales routes I should pursue for good residuals. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dwvp5q/lh_broker_considering_transition_to_commercial_pc/

Not making enough to stay in the business · 10 documents

"Not many sales I work about 6-8 hrs 3-4 days a week and I suck. I have a script. I feel like I follow it pretty good. I call aged leads but I'm rarely getting a sale. Can go a few days without selling anything. Thinking of hanging it up but I don't want to give up at the same time. This is my 5th month. How long does it take to get this?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vftpsq/>

↳ (0): "Could be the leads, the scripts or possibly just need more practice. Do you feel like you have mastered your scripts and objection handling?"

↳ (0): "No. I am terrible at objection handling"

↳ (0): "Are you getting alot of objections? Gotta master your craft if you want to close. Like the other person said 1 call close is the way to go. Most people forget about the appt and the others will just agree to be nice to get you off the phone."

"Making too little for Marketplace Insurance?? I am a college student live in FL. I enrolled health insurance through Marketplace and received premium tax credit in year 2025. Now when I'm trying to enroll for 2026, my estimated income for 2026 is lower due to job change. The Marketplace shows I have \$0 premium tax credit. I called them, they say I make too little to qualify the premium tax credit. Although they mentioned I make too much to qualify for Medicaid, I don't qualify Medicaid anyway. My question is: - My income dropped tremendously in 2025 due to job change. Is it possible that I have to pay back the Tax Credit if I made less than 2025 100%FPL? I am worried now that when I file taxes, I might owe crazy amount of money for the insurance. - how do I get cheap insurance coverage (just for serious emergency like accidents or unforeseeable disease. I normally don't go to the hospital to get checked up or for some small things like cold cuz I literally can't afford it right now) P.S.: My school don't have anything. It's a very small private school & they don't care. I'm waitressing and they do not offer insurance. I can't get on my parent's plan either."

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1plaivt/>

↳ (0): "For 2026, I think what you need to do is earn the 15k. (Whatever the exact number is). Probably that means, for example, you need to not take classes over the summer and work two jobs during that time. Plus some part time work during the semesters. Also, self employment income would count. Maybe you can baby sit or clean houses in addition to working a regular job. You just have to report the income on your tax return and pay the social security taxes on it, etc (look into paying taxes separately). It still takes time and I understand it's not easy as a full time student, but Florida has you in bad situation. 😞 It's not at all supportive of college students, but that's what Florida chooses to have it be. There's a cap on what you would have to pay back in 2025, but that's going away in 2026. I don't know how that will work as where are people going to get the money, but you don't need that hanging over you!"

↳ (0): "Florida is one of the 10 states that hasn't accepted Medicaid expansion, so people who make more than 100% of FPL cannot get on Medicaid, but less than 133% of FPL and so do not have access to ACA subsidies. Does your university have access to a student healthcare group policy? I know when I attended Illinois, anyone who did not have coverage through their parents or an employer was required to get a policy by the university"

↳ (0): "Point of clarification. OP can't access Medicaid in Florida, full stop. Even at 0% FPL / no income. OP would need to be low / no income *and either* blind, disabled, pregnant, over 65, or have a dependent child under the age of 18 to remotely qualify for Medicaid. The same is true for anyone in the 9 other states that don't have expanded Medicaid programs. In order to secure subsidies through healthcare.gov, OP needs a minimum annual income of 100% FPL. This is the healthcare.gov subsidy floor in the 10 states without Medicaid expansion."

"> It's a bit funny that the only thing you didn't acknowledge in my comment was the fact that you don't just get a regular job. ACTUALLY I worked in commercial finance for years + ran 3 small businesses so there's that. I actually got fired from the finance company partly because I couldn't get any work done with my home phone ringing 50 times before lunch. >There's absolutely no way you can convince me that you're making ZERO action to receive these calls. You're not getting 100's of illegal calls by being just a random needle in the haystack, you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. Believe what you want to believe, but I feign interest to see who buys the lead and that's that. I do not opt in anywhere. >you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. I do no such thing and I dare anyone to prove that I do. >Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. I don't want the money. I want the calls to stop. Since the calls won't stop, I will take the money. >We all get random calls from shady oversea call centers. Will I get 2-3 of these calls on a bad day? Yes. Do I decide to engage the call, pretend to be interested so I can sue the American receiver of the illegal transfer who is likely unaware this call was generated illegally? Absolutely not. img-wouldbealotcoolerifyoudid.jpg >You're trying to call it justice but it's just not. TCPA/DNC laws are set up to protect regular consumers, especially vulnerable ones like seniors, not to create a side hustle for bottom feeders like you. I'd be willing to bet when you find a carrier/brokerage/agent who's willing to fight you instead of just throwing you a couple of bucks to save the legal fees - you drop the suit because you don't want this going to discovery. Believe what you want to believe. I don't opt in for ANYTHING and I'm on every single marketing database known to man. Landline is 40+ years old, same address. Cell is 20+ years old same subscriber Registered voter, property owner, business owner, etc etc. The dataminers have enough out there on me that I don't need to opt in for a single goddamn thing for them to already know me Oh and I guess I'll clarify that I'm a carrier rep, my calls come from our own marketing. We don't use third parties at all. I fight and litigate EVERY single suit until summary judgement/jury verdict. Don't put words in my mouth."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8ygyfc/

Being tied to an agency, upline or contract · 8 documents

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm'd" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

↳ Inner_Friendship5913 (2): "I just got my license in September and knew absolutely nothing about insurance. I started with Equis and had a very bad experience with my upline and felt like I was stuck with no one to teach me or train me. The top group person just blew smoke when I tried to get help so I left. I signed with Symmetry and I'm having a difficult time getting Equis to release me because they say they don't require it but Symmetry does require it. Symmetry has already started to get me started with other insurance carriers. I only had 5 with Equis. I have got no contracts with any carriers with Symmetry yet in my email but I know they started the process. BUT I was never told that I have to split my commissions 40%(me) and 60%(SME agent). I spoke to transamerica and Mutual of Omaha and they said I'd be penalized 90 days for ending the contract through Equis. So if I decide to not stay at Symmetry then that is even more insurance carriers that I'll be stuck waiting 90 days to work with again. I honestly have no idea where to go from here. I don't want to do all the work and a finalizing agent take 60% of my commissions. What company out there allows you to keep your commissions outside of the Small bit your upline gets? Or at least a fair amount?"

↳ RedditInsuranceGuy (1): "I would need to know what line of insurance you are talking about to get more specific. But basically its a standard wait of 6 months after a documented request of release from the contract for most carriers. Mutual of Omaha is pretty strict on that stuff. As far as what you do going forward is find an IMO that can fill the gaps with something competitive in the meantime while you process the releases and wait it out."

↳ Standard-Position698 (1): "I am in the process of trying to get a release/terminate contract. My up-line has refused to continue to reply and has removed me from all platforms and blocked me but will not release my contract."

"United is simply restructuring and will release new plans for AEP. Obviously they were hit hard, notice they only decommissioned the extremely affordable PPOs going forward... thats because they don't want you to sell any more of them and they cant just release plan changes mid year. And you are talking about commission cuts when we were just announced a 10% increase in MAPD renewals and Initials for 2026. There are lots of carriers dying to throw agents money.... And new carriers are still getting in the game and expanding every year, which is a good sign. I agree it is a little unstable right now, but for agents that is a good thing. Medicare and ACA aren't going anywhere. And if they do, you have an entire book to convert to the new thing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n56ide4/

"New Agent Choosing an FMO vs. Going Direct – Advice Needed! Hello everyone, I'm a newly licensed agent in Virginia, and I'm currently in the process of choosing an FMO to work with. Right now, training and support are my biggest priorities—even more than commission splits—because I know that with excellent training, the money will follow. Primarily, I want to start off offering Medicare (with the hopes to offer my clients ACA & possibly Life at a much later date, after I gain an understanding of the industry, but only as supplements to their needs). It's my understanding that I could work for multiple FMOs, as one may not entirely fulfill my needs. 😊 I've been looking at Gordon Marketing, TR King Insurance Marketing, Ritter, and Redbird, but I've seen mixed feedback. Some people say Gordon Marketing gives off MLM vibes—does anyone here have experience with them? I've also seen advice about finding an upline and then letting them be your contact because going directly to an FMO will get you lost in their hierarchy without direct support and guidance. On the flip side, I came across a comment saying that going direct with carriers (rather than using an FMO) is a better route. I'd love to hear from anyone who's done this: Did you have prior experience before going direct? Do the carriers provide strong training & support, or would I be on my own? For those in Virginia, what are the most prevalent carriers I should consider contracting with? Also, I want to run my own agency and generate my own leads. I'm not looking for an FMO that requires me to buy leads from them or forces me into a specific system. I just want solid training. If, down the line, I decide to buy leads, I'd like the option, but I don't want to be locked into it. I want to set myself up for success long-term and avoid jumping around between FMOs. Any insights or personal experiences would be greatly appreciated! Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ijykig/new_agent_choosing_an_fmo_vs_going_direct_advice/

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you want your focus to be on Medicare, I would add, in order, 1) supplemental health (Hospital plans, Cancer plans, home health plans, dental plans.) All of your Medicare clients could likely use some or all of these. 2) Final Expense Life. Easy add on if you just look to fix problems with people's existing life insurance. 3) ACA but not to go after a large ACA book. So you can sell ACA to spouses and referrals. Mostly to grab them as future Medicare clients. 4) annuities. Lots of clients will have CDs, 401ks and other amounts of money that are essentially doing nothing for them. You probably can do number 1 after six months. 2 after 2 years. 3 a year after that. And 4 after you have been in the business for about 6 years. Go slow. Work intentionally. Build a long term business."

↳ NAF1138 (3): "If you want training and support you don't want to go direct. The carriers don't care about you and mostly don't know anything about selling insurance. They are not where you want to be trained. The only exception being the captive sales forces of certain carriers. You also, want to pick ONE of those things in your list. Do not come out the gate trying to sell Medicare, ACA, Annuities and Life. You will never learn to sell any of them that way. They are all different and sometimes conflicting sales processes. They can all easily keep you busy full time. You will essentially be doing 4 jobs full time badly. Of the FMOs you mentioned, TR King is actually run by a decent human who cares about his people. Ritter is good if you know what you are doing or are working with an agent who is running an agency under them, but doing direct to Ritter is the same as going direct to the carrier. Redbird, I don't know anyone who works their but they have a reasonably good reputation. I don't know Gordon Marketing at all. That doesn't mean anything though, no one knows everyone."

↳ voidsarcastic (3): "Like commission rates? Luckily they're all pretty close carrier to carrier so sell the best plan for the client every-time, and every client is different so different plans and carriers work better for different people. Pretty sure MAPD is the same rate for every carrier (315 renewal 650 IEP) however over-rides may be different and some offer HRA bonus. Most supplements are 20-23% annual (first year advance), and dental/HI is like 45-50% annual (first year advance). Be careful some MAPD plans are non-commissionable i do avoid those, but there really aren't many. I have however done no commission part Ds, you gotta do what you gotta do. Life commissions should be between 80%-115% (9 month- 12 month advance) starting out, if you're taking a lower comp from the FMO make sure you are getting lots of support."

TCPA, do-not-call and being sued for a call · 7 documents

"Possible complaint being filed against me. I am an independent life and health Insurance agent who may be having a complaint filed against me from a former client of mine. I have hundreds of clients enrolled in ACA plans (marketplace, Obamacare) and this person was one of them. He was enrolled in a plan and opted into automatic renewal. The plan was renewed and he called me back saying he was never aware his plan was renewed, because he was requiring a 1095 form to file his taxes. He called the marketplace and they told him to "file a complaint" against the agent. I have a recently recorded call where I told him he opted in for the automatic renewal and he didn't negate against it. I do have E&O insurance as well. I would never enroll a customer without their consent, I am just worried about what will happen next. He is losing \$1800 on his tax return due to him being enrolled in this plan, but it's not my fault. Any advice would be greatly appreciated, thank you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1c7go61/possible_complaint_being_filed_against_me/

↳ Stratosto3 (8): "Provide CMS with the info. Unfortunately they ARE cracking down, and you being independent means the heat goes to you. Explain to CMS that you have audio with explicit consent. He will then have to prove that he did not know, which you have consent to. Thats your best solution. Make sure its done by email if possible, any paper trail matters tremendously. You have no need to speak with the client in question, if you were wondering. Let CMS handle it. Sooner or later you will have this happen, mostly due to the clients being aloof during their own enrollment and not answering questions when you ask them if they have any."

↳ Stratosto3 (6): "Theres no need to. If you did the income correctly and he didnt update it, then thats on him."

↳ [deleted] (5): "Don't sweat it! You've done nothing wrong. These complaints are filed all the time and 95% of them are found to be baseless. I know it's nerve wracking and it's not a good feeling but the truth is if you do this for any length of time you will eventually get a complaint filed against you. I have been through it myself and after providing all forms of documentation and being forthright and open with the claims investigator who is just doing their job, the claim was closed and found to be baseless. Believe me when I tell you that there are actual cases of malice and this certainly isn't one. You have not done anything wrong and you have it all on record. You're going to be fine."

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"> in this instance would you even pursue this in court? HELL YES. Why wouldn't I? > You mentioned the complaint to the state legislator, but is this instance not something you would pursue in a lawsuit? They can run paralel. >I was under the impression that you signed up for the ACA plan? The minute the rep realized they couldn't pull off "Lindsay Smith" or whatever american name - they changed their tune. >Also aren't you afraid that someone Will steal your social security number? I'm 41 and my SSN has been lost in like 19 data breaches in the past 10 years. It's already out there, fuck it. >Or is that just the risk You're willing to accept for potentially being able to sue companies for breaking Do not call registry lists? Most of these calls are not scams, they're actual hard line attempts to sign you to an ACA plan and get a \$45 lead."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nl7wbo/another_reason_not_to_trust_lead_brokersthird/nfiv118/

AEP: the year's income riding on eight weeks · 6 documents

"Agency M&A Market Update Sharing some current intel on the agency M&A market. Everything here is generalities, but current trends you won't see in press releases. I also won't cite multiples, because even within these segments there is a lot of nuance and "what ifs" that have to be answered. But some general intel on if you have an agency in this category, things to consider. **Size Matters** Always has, but many capital buyers are continuing to bump up their targets. If you are sub \$750K revenue then PE buyers aren't as active. Your best bet is another local agency, and the offers won't be the same. Some PE buyers will play in this space, but the offers are super complex with low guarantees and pie in the sky earn out potentials. This has always been the case, but we're seeing less interest from larger buyers in that segment. >\$750K-\$1M, is typically where the interest remains. Majority of large buyers are open to >\$1M EBITDA, so if you are \$2.5M-\$3M+ revenue, the market is dramatically different. If you are a small agency, and want/need the best exit scenario, your primary objective is quality growth. Makes sense to increase the sale of an asset you should increase what makes it valuable, but for some reason people don't make that connection. If you are content with a handshake deal to turn over the keys with an agency across town, great, but don't expect a high sale price. **Medicare and Non-standard P&C Agencies are Super Limited** The population of buyers has dwindled tremendously over the last 12-18 months. Opinion? It's political. Any time there is looming administration change on health care or immigration, these can be volatile. Medicare agencies are constantly facing changing carriers, comp rates, etc. so on a dime a successful agency can be at risk. Just this week a client, large FMO, learned their #2 carrier was pulling out of a territory and they were at risk to lose revenue on 2,000 policies unless they find a replacement this AEP. Buyers know that, and have only been offering low cash proceeds at close and significant rolled equity or growth earn outs. So when you only have a few options, and the options aren't great, it's hard to sell for a good price. Non-standard is similar, in that there are only a handful of large buyers. Even large (>\$3M revenue) non-standard P&C agencies are not getting good offers. So unless sellers have a motivation to get out, many are holding on. Small or local non-standard, practically your only option is selling to someone local or another non-standard. **Personal Lines is Getting Slightly Less Interest Compared to Last Year** Many large buyers are changing their buy-box criteria to focus on a minimum book mix, so unless an agency has a minimum of 30%-50% CL, many of the larger buyers aren't excited. That's not saying they aren't sellable, we still get great interest for good agencies, but when the buyer pool reduces that can be reflected in the offers. This is an observation, but on average we are seeing offers for PL focused agencies around 10% less compared to last year for guaranteed proceeds. When you think about it, property rates in many states have slowed or even started to decrease, so the due diligence standards are also looking at this. Many agencies have floated on rate the last few years, and now the tide has turned. Having history of client count or PIF is more important, and if your revenue is stable but you've lost clients and policies, that's flag being discussed. **CL, or HNW, Holds Strong Interest** There are still nuances within that, but many capital buyers are focusing their efforts on agencies with 50% or more CL. Even though we still see strong interest in PL, on average we see almost double the amount of qualified inquiries for a CL focused agency. **Earn out Structures are Evolving** People know "you have to stay on for 2-3 years" to work out an earnout, but candidly recent history has proven that many sellers almost don't care about earnouts, or that's all they care about then completely check out. For truly competitive offers, buyers are focusing more on true perpetuation planning vs buying an owner out and giving them a short term retirement window. This is the rare exception, but have seen it, where some buyers are now tying earnout performance to staff retention (AMs and producers) instead of just the owner. Not everyone will adopt this, but I wouldn't be surprised if more do. So perpetuation of culture and why your agency can perform will be tied to things other than strictly financials. **EDIT Diversified Agencies are Not Always A Good Idea** Agencies that offer derivative services like real estate, tax prep, bookkeeping, payroll, HR, etc. cause problems. Back in the day there used to be buyers for these, not anymore. They will be broken up if you want to sell. Even as far as P&C PL and Medicare. As much as you feel they are complimentary, they aren't. Different markets. Even things like group benefits and HR consulting. While complimentary not everyone who does group benefits wants HR consulting. If you look at diversified larger agencies you can see one clear trend. P&C CL and group benefits can have some compliment. That's it. Focus on doing one thing, really really well, and don't get distracted with other things."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vzu98u/>

↳ (0): "Nice write up. Kind of what I am seeing/hearing as well. Have had a few calls from some older agency owners under 1,000,000 in revenue noting that they haven't received much interest from PE. I asked if they had any younger producers and they noted they did not. With the lack of younger talent and revenue under a 1,000,000 they aren't getting much traction on being acquired or able to sell to PE."

↳ (0): "Yep. Stagnant or no growth is sellable, but the true difference is a well run business, good staffing, and history of organic growth."

↳ (0): "Great write up and insights. Appreciate your expertise here, as always."

"I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want an insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnyracercat"

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🇺🇸 · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaNZ299tywzREh4AaABAg.9y98fTJc_WH9yCV1Jie25

"@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAq.9FNCTGBfz7K9FPVNMvVfon>

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Getting licensed, certified and started · 23 documents

"I agree with the pro of being independent and not micromanaged. Long rant but I just quit my fairly new job where I knew NOTHING. I had no experience. They said training would be 2 months.. Unfortunately, only 3 weeks in the boss kept pulling me aside literally every day and telling me I was too slow, not doing good enough, and that I should know a lot more. Then she wanted me to study at home to "catch up" without paying me. As well as the senior staff member would make comments throughout the day like "come on. you should know this already" The problem was I knew the information. It just got very difficult to focus because of the negativity. I was sweating and so anxious all day and because of that kept making mistakes. I woke up one day and said fuck this and quit. I work best when not micromanaged. I need to take the time to learn things at my own pace. I cannot tolerate negativity. My previous job was a pharmacy technician. I did it for 5 years and I loved it and I was badass at it. It made me realize that I love talking to customers about health insurance. I hope I do well as an insurance agent :D I'm about to take the licensing exam. Yay!"

— YouTube · PROS & CONS OF BEING AN INSURANCE AGENT · 122 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UfHT3xWq4TY&lc=UgwNWyFPgyNrc06hZcd4AaABAq>

↳ @ErinNogueira (15): "Best of luck Jane! Proud of you for sticking to your guns and doing what's best for you!!"

↳ @nerd6646 (5): "how is it going? i'm about to do the same move you did lol"

↳ @dianaag28 (1): "Good for you, good luck 🍀👍"

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"@JohnDavis-yz9nq John I am licensed agent and EITHER way can bleed ya...it is the hope of Medicare that NO ONE uses it."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 39 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgXAXzFMBaU_-X7O2GZ4AaABA9_9YRy38TRtYC9YiQyO8M_Ni

A book of business and renewals that pay every year · 21 documents

"Quit \$150k W2 Sales to start an Agency. 6 Months in: Lessons learned from the "FE Trap" and pivoting to Group Health/Life. Feedback? I'm in my late 20s and recently walked away from a \$150k+ W2 sales career to build my own independent agency. I started with a \$2,000/month residual base from a previous ACA book and a small group. The Failure: I fell for the Final Expense hype. I burned several thousand dollars on my own ads, lead vendors, and a marketing firm. After 6 months, I realized the "social worker" aspect of FE isn't for me. I'm a consultant and advisor, not a hand-holder for the unbanked. The Pivot: I've officially pivoted to Group Health (U65), Individual Health, and Term Life. My daily "Machine" looks like this: • Cold Knocking: Visiting local businesses daily to prospect for Group Health. • Strategic Partners: Building a referral network (CPAs, P&C agents) for Life/Health leads. • Efficiency: Cutting all paid lead spend once current FE ads die. Reallocating that budget to BNI and local SEO. The Concern: I'm 6 months in and not profitable yet. I live in a major city and the grind is real. Thank God for my savings and residual base, but I want to make sure I'm not missing a gear. My Questions: 1. Aside from BNI and cold knocking, what high-leverage community events or "advisor-level" prospecting am I missing?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rgt03f/>

↳ (0): "Insurance Sales is hard, if you don't already have a book of business. It will take a while to build the business."

↳ (0): "How long did it take you to profit?"

↳ (0): "Health biz is great, just takes years to build. Have you looked at using ICHRA to get into the door? Do some research on IHCRA if you haven't. Some other things I'd try: look for new business formations in your local newspaper and go drop in on them. Fresh meat! =) Also, how much activity are you doing? Are you cold knocking 30 businesses daily or making 100+ phone calls daily? A lack of activity is usually the cause of all sales woes. If you're looking for ways to bridge the gap with final expense, consider doing in-person seminars at local independent senior living facilities. Did those for 9 months and made around 100 sales with zero expense. Have seen dozens of other agents do well at it, too. Further, you could look at doing talks at small group church meetings, senior activity centers, about Medicare, final expenses, etc. Cost nothing and creates the best leads. Good luck. Remember it's normal that the first few years are incredibly difficult as you find your place. Stick with it and eventually you'll find your niche and begin getting traction!"

"Having done Medicare, I'd do ACA. Your odds are high that you will write the entire family versus Medicare where it's mostly one person. While you can sometimes do husband and wife enrollments it's very rare. Your goal is to build residual income. Plus, no longer dealing with pain the butt elderly people with a 2 minute attention span wanting \$5k/month in food cards who change policies multiple times per year is a bonus. I'm thankful for the experience in Medicare because it really does teach you to overcome objections and pivot pitch. Beyond that, I would never want to sell it again."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kmjoeg/whats_better_aca_or_medicare_sales/msbxwrl/

"For me it's, \$611 up front for MAPD and \$306 renewals in January. Med Supp Im about \$550 when you factor in PDP. My goal each year is \$100k FYC plus my renewals in Medicare. Add in annuities, FE, CHAS, etc. Being rich depends on the person."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Does anyone really get "rich" selling Medicare · 5 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/does-anyone-really-get-rich-selling-medicare.113372/#post-1494991>

Six figures and the freedom that comes with it · 18 documents

"Are there ANY truly "good" life insurance companies to work for?? I'm in the process of getting my license, so still very new to the biz. I've read the horror stories of truly bad MLM-like companies and am staying away from those (although strangely, they seem to have their fair share of happy employees), so I did a very basic Google search of "The Best Life Insurance Companies to Work For." I got answers like Northwestern, Mutual of Omaha, New York Life, etc. So I go to Glassdoor & Indeed to read employee reviews, and those are just as all over the place as the MLMs! "Best company in the world, changed my life", "Shit leads, non-existent training, if you don't meet production goals you're fired". My question is: How do I know where the truly GOOD companies are if all the reviews are like this? I just want an entry-level role to get my feet wet, aiming for \$80k/yr in the first couple years. Nothing crazy. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/

↳ MrDaveyHavoc (11): "The subset of people motivated to post online reviews is always going to skew negative."

↳ amusings_ (11): "Hello 🐼 I've read about Globe Life (AIL) and it sounds like they're known for the "bait and switch" of their customers. (I.e. Using a customer's request for a Safety Kit to then try to sell them life insurance that they didn't ask for). What do you say to those claims?"

↳ amusings_ (9): "That's a good point ✅ The successful people usually don't bother to sit down and write a review about how successful they are, haha"

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tg4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

↳ DonicaLewinsky69420 (16): "Ask every client and new prospect for referrals. Let them know how important it is to you. Be the business. Not the Business professional. Live it, breathe it, learn it."

↳ FuzzyDice_12 (7): "My tips: 1) Networking: I'm an introvert that comes across as an extrovert. Great for sales but I dread going to events and force myself to go. Staying connected and going to Insurance Events, opens up connections, some you may not realize for years later. Perfect example is while I'm young, I got into insurance and owning my agency at 21ish. Many of the contacts at brokerages I've made, jump ship to other brokerages. The friendship will get you an appointment where normally you couldn't have. 2) Agency Software: This one is a big one. Many of the softwares are expensive and slow. Sometimes agents, when opening their own agencies, use the software from their previous agency, with outdated tech, solely because of familiarity. I learned this lesson the hard way. Thousands a year on crappy agency software. 3) Turning 1 New Business Insured and the policy they chose to have you quote, into multiple policies and new leads. This one is big. 4) This is personal to my niche (small/medium accounts are \$100k+), and builds on 3. Offer several smaller quotes for lines of insurance applicable to your line of business the insured may not have/have been offered previously, even if you don't think the insured will be interested. "If Any" Workers Comp would be applicable for my lines of business. 5) create partnerships with other independent agencies and agents. Self explanatory I would think. 6) SOP's, and building the agency with Franchising in mind. 7) Calendar: setting up reminders to touch base on insured's. If you are coming around only at renewal time, you easily become an agent that is replaceable. 8) As an agency owner, not only having SOP's, but understanding how every moving part of your agency works. From accounting, to customer service, to certificates of insurance, and on and on. Excuse any typos (at the barber shop), but this is what I could think of off the top of my head, and while some sections are more important than others, I didn't number them in any particular order."

↳ ChrisPbacon969 (5): "Commenting to follow along. I'm about to get started on my p and c journey."

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will my make feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (39): "I didn't read everything you wrote, but just keep in mind, it's a tough insurance climate right now (Assuming you're in the US). Doing it right now would leave you struggling to get contracts. I'm an independent and almost all of my major carriers are not giving new contracts at this time. This will drain your assets extremely fast. I'd hold out until it softens up a bit."

↳ Acceptable-Tip7886 (28): "Times are tough, if you're making 200k plus I would stay and invest. Money now is more important than money later plus you'll retire sooner"

↳ HamiltonSt25 (10): "I'm sorry, let me clarify. I'm speaking as far as P&C goes. So if you're asking about life/health, I have no idea. If you're talking P&C, then I'm speaking about direct contracts with carriers/companies."

Going independent · 15 documents

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

↳ idontknowhow2reddit (7): "I agree with all of this. Insurance is a crazy world so there's a ton of things to learn. The textbook and real world are very different so I would try to find an established company with good training to work for first. Without that, it will be hard to build a referral base or to gain that trusted advisor role. Your network and other professionals are going to need to see you in the industry a bit before they will trust you on your own."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (5): "Congrats! For someone who also got into insurance later in my career. 1. Pick one product and master it, then move into the second one, and so on. Medicare, ACA, Final Expense, Annuities, etc. 2. Training. Master that product and then move to the second. W 2 or Captive will give you the most training. 40 a week of training vs 1 or 2 hours a week. 3. Pick the right organization. Know the difference between recruiters selling me vs legitimate interviews. I wish someone told me about how many recruiters would try to sell me and then offer no support. I am so glad I left and went into a W2 to learn and get practice but I wish someone told me how difficult releases were! Best of luck but honestly someone with your degree of previous success should be fine. Just remember you're not gonna make as much money at first. You'll probably need to go independent to make more than 125k. However, I would suggest to build that foundation first but as long as you know what you're getting into I think you'll do great."

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (5): "If I had to start over today, the first thing I'd do is choose my upline very carefully. The wrong agency/upline can cost you years of your career. Second, I'd pick one niche and master it before trying to sell everything. Too many new agents want to do Medicare, ACA, final expense, annuities, group benefits...and end up not getting very good at any of them. Third, I'd get in front of people every single workday. Nothing replaces activity. I'd rather have a decent script and 15 appointments than the perfect script and no one to talk to. The biggest mistakes I'd avoid are buying into recruiting hype (MLMs), signing contracts without understanding release policies, and spending time on useless activities, like tweaking logos, trying to figure out every detail of CRMs, or building websites than actually selling. I would absolutely suggest joining an agency first. I'd choose one based on transparency, track record, proven training and scripts, and upline (again, upline is very important). Make sure you're paid directly by the carriers, understand exactly how releases work (get it in writing), and ask a lot of questions before you sign anything. Once you start selling, consistency is key. Focus on activity, because your input determines your output. Work hard, follow your upline's advice and system, and don't get distracted by other opportunities or anything else."

"Looking to do final expense and Medicare sales over the phone. If you were starting out today what imo/fmo would you go with? I want to stay independent. I was going to go with Digital BGA because they promoted a reduced commission for free lead program but they've changed their structure. So I'm now open to new companies as long as I can work from home."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/skrayl/>

↳ (0): "DBA is probably the best over the phone from what I hear. Jeff is a powerhouse so I assume you'll have access to quality leads. Have you sold those (MS and FE) before or do you need training? If you need training check out my book on Amazon."

↳ (0): "I've heard nothing but good things about DBA. However, I literally quit my job to go work for them because they offered free leads with reduced commissions. Then after I got my license they no longer offered that. So I'm looking at other avenues now. I was a stockbroker for 9 years (years ago) and sold tons of insurance policies but never FE or MS. I'm all about training so if you have a book that you think I should look at either send me a DM or link it here and I'll get it. If you have recommendations for other firms let me know."

↳ (0): "That sucks, any mention why they stopped the program? Another BGA that is giving the same opportunity I remember, not to long ago is Ben Boman - saw an email of his across my desk last week about it. He's mostly FE and has a solid sales process, but I think his process prefers physical f2f sales - I may be wrong. I don't permit linking here for prospecting - so you'll have to search my name for the book."

"1099 Health & Life agent here. Im 100% commission based, and I'm associated with a brokerage which provides training, leads, and makes it very easy and simple to appoint with different carriers. I have heard lots of horror stories about how it can be, but I was very lucky to land at a place where it seems to be the dream which I'm sure there are others like it. My work life balance is what I choose. Since I am 1099/Independent- I work from where I want, however I want, for however long I want... sell the products that I choose. My brokerage provides an office space for free which you can go to 7 days a week and there are always people there willing to help or let you shadow while you learn. Pay depends on you. Last year was my first year and although it was rough (Chargebacks, customer service being the worst) I see the potential in the game especially since I have become close with some of the top producers at the brokerage. Although some decide to work 6 days a week for 10 hours or more (and make well into the 6 figures or even 7) others do what you want to do which is put their family first. I would take everything you are told with a grain of salt as it is heavily dependent on that person's experience. Mine has been great. If you are a resilient person, manage stress well, work hard on your own and don't need external motivation, this career could be good for you. It definitely has it's ups and downs (I'm a 100% commission based agent), but if you have enough money saved up to survive for a couple of months while you get started I would highly recommend a 100% commission based position if you can mentally handle it since you will get a much higher commission rate and you will own your book of business. Best of luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ax5nn1/what_is_it_like_being_an_insurance_agent/krlsxi6/

A lead source that works every month · 10 documents

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage.m, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"That is insane- I started ACA this past November. I didn't invest in leads or anything, just leaving with a small handful of clients. I'm desperately looking to build my book of business this year and I'm really looking for viable lead sources outside of open enrollment and would love to hear about the source you use during open enrollment to reach those numbers- I'm willing to invest in myself. Could you DM or reach back out on this post?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rx4iw2/enrolled_500_aca_clients_my_first_open_enrollment/ob4t2br/

"Great video. I am new and have rcvd a few leads. None panned out but hoping some good leads come during open enrollment"

— YouTube · FREE LEADS!! How to get free leads for ACA "Obamacare" · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sBopPuhBx74&lc=UgwXP RP-6mdv3iHEBMF4AaABAg>

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "Thank you. It should be a lot better during open enrollment"

Leads that answer and a phone that rings · 9 documents

"From Restaurant Owner to Bankruptcy: Charting My Path Back to Success Hi Reddit friends! I'm here to tell you about my journey and ask for a little help. I used to run a restaurant that I opened back in 2010. But when COVID-19 hit, I had to close it because of money problems. Before that, I worked with import and export between Dubai and Belgium. Right now, I'm working at a company to pay the bills and I'm still paying off some debts from my restaurant. I want to start working as an appointment setter and later on, I hope to become good at closing deals. I'm thankful for everything I've learned and I believe in myself. I know I can find my way back. Life has been tough, but I have faith. I'm from Belgium and I speak English, French, and Arabic. If you have any advice on how to get into appointment setting or know someone who can help, I'd be so grateful. Thanks for reading!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d8424p/>

↳ (0): "Appointment setting can be very ominous. Just get a good script and read it every call to get the client over to the closer."

"I've been hearing mixed things on inbound, and would love to try but unfortunately given the financial situation I'm in now I can't buy any more leads even if they are inbound. I would feel better about it but the vast majority of the people I spoke to that are tenured have told me it takes between 6-12 months just to become profitable. I don't have that kind of runway. But I pray it goes well for you! Please check back in and let me know how things are going I'm genuinely interested to hear how you do by sticking it out!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ourbvaq/

"Lead magnets don't work I followed the textbook advice: build generic lead magnets for prospects ("Medicare 101: A Beginner's Guide to Turning 65"), hoping to get more leads. I used these "magnets" to run ads and send them directly to prospective clients. **Spoiler alert: It was completely ineffective.** I learned the hard way that lead magnets only work when they answer the **specific question** the client is "actively" looking for. No one, especially not a busy prospect, is going to read through a large, generic PDF or blog post. "What worked for me:" 1. Finding social media posts for people asking questions about their insurance - it could be final expense, medicare or ACA - doesn't matter. Key is to find the real people asking questions on groups. 2. Based on the question, use ChatGPT or Gemini to generate an article (PDF or blog) to answer the specific question. It should be HELPFUL but not generic 3. Send it to the prospect. Follow up with questions, to help refine the material. Anyone tried this playbook? Any ways to make these even better? Tip: Having blog posts hosted on your website work great, as they allow you to build custom audiences for ad targeting on meta. Additionally, adding them to your social page works great as well."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1otr8l0/lead_magnets_dont_work/

↳ oogway_rox (2): "We use a tool to find and filter social media posts. You could use Google or ai tools, but it requires manual effort to weed out the irrelevant posts."

↳ firenace (2): "Fremium downloads are to get attention, not close a sale. Also defeats the purpose as IME paid ads have been ineffective for a long time. I've reviewed prob over 1,000 agency P&Ls by now, can count on one hand the number of agencies that get a true long term positive return from paid campaigns. I know plenty however that do Medicare 101 seminars or webinars and get hot leads from putting them in the right place right time. One even does them at the local library every few months, the library advertises it, and they consistently get sales from it."

↳ AbbreviationsGold587 (2): "So basically you see a question someone asked, put together a blog post on it, then say we just wrote a blog post on that exact topic?"

Helping people, not just selling · 7 documents

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a notary too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshows, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavgn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

↳ mental_mentalist (13): "You could find life and health carriers and go to their careers section (although they may want experience you may not have)"

↳ takeagander20 (9): "A couple of Medicare agencies who are frequently looking for remote workers, that pay a steady base and a little extra money for enrollments are ResultsCX, and Select Quote. You won't get rich working for either outfit but you can get your feet wet and gain the confidence necessary to go 1099, which is what I'm doing this year since my first AEP and OEP as an hourly sales agent went so well. Getting in is mainly a matter of timing though. Seems I got hired in mid July, to start late September, so you might be a little early. Keep looking on indeed, and you will progressively see more Medicare Sales ads show up day by day. You'll eventually see one or two that offer an hourly base. Good luck!"

↳ mkuz753 (7): "Brown & Brown is a large national independent agency/brokerage. There are many others. Keep in mind that most L&H licensed people end up in employee benefits, aka group plans."

"I am so grateful I came across your channel! I recently received my insurance license with California, and I was wondering if you have any tips to for a beginner in this health insurance industry. I currently work for a small firm in Los Angeles, and I want to become really good at helping people find the right coverage for them. Besides watching your videos, what do you suggest I study and read to become as successful as you? Thank you so much for sharing your knowledge!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance Subsidy Repayment Even If You Left Covered California with Higher Income · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4nPtpHKvnic&lc=UgyXJFOxpL4sv1hlvxN4AaABAg>

↳ @KevinKnauss (3): "Pretend you are the client. What would you want to know about when it comes to how a health plan works? Understand how the subsidies are calculated. Don't forget about Medi-Cal and how children are often Medi-Cal and parents are in Covered California with the subsidy. Talk to your clients about how they use health insurance, what they need. Then there is HMO, EPO, and PPO plans, another confusing element. Most importantly, let your clients know they can call, text, or email you anytime with questions. You may not have the answer on the top of your desk, but let them know you will find it. Reading material includes the Evidence of Coverage for the various health plans offered in your area. Instructions for IRS form 8962 Premium Tax Credit reconciliation. Learn about how Medi-Cal works."

↳ @felixgarcia3184 (3): "@KevinKnauss Thank you so much for the advice Kevin. I will definitely start thinking like the client and pursue higher knowledge on the plans being offered by these insurance companies."

"Thanks for posting this! Been trying to wrap my head around all the changes. I truly hope most of these don't go through, I'm not sure why every single one is meant to hurt Americans, not help them."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m2m8ak/important_aca_changes_to_know_heading_into_2026/n3r4h3u/

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Agents rarely write about family; the relationship that recurs is with recruiters and uplines.

Theme	Documents
Friends and family: the warm market and the referrals	35
Uplines, managers and recruiters who misled them	19
Clients who get angry when they are called	16
Other agents: poaching, bad actors and the reputation	6

Friends and family: the warm market and the referrals · 35 documents

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVENT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spleine KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

"I work at a brokerage in life. I have gotten people approved with one of 40 carriers I have that would have been turned down everywhere else. If I was captive at one of 97.5% of these carriers, I would have had to say "sorry" instead of "you'll receive your policy packet in the mail." That's the root issue with captive. Regarding strictly comp, having to buy leads isn't fun. I don't do warm market. Look a few years down the line if you're producing even low six figures in AP, paying \$50-80 per lead at ~100% commission sounds a lot more fun than 40% with some marginal guarantee and no lead spend. It boils down to being able to help the client and your goals and risk tolerance."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vz10ku/why_does_captive_get_so_much_hate_verses_brokerage/p61bv2i/

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

Uplines, managers and recruiters who misled them · 19 documents

"NEVER work or get life/health through Globe Life 🌐 Worst recruiting experience I have ever had, didn't help with getting license at all, lead me on for weeks, paid everything out of pocket, had to have gallbladder removed right after starting and they told me to kick rocks. Just got off the phone with regional manager yelling and cussing me and they told me because I missed part of training and had a second job (security night shift) that I wasn't committed enough and should go to a flack that "committed" agents are a dime a dozen and they could hire any loser to fill my spot they didn't need me. I have 15+ years sales management and experience I even was on finals for the next great American speak off and I get treated like another entry level sales rep. Even in training they were more focused on the sale rather than the customer. I got into life/health to help people not suffer the same fate I did due to having an emergency hip replacement last year in May. It ruined me financially and cost me my business in adventure tourism. I just wanted to spread knowledge on the importance of coverage and actually get customers what they need, not just get their money for my own benefit like Globe Life's primary focus. I'm just pissed right now, dumped money I really couldn't afford at the time on the things I needed to be successful, the class, the license, everything and for nothing. Now I don't even know what to do with this license because 99% of the recruiters I talk to are still just wanting people for MLM crap or straight up scams. Just wanted to rant, if anyone sees this that is legit contact me. If you put me in a position to take EVERY contract from my local globe life offices I will make it my personal mission to take their business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/

↳ Expert-Difficulty605 (7): "I worked business 2 business for 5 months and for me I was miserable. I made the switch to med Insurance for seniors and for me it's been night and day. I feel like I'm truly helping helping people who get lost in the shuffle"

↳ Unhappy_Corgi_6838 (6): "Sorry to hear about your experience. I recently got my life/health license through Bankers life and I'm having a similar experience. Haven't even made a prospect call yet and can't even sell until I do a 3-day training class 2 hours away from my home. It looks like the Insurance job market (really every industry) is filled with MLM companies and low paying call center contract jobs."

↳ katieintheozarks (6): "I was with Bankers Life for 2 weeks and quit in part because of their hard sell system and cold calls. Also I explicitly asked for work at home and then I was told I wouldn't be able to work at home. I interviewed six different places and landed with symmetry which is completely work at home and the outside leads are amazing. Jump ship. Every other company I interviewed with was better than Bankers Life."

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell off the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

↳ pdxoss (6): "I hate MLM too but if someone is making 100k and paying for leads/gas, taxes etc. Their take home isn't 40%. They're going to write off marketing expenses, gas, and everything they can on taxes"

↳ coreyjacrispy (5): "Haha, not specifically, they are are a known MLM company though. Them, Primerica, Symmetry etc etc. Anytime they're trying to force the Kool aid down your throat, with generic phrases and lectures like "You can take this and be BIG man, BIG...you want to have complete financial freedom? Be on your own clock? WE give you the tools to do that! We are a family, and want everyone to succeed" Blah blah blah lol, rest assured knowing they are indeed a MLM company."

↳ Tahoptions (3): ">How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. That is only for simplified products like final expense and mortgage protection. Street is no where near 120% for most traditional products. It is much closer to 85-100% (for term/GUL/IUL) and even lower for permanent products from big mutuals like Guardian and Mass. The post is a good warning though."

"I watched the FX vid that was posted here and he talked about a rogue agent writing 40k of bad business and fleeing the country. My Assurant regional manager told me a better one. Assurant came out with a feature where if an app was instantly approved - meaning the second you submitted the app it was approved without any UW, you got 12 months advanced commission. What could go wrong? A new agent signed up his entire network of friends. They chose the most expensive plans, listed zero health conditions and all were auto-approved, earning him \$48,000 in commissions. His friends all then cancelled the policies during the 10 day free look. His MGA apparently didn't think it was a flag that a new agent wrote that much in two weeks. Every dime was charged back to the MGA who had to file BK over it and the agent went off to Mexico."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/n1b228/

Clients who get angry when they are called · 16 documents

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** – How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** – How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** – How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kfmhbp/8_tips_for_new_agents_to_sell_insurance/

↳ hawkwood76 (11): "Love it. I will only add If it isn't on our calendar, it doesn't exist."

↳ CGWInsurance (5): "Congrats on doing this for new agents. Extremely well written. I would have put thick skin at either 1 or 2. Seen many leave this industry who rocked everything, but just took everything that was said to them personally and they had to quit for their own mental health."

↳ DavidDuford (2): "Appreciate it. Selling insurance or doing something totally performance-based is not for the faint of heart."

"Main reason I got out of Medicare. I had nightmares about those garbage food/flex cards. I would have people literally cussing me out to get a \$10 increase in their welfare, I give them what they ask and then they say "Its not worth it for such a little increase." I had a soft spot for elderly people, not anymore, they are some major A-holes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7vk9p/

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/] (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/) I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. when I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \-sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircj1/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent/

↳ Jonfers9 (14): "Congrats. It's funny you say you're good at what you do...you'll look back in 5 years and think man I didn't know anything back then."

↳ kevymetal87 (9): "A lot of the people knocking Bankers Life (myself included) do so because it's typically not setup for proper success for individuals. Churn and burn. That being said, like any other line of business/industry, there are always some good agents who will help you sincerely, and it sounds like you found one."

↳ Ok-Philosophy-3743 (8): "As in things only get better from here?"

Other agents: poaching, bad actors and the reputation · 6 documents

"Have agencies starting out new agents on aged leads even care about FDNC lists? I had to make a post about this because I used to be in these shoes. Given a list of couple hundred aged leads that were super cheap with no clue about FDNC. After building an agency and going through process of getting compliant leads it makes sense why agencies continue the easy route with cheap aged leads. Instagram ads I'm seeing are about the roadmap with new agents but most of these aged leads are all FDNC and new agents are getting screwed. These 18-19 year olds so excited for a new career just to be hit with a lawsuit or carrier violation because their agency set them up with non-compliant aged lead sheets. So many agencies could be doing right and not trying to make a quick dollar. There is a reason financial service/ insurance industry gets a bad rap when this is how you onboard new agents. When will it end with the bad apples that give this industry a bad rap?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1w0xb6x/have_agencies_starting_out_new_agents_on_aged/

↳ jroberts67 (2): "I guess the question I have, is when a customer requests a quote, there's fine print that allows agents to call them - so the question is how long are they allowed to be called."

↳ Spare-Package-2243 (1): "Before purchasing them try to scrub them through Federal or National Do not call list and then pay them for rest of leads."

"Thats not a lead vendor, Thats a criminal accomplice! marketing companies are not allowed to take personal client information give quotes etc... What you just described is **not** Lead generation. Its marketed as "pre sold policies by shady dudes in facebook groups" and its illegal.. If an agent doesnt know that they deserve to lose their license. There is no way this was suprising to him. he knew what was happening.. he paid more for this "service" specially because he is Lazy..... There are in fact marketing companies that want to sell legitimate CMS/ carrier compliant leads and inbound calls. They do exist. You never interact with them because you are a professional litagtor on the DNC list . Legitimate companies pay money for subscriptions like this <https://www.dnc.com/dncscrub/> and make api calls to stay DNC compliant. Those same API calls check Professional Litagtor lists, which you are likely on..Any one who can afford \$300 per month and knows how to call an API will make sure they never call you. The only marketing companies you ever interact with are the Bad ones... here is the medicare manuals <https://www.cms.gov/medicare/health-drug-plans/managed-care-marketing/medicare-guidelines/> As you can see this is COMPLICATED. Many Insurance brokers choose to outsource marketing because there is a lot of rules to follow here. Some companies Aka "third party" marketing companies offer a legitimate service to insurance brokers , allowing them to legally outsource marketing.. just like very other industry. Some agents do get decieved by shady companies. many dont even think to ask marketers , "how do you check DNC /TCPA? how do you generate leads or data? "what qualifications do you use to turn data into a lead? how many people are you selling this data to? What lliability do you have regarding DNC/TCPA violations? These are all legitimate questions any legitimate marketer will have no problem answering.. Keep up being a professional litagtor. get the Bad apples out of the lindustry. you should put up a you tube channel like Coffeezilla. I bet it would be more entertaining the most insurance indusry content.. i think it would be helpful for a lot of agents if you posted content of this stuff. Its the dark underbelly that many agents never see.. they get pitched an offer thats too good to be true.. and well it is..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nl7wbo/another_reason_not_to_trust_lead_brokerstbird/nf78cv7/

"I see lots of comments about people's goals to sell so many APPS per day. Don't you get paid based on ENROLLMENTS? Is an APP an ENROLLMENT? There aren't any agents out there explaining the difference between a quote, an app, and an enrollment. Step 1 for the customer is to get QUOTES, then COMPARE PLANS, before ever APPLYING or ENROLLING for anything. Unscrupulous agents are starting applications for people who never asked for one, when the agent hasn't even given them prices and companies to compare. Looks like a racket. It's tough enough for first time customers to figure everything out, without having to clean up the messes of dishonest agents who seem to just want to be first....to beat other agents to the punch and pocket that commission. Their licenses should be revoked."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=Ugzl2ERN5LAeigkORJN4AaABAq>

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

Theme	Documents
What the recruiter, trainer or upline told them	28
'Don't buy leads, generate your own'	22
'It's a numbers game'	18
'The money is in the renewals / your book'	12
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What the recruiter, trainer or upline told them · 28 documents

"Just got fired Got fired from my first insurance job because after 2 weeks i didnt make them enough money. I told them i did exactly what they told me to do in the trainings. And i had also told them that i have never sold before. But he didnt care. Literally in the training he told me "i want you to say this word for word". BUT HERE I AM. What do i do? Obviously besides get another job i already know that. I did sell, but now i wont have access to marX or sunfire which is what i used to do all this with. Just wondering what i should, how all that works. How does it work to be a independent agent? We sold medicare plans"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 92 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oezwib/just_got_fired/

↳ mythic_dot_rar (56): "Two weeks is insane so either they're crazy or there's something you aren't telling us. Either way, you're kind of boned for this AEP because all of the carriers are in their blackout period (meaning you can't switch uplines until January) and they'll probably drag their heels on getting you released. You should reach out to your MAPD carriers and at least submit a request for release right now to get the 3 or 6 month process or whatever it is going."

↳ itsalyfestyle (17): "Brutal. Unfortunately you won't get another job selling Medicare until January Name and shame the agency"

↳ itsalyfestyle (15): "Yea there's a blackout period during AEP so you won't be able to transfer your contracts until next year."

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

↳ SHURP (14): "I'm was actually thinking about finding a property and casualty specific subreddit. It hadn't even dawned on me till I saw the posts here that people actually view life and health in the same vein. I hate to sound like a purist or something but due to the way health and life insurance in American works, I feel like it's crazy to call any of the programs that isn't single payer, anything but MLM."

↳ Samwill226 (6): "I'd like a Reddit for just P&C Agents (no consumer questions there's plenty of that already). There's so much confusion on what someone is talking about sometimes you get an answer and its a life person thinking you are talking about life policies. I would like to be able to talk just to folks I can relate to."

↳ malachi347 (5): "did you ever find or make one? I'd love to be a part of a community like that as well. can't stand life/group med.. or personal lines for that matter heh"

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

'Don't buy leads, generate your own' · 22 documents

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/

↳ zb0324 (33): "If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

↳ TheMatthewMurray (18): "This is good. I use the method called "Mimic it, Master it, Make it your own." However, copying and pasting will work for awhile, but understanding why ads work is fairly important. That way you're not constantly copying. When something goes wrong is when, people don't know how to fix it."

↳ Randomdeath (16): "did you just post Well thought out and simple strategies for success? Sacralige I say"

"I would say this is pretty accurate. I've been in the life insurance business since 2015 . I don't have any overhead and don't pay for leads . Id say I am pretty average and work about 30 hrs /week. strictly personally producing right now . I have 90% retention and make about 5k a month . I've had a team before and was making considerably more money but was putting in considerably more hours. I also have seen people in my company that are more motivated than me make 20k+ a month. I don't have a spouse or kids so working remotely is perfect and lets me travel all over and I enjoy taking time off to explore . For someone that is willing to put in the time and effort , life insurance is a great long term career . Just make sure you look into leads , chargebacks , and residuals when you interview with a company and be prepared to put in work ."

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 49 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgzvaarWYK3Ns1QxAWF4AaABAg>

↳ @MyPowerfulClips (4): "Where are you working where you don't pay for leads ?!"

↳ @patinamia (4): "how do you find clients without buying leads"

↳ @Lovebeyondfear1111 (0): "This is awesomeness !! Where do you see your career in the long run?"

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

↳ bigalien1 (28): "Sometimes the name gives it away"

↳ Diligent_Throat304 (8): "They should rename bullsh*tleads lol"

↳ jwf1126 (7): "You should have taken your own names advice or even gone full deep throat with a company name like that. Lead gen sucks but there are companies out there that will at least put a good faith effort and give you the time a day and have some successes"

'It's a numbers game' · 18 documents

"The Lifeboat Mentality The art of selling is truly an art, and guess what, it's something that every single one of us needs to master - fast. I'm going to get the first, and what I think is the most important step out of the way immediately: **Stop trying to sell *products* and start selling *yourself*** When I first started, I always had this question in my sales experience: Why is it that one guy has extreme success selling the same product, and another guy doesn't? Let me tell you about a time when I sold life insurance that completely changed the way I sell, and will sell for the rest of my life. So, I got hired at a huge brokerage in Florida. We were contracted with 40+ different insurance agencies to market and sell their products. I had to be licensed to sell annuities, medicare products, health insurance, prescription drug packages, and life insurance. So, needless to say we had an **ARSENAL** of products to choose from. During the orientation, we were greeted by the companies top salesman. The idea was for him to come in and share his success, and answer any questions us newbies may have before we ventured out on our own. It came about time for him to come speak, and in my head I'm thinking some young 20-something was going to bolt through the door with excitement and enthusiasm. Wrong. In walks a 60-year old retired war-veteran who had been crushing the insurance game in this company for the last year, month after month! His annualized premium average was close to \$26,000 per month. (This is the amount of Premiums people that he sold to were paying on a monthly basis. He not only receives residuals off of this, sometimes he'll even receive a 90-95% commission off of the first-year premium total - If they pay \$100 per month, he receives around \$1000) I couldn't believe it. But, me transitioning from shock to understanding, I began to listen to him. His success was no secret. He literally worked "harder" than everyone else. His military mentality came into play big time in this field. Why? He would knock on 30 doors per day. Non stop, wake up at 7am, and not go home until 5pm, or until he successfully spoke to 30 people. His strength was in his numbers. Law of averages! If he got a "No." he wouldn't waste a second, bat an eye, or fold. He knew his power was in his ability to talk to as many people as possible. Day after day, same mentality: Do it, or die. (Not to that extent, but you get the idea!) **Takeaway One: Understand the law of averages, and commit to it!** However, although we had an arsenal to sell from, I became completely overwhelmed because it seemed impossible to take in all of the product specs and legalities, all while trying to create a smooth sales pitch. So, instead of focusing on things I didn't know, I just focused on one of the many things I could sell that would give me the best chance at success: life insurance. I modeled the success of the older salesman, and knocked door to door to offer our product relentlessly. But, door to door sales isn't as easy as it seems. Actually, it doesn't seem easy at all. Think about it. Have you ever bought anything from someone who randomly walked up to your door trying to sell something to you? The idea is crazy. But, it works. Numbers game. Same with cold calling, and same with any service. The idea is to put yourself in a position to collide your product with a consumer in demand, at the time they have made up their mind to purchase. If they haven't made up their mind to purchase, it's your job, as a salesman to help them. But, knowing how crazy this idea is, I had to separate myself and treat people as if they were my friends. I didn't come across as pushy, I came across as informative, and very confident - I adopted the **Life Boat Mentality** The Life Boat Mentality is simple: Your customers are drowning. They are drowning from poor quality products or services. You see them drowning in these products or services, and paddle on over in your Lifeboat. The idea is this: With impeccable trust, of course, you persuade your client to get in your life boat. Your life boat is the "best" option. And if it's not the best option, you need to find a company that offers the best option and sell that. (I'm not about selling garbage - Honestly) If you truly in your heart believe that what you are selling is the best option, the Lifeboat Mentality will help you tremendously. For example. I own a small residential repaint company now. I've taken the Lifeboat Mentality with me throughout my entire duration owning a business. I've got the branding where I want it, I have the production where it needs to be, and the Lifeboat mentality that I carry with me says this: Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. How do I ensure that this remains true? How do I have the confidence to pitch this? Because as the business owner, I insure it. My sales process is down to a science and has clear concise wording, professional formatting, and a great follow-up procedure. We have references and a great website for them to visit, and provide insurance and legal information up front. I ensure that I will be at each job to make sure that our quality of service is exactly as promised. In other words, I'm showing them that I "me", the "salesperson" am the lifeboat! It may seem silly at first, but think of yourself as a lifeboat. Start saving people! Happy selling! P.S if you're interested in knowing more about the painting business, feel free to PM me I'd be happy to answer any questions you may have!"

— r/sales · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/7tph4u/the_lifeboat_mentality/

↳ krimpenrik (8): "Exactly how i sold used cars. After 10 years it was easy to see that a lot of times they buy the car from you because they trust you instead of a cheaper car at a competitor. I wasn't a sleek guy all dressed up. Often with a oil stained Polo because I was helping out in the garage. It doesn't matter, even helps to gain trust"

↳ JDogNumeroUno (5): "> Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. This is Brilliant! Very much like Jay Abraham, well done!"

↳ [deleted] (4): "Thanks for the great post!"

"The shxty part is most agencies teach their agents it's a numbers game while they sell you over priced aged leads. Then you're outside all day chasing shxx leads like an axxhole and then they give you poor sales training. My advice is to master reframing and tonality. Get those two aspects down and fine tune your pitch and you'll increase your close rate. I been there and it honestly was horrible. Left and got into AI SaaS but if i had to do it again I'd master those two aspects first. Also remember Chase compassion, not commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ueswou/i_fully_respect_the_hustle_that_is_insurance/otmgwyw8/

"Great video. Could you possibly make a video discussing how to get better response rate for leads. I have leads coming in, but they never pickup / say they aren't interested before we even start talking. Is it just a numbers game?"

— YouTube · Day In The Life Of A Life Insurance Agent (Work From Home) · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D8Uca74uodA&lc=Ugwynpxo6VmZ3oylODh4AaABAg>

↳ @AdvancedAgentMarketing (1): "Yeah definitely, have you seen our video about Kixie?"

↳ @joego9851 (0): "@AdvancedAgentMarketingI will have to find it and check it out again."

↳ @eastcoastdevereaux7154 (0): "Same! Very frustrating"

'The money is in the renewals / your book' · 12 documents

"Possible complaint being filed against me. I am an independent life and health Insurance agent who may be having a complaint filed against me from a former client of mine. I have hundreds of clients enrolled in ACA plans (marketplace, Obamacare) and this person was one of them. He was enrolled in a plan and opted into automatic renewal. The plan was renewed and he called me back saying he was never aware his plan was renewed, because he was requiring a 1095 form to file his taxes. He called the marketplace and they told him to "file a complaint" against the agent. I have a recently recorded call where I told him he opted in for the automatic renewal and he didn't negate against it. I do have E&O insurance as well. I would never enroll a customer without their consent, I am just worried about what will happen next. He is losing \$1800 on his tax return due to him being enrolled in this plan, but it's not my fault. Any advice would be greatly appreciated, thank you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1c7go61/possible_complaint_being_filed_against_me/

↳ Stratosto3 (8): "Provide CMS with the info. Unfortunately they ARE cracking down, and you being independent means the heat goes to you. Explain to CMS that you have audio with explicit consent. He will then have to prove that he did not know, which you have consent to. That's your best solution. Make sure it's done by email if possible, any paper trail matters tremendously. You have no need to speak with the client in question, if you were wondering. Let CMS handle it. Sooner or later you will have this happen, mostly due to the clients being aloof during their own enrollment and not answering questions when you ask them if they have any."

↳ Stratosto3 (6): "There's no need to. If you did the income correctly and he didn't update it, then that's on him."

↳ [deleted] (5): "Don't sweat it! You've done nothing wrong. These complaints are filed all the time and 95% of them are found to be baseless. I know it's nerve wracking and it's not a good feeling but the truth is if you do this for any length of time you will eventually get a complaint filed against you. I have been through it myself and after providing all forms of documentation and being forthright and open with the claims investigator who is just doing their job, the claim was closed and found to be baseless. Believe me when I tell you that there are actual cases of malice and this certainly isn't one. You have not done anything wrong and you have it all on record. You're going to be fine."

"Yes, but years 1 & 2 are solid working years (build a base for renewals) in health expect about 40-60k in new business, (money to you). This is health insurance, my niche is Medicare and I love it. By year 5 you should be somewhere near 200k annually (gross) with renewals and new clients. Oh, and I don't really work that hard, if I did my numbers would be double..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/pkdfdw/independent_insurance_agent_a_viable_career/hc6m3ct/

"I'm yet to find a decent lead vendor in many years in health. Best way is to build your book with referrals - like really be a good person to your clients, then when OEP/AEP get closer, you gotta ask those clients for referrals. Every once in a while, I'll try a new lead company and sometimes it works out but typically, the leads get worse and worse over time (that's their business model in many cases), so it becomes not worth the time or money."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/np07fdj/

'Read the contract: who owns your book?' · 11 documents

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ads on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through (carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imos start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344555>

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

Tab 5 — Frustrations

Theme	Documents
Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer	124
Prospects who ghost, no-show or already have an agent	60
Carriers: non-commissionable plans, cuts and service	49
Bait-and-switch marketing ('free' benefits, 'free' policies)	46
TCPA, consent and do-not-call exposure	40
FMOs and uplines that own the book or won't release	40
What a lead costs against what a sale pays	30
MLMs and captive agencies that recruit on promises	28
CMS rules and commission caps	26
Inbound calls and transfers from offshore call centers	18
No training: all recruiting, no selling	15
Chargebacks and clawbacks	9
Dialing all day for a handful of conversations	9
Clients poached or switched by call centers and other agents	7

Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer · 124 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"Be prepared for the phone apocalypse Apple dropped the hammer on all unsolicited calls. With the iOS 26 update in September, no calls will automatically go through unless their in your contacts. Instead, the person calling will have to state their name and the reason for the call. That will show up as a text and the caller decides whether or not to allow the call. Here's a demo: <https://youtu.be/4yFDvgEjciQ?feature=shared> Apple owns 60% of the market. If other phone manufacturers and even carrier follow, it's possible we see day where cold calling has died. This will have a direct, negative effect on leads, especially shared leads. Be prepared."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/

↳ Pneuma_LooT (32): "Id say 90 to 95% of people do not answer phone calls anyways. Its not until they receive a text and set up a time to talk that they respond. This is what the industry has become the last few years for whatever reason."

↳ Madeanaccountforyou4 (25): "Google Pixel phones have had this since 2018"

↳ SilentFlames907 (15): "Then I guess agencies will actually have to provide us with viable leads?"

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

↳ loan2you (6): "What IMO did you join since?"

↳ Will-Adair (6): "I work with Symmetry. I like it as an independent IMO. I buy only new leads generated in real time so that doesn't line with my experience. Value leads range from weeks to years. I've never seen a value lead over 3 years old. Culture does depend what agency you're with, sounds like you were in a bad one. I've owned my business for 3.5 years so not sure what happened wherever you were at. Conferences are optional but beneficial. Again sounds like your experience is much different than mine and I'm going on year four. How long were you there? National has descent training and good agencies have their own too, we have for over a year. Sorry your experience stunk. Did you reach out to corporate and use their mediation team? Even if that door is closed reach out because corporate may be able to help train your former up-lines. Alignment is key. Glad you found a better solution for you."

↳ OPlathome (3): "I work with Symmetry as well and I agree with Will. What owner you're with matters, and not all teams are built equally. I get tons of support and training, and I do pretty well even with the older d-e leads."

Prospects who ghost, no-show or already have an agent · 60 documents

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

"Warning: Globe Life Zuzick I was "hired" by these people after watching a prerecorded video and waiting for 45 minutes in an empty breakout room. Red flags from the beginning. I went through with getting my license that week and scheduled for a group training call. Towards the end of the call, the leader was explaining how we must respect the CEOs time and must have the contracts signed BEFORE he talks to us and welcomes us to the team. She then gives us a 7 page contract and less than 5 minutes to sign. Everyone signs without reading. I tried to read thru it before he joined, but didn't make it. She called me out on the call saying they're still waiting on me. I just turned my cam off and kept reading. Pressuring kids into signing a contract is super unethical and should be illegal. I knew I would find nuggets of garbage after this pressure. Sure enough, I did. The only reason why I was going to let them take 70% of my commission was because they said they provided leads for free. Funny, the contract says: we do not guarantee that you will receive any leads. I also was wondering how no one has ever written poorly of this branch online. There was a clause in there that says you may not say anything negative about our company once signed. Is that even allowed? I ghosted them and have been getting spammed with emails and texts as if I am still with them. Sad to see, taking advantage of people in desperate times."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1muj1p8/warning_globe_life_zuzick/

↳ roberts67 (6): "Glad you sussed them out and didn't sign. And non-disparagement clauses are "barely" legal and rarely enforceable. For companies like this, free leads are typically aged leads."

↳ Livid-Acadia6078 (3): "I worked for them for like 3 months, it was a mess. Glad you dodged a bullet"

↳ Foreign_Advisor_7573 (3): "Kudos to you for standing your ground and being smart about it. Contracts -- some clauses are there to send you a scary legal letter threatening legal action by citing contract violation. You'd be surprised how many IMOs/agencies have appealingly bad contracts; you'd think you're signing your life and your keen away, not basic contractor agreement. Edit: free leads. Those will usually be very, very old, and worked through by many, many agents. Words like exclusive, premium, etc. mean nothing. How old is the lead, how many other agents have it, and how it was generated is what matters. So if recruiter won't answer those questions or give generic answers, the free leads they offer are worth little to nothing and not worth a bulk of your comp."

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

↳ Neither-Historian227 (19): "I had a dozen death threats during the pandemic when government locked everyone down and destroyed their businesses, this is cake walk"

↳ NovelMotor7972 (13): "Are you kidding me?I deal with crazy people for a living. Lol I've literally had people misstate their income on a recorded line, make a complaint against me to the office of financial regulation, and cause a whole ordeal over their own tax penalty, because they misstated their income. I learned my lesson, every single one of them signs a disclosure that this is the income that they are stating."

↳ BroWeBeChilling (12): "It wears on youafter ten years I have heard it all. About 20% of the people are always unhappy. This has worn on me everyday especially since most people don't take responsibility for not paying their bills, their bank made a mistake, they never got a notice in the mail or to their email. Then they take it out on me. I try brushing it off but for sure after one heart attack my life is shortening everyday."

Carriers: non-commissionable plans, cuts and service · 49 documents

"Let's remember what selling health was like pre-ACA Before 2010, I was running a rather large individual health insurance agency. Jan 2010 literally put me out of business overnight as commissions evaporated. I looked at my wife and said "well, this all needed to change." Commission rocked. 25% average on the front, 5% renewals on average. \$400/mo premium = \$1,200. Market was everyone that didn't have group. We could even pull people off group. Although highly unethical, it happened all the time. 1. Declines for all major health conditions. Diabetes? Decline. Heart? Decline. 2. Ratings or waivers/riders for every other health condition you can imagine. HBP, Asthma, etc...rated 25% to 50% or the condition was excluded from coverage. Some more mild conditions might have only resulted in a drug waiver. 3. Post claims underwriting. No carrier pulled medical records or MIB reports. Instead, they waited until they filed a claim. Any misrepresentation on the app resulted in either a denial of that claim or a policy rescission. For auto, imagine no one checked anything; no DMV report, didn't run their license and only did that when they went to file a claim, then cancelled the policy. 4. Fraud was everywhere. Agents knew they wouldn't get paid for putting conditions/meds on the app, so they excluded them. I was trained by Mega Life to never list health conditions. Tough conversations with newly self-employed people. Many simply could not get covered. People who had direct control over their health, like smokers I had little sympathy for. People with conditions out of their control? Horrible phone calls."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/

↳ roberts67 (43): "Some of my calls went like this: "I'm sorry but due to your health conditions you'll be denied coverage." "That's fine, I'll call another agent." "There are 8 health insurance carriers in MD and I write for all of them. It's a decline for all of them." "So what do I do now, I don't have access to group." "You'd have to find a job that offered group health." "I run a business." "You'd have to close it down and get a job." "....really." "Yes, really. To anyone here who wants a ACA repeal and to go back to the way it was, if you're self employed and on any meds or have any conditions, you're ass out."

↳ Brown_Car1987 (29): "I reminded a client of this not that long ago. She was espousing repealing the ACA, and has been fighting cancer for years. When I reminisced about the old days of declined apps for med history, she didn't know what to say. People who were covered by employer plans then have no idea what happened if you wanted to retire before 65."

↳ Brown_Car1987 (16): "Sounds familiar. And retiring "early"? Don't think so. Marketplace isn't perfect, but it definitely solved several problems."

"RIP to Wellcare Wellcare decided to screw over their agents yesterday. They announced that they are terminating all agents for Medicare drug plans at the end of the year, and cutting all commissions for both new and renewal business. Allegedly this was live at a national conference and they were LITERALLY booed off the stage. It feels awfully salty that they offered some of the best plans in the market for 2 years in a row, bought the business, and are now cutting out all their agents. Thankfully we only have hundreds of clients to move, but I know some massive agencies that have thousands. We'll lose less than 2% of revenue, but we're done with Wellcare for good."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ezltc7/rip_to_wellcare/

↳ [deleted] (17): "They will come back to hire you. They think that they can sell online, and they are about to find out that this is not the case."

↳ NAF1138 (11): "It looks like Humana and UHC are about to get a LOT of new PDP customers"

↳ Itschmit (8): "Every company has the right to giveth and taketh away. But I agree it's just unethical bad business"

"Why aren't we talking about commission cuts? I've been lurking here for a while, and like many others, I've been considering getting licensed to sell health insurance. I've noticed there are *a ton* of weekly posts asking "Should I get into insurance?" and most of the responses are really positive and encouraging. But what surprises me is what's **NOT** being discussed much: **#1 Major carriers are cutting commissions or removing them entirely.** Here are some examples: * **United Health Care** will stop paying commissions on 100+ Medicare Advantage plans and all PDPs in over 20 states starting July 1, 2025. The NAIFA denounced UHC's decision to cut agent commissions. * **Aetna** is withdrawing from the ACA marketplace and slashing commissions after 2025. * **Cigna, Centene, Elevance (Anthem)** are all making similar moves. **#2 The recent passing of the new "Big Beautiful Bill"**. From what I can tell, these are pretty major shifts and could seriously impact how agents make a living going forward. Yet almost none of this shows up in the "how do I start" threads. Why? So, I wanted to ask more directly: * Why isn't there more discussion about these changes here? Is the impact overstated, or are we just not seeing the effects *yet*? * Do veteran agents think ACA/Medicare will still be viable long-term? * Should newcomers treat this as a full-time career or more of a side hustle moving forward? * How are current agents planning to adapt in the next 5-10 years? Genuinely curious. I'm not trying to be negative. I'm just surprised there isn't more open talk about what seems like some pretty big red flags for the industry. Would love to hear what those of you already in the trenches think. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/

↳ jroberts67 (17): "A solid career in insurance is either P&C or life products. Although I've seen a lot of talk (licensed since 2003) about the "wild riches" of Medicare, I've never seen it. That's not to say no one has built a solid career selling supps, just an extremely small percentage. Health insurance died Jan 1st 2010."

↳ brightladdy (12): "Overall there's just less chatter about Medicare here. I feel like majority of users in this sub are P&C agents, followed closely by the MLM Life Insurance folk. Could just be a demographic thing. Reddit users tend to be of the younger generations and maybe the majority of Medicare reps are all chatting in those cesspool Facebook groups."

↳ voidsarcastic (11): "United is simply restructuring and will release new plans for AEP. Obviously they were hit hard, notice they only decommissioned the extremely affordable PPOs going forward... that's because they don't want you to sell any more of them and they can't just release plan changes mid year. And you are talking about commission cuts when we were just announced a 10% increase in MAPD renewals and Initials for 2026. There are lots of carriers dying to throw agents money.... And new carriers are still getting in the game and expanding every year, which is a good sign. I agree it is a little unstable right now, but for agents that is a good thing. Medicare and ACA aren't going anywhere. And if they do, you have an entire book to convert to the new thing."

Bait-and-switch marketing ('free' benefits, 'free' policies) · 46 documents

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips ☺"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

↳ UnfairFloor3347 (25): "My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

↳ [deleted] (13): "I looked into it and they were very expensive in my opinion. Plus it's usually some room full of very hungry people in the Philippines or someplace like that bullying people through a script and that could turn out to be a waste of time in many cases. So I bought the call list myself with certain parameters I set according to people of the ages that typically are thinking about life insurance (because they typically still have people they feel the need to provide for unlike Mrs Jones at 69 years old whose kids are all in their 40s and whose husband is typically dead. I figure if people get to their 60s or older and still have absolutely no final expense coverage it's usually either because they don't see the necessity of it or they just can't afford it. Sure there are exceptions to that but they're exceptions. That brought me to my other parameter of 40K plus income, people that can actually pay the premium. The way I see it I'll just call them myself and I'll be very direct. I won't tell them I'm a "benefits coordinator" or any other BS line. I'll flat out tell them I sell life insurance and if they have about 2 minutes I'd like to give them a quote and that if they like the price I'll come by and we'll do the paperwork in person and they can take out the policy. Then I'll tell them that I'll make no attempt to talk them into buying anything they don't want or can't afford. Then I'll pause for a second. They'll either let me quote them or they won't and then I'll move on down the list. No shady practices at all. Some people will appreciate that and may actually buy a policy. Some won't. Either way I won't feel smarmy and I won't waste several hours and x amount of money on gas driving all over the place trying to talk to people that don't want to talk to me anyway and probably have no intention of buying anything."

↳ Deadly3ffect (12): "I always hated this. "34 year agent and I've never used leads." Back when people would walk into your office to get an insurance policy. Fucking shocker, you started before anyone used the internet. By the time the industry changed you were already established. What you started with is completely different to what the insurance industry is now. Sorry, that shit seriously pisses me off. All these old timers are sitting below me on the monthly sales because they have this outdated mindset. You want to sell insurance? Buy fucking leads."

"Main reason I got out of Medicare. I had nightmares about those garbage food/flex cards. I would have people literally cussing me out to get a \$10 increase in their welfare, I give them what they ask and then they say "Its not worth it for such a little increase." I had a soft spot for elderly people, not anymore, they are some major A-holes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7vk9p/

"What in the actual fuck is happening in this industry. (ACA) Overused milked leads, marketplace looking like a brothel, people being promised subsidy cards, free grocery cards, nothing short than being promised a free Mercedes-Benz which I'm sure someone has been already promised. That being said, a great company I'm with, but holy cow man, what an actual cess-pool of agents just circle jerking each other with ol miss Emmy Lou in Lagrange, Mississippi's market-place profile. Luckily I have a 80% closing ratio on getting them to lock me down as their agent for 365. I love it"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j5cd0g/what_in_the_actual_fuck_is_happening_in_this/

↳ DJSimmer305 (23): "Nothing better than starting an application for someone and getting a pop up on HealthSherpa "Warning: this customer may be working with 11 other agents""

↳ brightladdy (13): "It's ACA dude... of course it's going to be a cesspool"

↳ Vast-Gate8866 (12): "Worked my ass off as a independent for almost 4 years now. Living off residuals and kinda taking a break. I make sure I never miss a birthday or holiday though. Always making calls and mailing cards to keep them on the books. Honestly, it's amazing how much that makes a difference. Especially after flipping a client. So many "wham bam" agents out there, make the sale and their clients never hear from them again!"

TCPA, consent and do-not-call exposure · 40 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought *pre-sold leads* from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the *insurance carrier, not the agent*, for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (75): "Quitting insurance today and becoming a professional litigant Imao"

↳ InsuranceEvangelist (70): "New income stream unlocked..."

↳ DavidDuford (24): "For real =). I should start selling info-product courses on how to do it, and partner with a lawyer to do all the work. "Make an easy \$1500 a day with one simple trick.""

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2g/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

↳ BluebirdFast3963 (16): "Work for an independent that has the best prices in my province, so nothing. They come to me. We have 25 companies. Provide quick quotes, quick binds, quick service when they need something done to their policy. A variety of ways they can reach out. Retain most of my clientele year over year. Re-market my current clients if I need too. The way it should be. This lead factory head hunting, farming for clients you barely know and paying for someone to send you a list of numbers is wild to me - is this common in America? I think the Canadian industry is a bit different. I don't know anyone who has to buy leads. Seems like an awful way to retain a trustworthy client base. Is it just dog eat dog down there, constantly churning through clients or what?"

↳ registeredfake (9): "ive got to say, it does not matter what question is asked by anyone in this sub every one think the answer is Independent this independent that. OP is asking for marketing ideas, is already an agent where he has invested his time and money to build something and your first thought is to go independent. stupid"

↳ Armstrongs_ball (7): "Stop. Buying. Leads. Go independent, network, build your book of business by referrals and word of mouth. After a few years, you'll be living off your book of business and getting referrals left and right from clients, assuming you provide good service. Buying leads is literally the biggest waste of \$ in this industry and it's not even close. And good luck actually retaining those clients. They'll be the first to leave after their auto rate increases \$10/month of their first renewal."

"A few things: - Anyone you buy leads/calls from need to give you contract language specifically for this situation. - Litigators are 100% bad faith, this is how they "makes living". The upside is that between the "I paid for a live transfer and you'll need to talk to the company that drive the call" is valid - Litigators are lazy assholes. Best bet is to match their energy and say you will show up in court to litigate this. \$10k is the small claims limit in a few states. Some are \$5k and a few are higher. The MO is to file in SC, show up to the hearing and then get a judgement. That's why you should show up with a contract to give to the judge showing you are not responsible for this litigator doing what they're doing. That \$25k settlement is now Civil Court territory, meaning you need to retain representation... in other words, it's costs money. Call their bluff, show up to any SC hearing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mjv8uf0/

FMOs and uplines that own the book or won't release · 40 documents

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholmed" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

↳ Inner_Friendship5913 (2): "I just got my license in September and knew absolutely nothing about insurance. I started with Equis and had a very bad experience with my upline and felt like I was stuck with no one to teach me or train me. The top group person just blew smoke when I tried to get help so I left. I signed with Symmetry and I'm having a difficult time getting Equis to release me because they say they don't require it but Symmetry does require it. Symmetry has already started to get me started with other insurance carriers. I only had 5 with Equis. I have got no contracts with any carriers with Symmetry yet in my email but I know they started the process. BUT I was never told that I have to split my commissions 40%(me) and 60%(SME agent). I spoke to transamerica and Mutual of Omaha and they said I'd be penalized 90 days for ending the contract through Equis. So if I decide to not stay at Symmetry then that is even more insurance carriers that I'll be stuck waiting 90 days to work with again. I honestly have no idea where to go from here. I don't want to do all the work and a finalizing agent take 60% of my commissions. What company out there allows you to keep your commissions outside of the Small bit your upline gets? Or at least a fair amount?"

↳ RedditInsuranceGuy (1): "I would need to know what line of insurance you are talking about to get more specific. But basically its a standard wait of 6 months after a documented request of release from the contract for most carriers. Mutual of Omaha is pretty strict on that stuff. As far as what you do going forward is find an IMO that can fill the gaps with something competitive in the meantime while you process the releases and wait it out."

↳ Standard-Position698 (1): "I am in the process of trying to get a release/terminate contract. My up-line has refused to continue to reply and has removed me from all platforms and blocked me but will not release my contract."

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

↳ pdxoss (6): "I hate MLM too but if someone is making 100k and paying for leads/gas, taxes etc. Their take home isn't 40%. They're going to write off marketing expenses, gas, and everything they can on taxes"

↳ coreyjacrispy (5): "Haha, not specifically, they are are a known MLM company though. Them, Primerica, Symmetry etc etc. Anytime they're trying to force the Kool aid down your throat, with generic phrases and lectures like "You can take this and be BIG man, BIG...you want to have complete financial freedom? Be on your own clock? WE give you the tools to do that! We are a family, and want everyone to succeed" Blah blah blah lol, rest assured knowing they are indeed a MLM company."

↳ Tahoptions (3): ">How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. That is only for simplified products like final expense and mortgage protection. Street is no where near 120% for most traditional products. It is much closer to 85-100% (for term/GUL/IUL) and even lower for permanent products from big mutuals like Guardian and Mass. The post is a good warning though."

What a lead costs against what a sale pays · 30 documents

"Main reason I got out of Medicare. I had nightmares about those garbage food/flex cards. I would have people literally cussing me out to get a \$10 increase in their welfare, I give them what they ask and then they say "Its not worth it for such a little increase." I had a soft spot for elderly people, not anymore, they are some major A-holes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/tj8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7vk9p/

"HSAs and HDHPs Explained So you might've seen Dave Ramsey and other financial professionals throwing out the idea of HSAs and framing it like a secret hack to cheaper healthcare. With the rising health costs expected to come this OEP after the expiration of the famous subsidies, I was intrigued. As a licensed agent, I felt obligated to do a deep dive on this topic to see if all in all it is a better option for my clients. My findings are written in a blog style format below. *Yes it's long. It's an in-depth explanation so you can understand the full picture surrounding HSAs and HDHPs. Feel free to offer any corrections or suggestions in the comments.* With healthcare costs expected to hit all time highs, everyone from low income families and high income individuals are looking for a way out. The health insurance marketplace is a thick and complicated ungroomed jungle and without proper research and a solid understanding of all the acronyms and structures involved, your chances of affordable healthcare are pretty much non-existent. In these troubling times the financial and insurance gurus of social media have taken to the streets, or should I say screens, and are doing their best to educate their viewers on other options and structures when it comes to health insurance. One of the most popular alternative options being mentioned this year is a unique insurance structure called an HSA. **What the heck is an HSA?** An HSA, **Health Savings Account**, is a type of savings account that is tied to a HDHP, **High Deductible Health Plan**, that is said to work best for individuals on the extreme ends of the spectrum when it comes to insurance. What I mean by that is individuals or families who are either healthy and rarely use their insurance or ill and use their insurance heavily. The structure works as follows, the individual or family enrolls in a HDHP and then ties this HDHP to an HSA. Both the HDHP and HSA work to balance each other's cons and create an affordable health insurance option for these groups of people. Since the HDHP has a high deductible, it offers low premiums and pretty much complete coverage after the deductible and OOPM, out-of-pocket max, is hit. In order to help individuals meet this high deductible, the HDHP is paired with a tax free savings account known as an HSA. The individual can contribute extra savings, separate from their monthly premium, to this HSA completely tax free so that when it comes time to pay that high deductible, the accumulated funds in the HSA can be withdrawn to do just that. Using an HSA to pay down a high deductible is beneficial because individuals can invest tax free and avoid paying any income tax on funds used to pay high deductibles. **HSA Funds** Funds stored in a HSA are only allowed to be spent on qualifying medical expenses. Other than deductibles, HSA funds can be spent on a bunch of other things like copays, medicine like Advil and Pepto Bismol, and even contraceptives. HSA funds can only used to pay monthly premiums in special scenarios like paying for COBRA continuation coverage, while receiving unemployment benefits, or even some other unique circumstances. To make things easy, most HSA accounts come with their own debit card that can be used to pay for eligible expenses. Unused HSA funds rollover and are kept in the account pretty much indefinitely and most HSAs are interest bearing accounts. HSA withdrawals are completely tax-free and penalty-free as long as they are being used for eligible expenses. If you want to pull out the money for any other reason, you will be subject to a 20% penalty if you are under the age of 65. If you're over 65 you will still be taxed on the withdrawal as income. **Deposit Limits** An HSA, just like an IRA or 401K, has set annual contribution limits that are determined by your age and how many people are on your coverage. If your HDHP only covers yourself and no one else, your maximum annual contribution is capped at \$4,300. If your plan covers 2 or more people including yourself, the annual contribution is capped at \$8,550. Individuals at 55 years of age or older have an additional \$1,000 added to their maximum annual contribution per account, whether they are single individuals or under family coverage. Even contributions that are not made by you, such as employer contributions, are still counted under this contribution limit. Every dollar contributed over the max contribution limit is subject to both income tax, as it is not considered tax-free because it is over the limit, and a 6% penalty fee for every year that the excess of funds are left in the account. **Investing HSA Funds** After enrolling in an HDHP and fully maxing out your HSA, your HSA will become full of funds just waiting to be spent. What should you do? Well, what some financially savvy HSA owners like to do is invest the funds being held in their account. HSAs are great investment vehicles because they offer a triple tax advantage. This means that contributions, growth through investment or interest, and qualified withdrawals are all completely tax-free. It depends on the HSA provider but most offer investment options that can help put the sitting funds to work. Common options include stocks, bonds, mutual funds, ETFs, and more. Any gains realized within the account are tax-free but are still only allowed to be withdrawn for eligible medical expenses. **Does An HSA Actually Make Health Insurance Cheaper?** So is an HSA actually worth it? Let's do an experiment. I am going to compare quotes for 5 example applicants to determine whether they should choose an HDHP and HSA combo or stick to a normal Marketplace plan. The example applicant demographic are as follows: * **Single Applicant**, Age: **24**, Income: **\$22,000**, Name: **Tommy** * **Family of 2**, Ages: **41 and 43**, Income: **\$62,000**, Name: **Smith Family** * **Single Applicant**, Age: **51**, Income: **\$115,000**, Name: **Richard** * **Family of 3**, Ages: **6, 32, and 36**, Income: **\$42,000**, Name: **Willard Family** * **Family of 4**, Age: **16, 12, 52, and 57**, Income: **\$145,000**, Name: **Gonzalez Family** Please keep in mind that I am licensed in Florida and these quotes are coming from the Federally Facilitated Marketplace using my local zip code. These quotes may be different depending on what state you apply for coverage in. Also, quotes are subject to change, so even if you are in Florida these quotes still may not apply exactly. Since there are several options of each type of insurance, standard Marketplace and HDHP, available for every applicant, I went through and picked what I thought would be the best option out of the available plans. I ran these quotes on 10/21/25. With that out of the way, let's look at the numbers. <https://preview.redd.it/86z2kyzy9vwf1.png?width=981&format=png&auto=webp&s=e6b713046ca87d393814b817af99850e815f0862> **Findings & Summary** So after analyzing the numbers you can see that enrolling in an HSA eligible HDHP is never really the better option for anyone in this experiment. You could maybe make a case for Richard, the single applicant high earner demographic, depending on his priorities and plan usage but that's pretty much it. At least from the quotes I saw, both premiums AND deductibles end up being higher. Maybe you get a better out-of-pocket maximum but most people don't even come close to hitting their limit anyways so in my opinion it's not worth it. If you are enrolling in health insurance through the Federal Marketplace, I would not recommend you buy into the idea of an HSA if you are in the Florida area. That being said, I have no idea what other non-federal private insurer's HSA eligible quotes are so maybe there are some better options out there but from what I've seen, standard Marketplace plans seem to be the better option in this case. Again, to be clear, I am not saying that HSAs never work and you should always avoid them. Some employer options and private options might be awesome choices but if you are applying through the Federal Marketplace, I would just stick to the standard options. **Future Of HSAs and HDHPs** There are some pretty big changes coming to HSAs in 2026 that could really shake things up and make them much more useful. Starting on January 1st, 2026, all Bronze plans and Catastrophic ACA Marketplace plans will become HSA eligible opening up the power of HSAs to a new demographic for the first time. In the past these plans didn't hit the high deductible requirements to be HSA eligible under IRS rules but these rules are officially set to be changed. Also, contribution limits are expected to raise by an extra \$100 for individuals and an extra \$200 for families. This expanded eligibility looks like it's going to make HSAs much more competitive and accessible then ever before so be sure to ask your agent about your options and keep these upcoming changes in mind when shopping for plans."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oe3dky/>

↳ (0): "You can't make recommendations based on your state. Florida is a disaster zone for insurance of any type, including health insurance. I've been reading some stories of people getting their Florida Blue 2026 quotes, and being absolutely floored by the increases. You are also discounting the value of putting extra money into an HSA, which is not only a tax deduction (which will increase the subsidy!), but is forever tax-free. Also, every Bronze plan in 2026 will be HSA-eligible, so that changes the calculation for many people."

↳ (0): "As of now, I am only licensed in Florida so I can only offer advice for Florida residents. I put multiple disclaimers in the article saying all of these numbers come from Florida and they can be disregarded if you are outside of Florida. And to your point, yea FB increases have been pretty steep but it's looking like that's going to be the reality for everyone. Also, AmeriHealth Caritas is offering some pretty competitive plans for 2026 and I think with the right agent people will be able to at least tolerate the price increases. I am not discounting the value of putting extra tax free money into an HSA. But, if you live in Florida and are looking to get Marketplace coverage it really only makes sense for a small group of people. About the Bronze plans, thanks for offering that information, that is news to me. Let's hope HSAs becomes more affordable when they can be tied to bronze plans. From my understanding though, bronze plans are going to become HSA eligible because there deductibles are going to get out of control, is this right? Regardless it should help keep the premium down so I'm definitely going to redo this once this rule comes in place starting January 1st."

↳ (0): ">Other than deductibles, HSA funds can be spent on a bunch of other things like monthly premiums, Just wanted to point out that HSA funds *cannot be used for monthly premiums* unless it's while you're on COBRA or while you're receiving unemployment benefits so most people cannot use their HSA funds to pay their premiums."

"What lead vendors work for you? I'm a face to face final expense agent. I was using cheaper internet leads from integrity, social insurance leads, and leads direct. They aren't exclusive but they're anywhere from \$1-11 so I can get a lot of them, and if you dial enough you'll set up enough appointments. The ROI was great. As of recently though, they're just bad. And I've been with companies in the past that have had BAD leads before, I'm used to having to dial a lot and overcome objections, but this just isn't the way anymore. I've tried Facebook ads myself and I've come to the conclusion I'm just not a good marketer. It takes a lot of trial and error and time to figure it out so unless there's somewhere that'll give me a copy and pasted proven ad to post, I've decided it's not worth it. I'll take any recommendations on any direct mail or internet lead vendors. What works for you guys?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxcl1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/

↳ DavidDuford (5): "I'll second u/NAF1138 - just work direct mail leads. Aged direct mail leads can be great if you can find a quality distributor. Facebook leads can be good but you'll have a bunch more travel time to work them effectively."

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you sell face to face, you should ONLY work direct mail. All other lead types are only good for filler leads or telesales. There are lots of good direct lead vendors The Lead Connection Lead Concepts Need a Lead RGI Are some places to start."

↳ dis_iz_funny_shit (4): "I've got a direct face to face method for finding new leads in the field - mortgage protection leads — so the tool helps you find people in any area that just bought a home in the last few months. It helps you locate a phone number also about 60-70% of the time"

MLMs and captive agencies that recruit on promises · 28 documents

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGANT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making"\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

"NEVER work or get life/health through Globe Life 🌐 Worst recruiting experience I have ever had, didn't help with getting license at all, lead me on for weeks, paid everything out of pocket, had to have gallbladder removed right after starting and they told me to kick rocks. Just got off the phone with regional manager yelling and cussing me and they told me because I missed part of training and had a second job (security night shift) that I wasn't committed enough and should go to a flack that "committed" agents are a dime a dozen and they could hire any loser to fill my spot they didn't need me. I have 15+ years sales management and experience I even was on finals for the next great American speak off and I get treated like another entry level sales rep. Even in training they were more focused on the sale rather than the customer. I got into life/health to help people not suffer the same fate I did due to having an emergency hip replacement last year in May. It ruined me financially and cost me my business in adventure tourism. I just wanted to spread knowledge on the importance of coverage and actually get customers what they need, not just get their money for my own benefit like Globe Life's primary focus. I'm just pissed right now, dumped money I really couldn't afford at the time on the things I needed to be successful, the class, the license, everything and for nothing. Now I don't even know what to do with this license because 99% of the recruiters I talk to are still just wanting people for MLM crap or straight up scams. Just wanted to rant, if anyone sees this that is legit contact me. If you put me in a position to take EVERY contract from my local globe life offices I will make it my personal mission to take their business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/

↳ Expert-Difficulty605 (7): "I worked business 2 business for 5 months and for me I was miserable. I made the switch to med Insurance for seniors and for me it's been night and day. I feel like I'm truly helping helping people who get lost in the shuffle"

↳ Unhappy_Corgi_6838 (6): "Sorry to hear about your experience. I recently got my life/health license through Bankers life and I'm having a similar experience. Haven't even made a prospect call yet and can't even sell until I do a 3-day training class 2 hours away from my home. It looks like the Insurance job market (really every industry) is filled with MLM companies and low paying call center contract jobs."

↳ katieintheoark (6): "I was with Bankers Life for 2 weeks and quit in part because of their hard sell system and cold calls. Also I explicitly asked for work at home and then I was told I wouldn't be able to work at home. I interviewed six different places and landed with symmetry which is completely work at home and the outside leads are amazing. Jump ship. Every other company I interviewed with was better than Bankers Life."

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell off the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

↳ pdxoss (6): "I hate MLM too but if someone is making 100k and paying for leads/gas, taxes etc. Their take home isn't 40%. They're going to write off marketing expenses, gas, and everything they can on taxes"

↳ coreyjacrispy (5): "Haha, not specifically, they are are a known MLM company though. Them, Primerica, Symmetry etc etc. Anytime they're trying to force the Kool aid down your throat, with generic phrases and lectures like "You can take this and be BIG man, BIG...you want to have complete financial freedom? Be on your own clock? WE give you the tools to do that! We are a family, and want everyone to succeed" Blah blah blah lol, rest assured knowing they are indeed a MLM company."

↳ Tahoptions (3): ">How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. That is only for simplified products like final expense and mortgage protection. Street is no where near 120% for most traditional products. It is much closer to 85-100% (for term/GUL/IUL) and even lower for permanent products from big mutuals like Guardian and Mass. The post is a good warning though."

CMS rules and commission caps · 26 documents

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

↳ Samwill226 (38): "24/7 cell is going to be your downfall."

↳ Samwill226 (10): "You know what huge risk it really opens up? E&O. I've been in this a long time. I can't tell you how many E&O claims come from cell phone communications. It's a HUGE vulnerability"

↳ Samwill226 (8): "It really is a huge hole for a claim. I have clients find me on social media and send me a message on a Saturday night about a change or coverage question I won't even look at it or respond. You gotta protect yourself on your personal time because they'll throw you under the bus quick! "I called and told him....""

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

"Just giving an update. I followed your video and my ad has been up and running. So far I've generated 2 leads going on 48 hours set at 50.00 daily."

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFT03FiUCM&lc=UgzsHGMVmxVflzSg01N4AaABAg>

↳ @phylliskalu3442 (3): "I only recommend doing this if you have multiple states. I only have one state didn't generate enough leads."

↳ @amillionairerise (2): "@phylliskalu3442 what about the quality of leads?"

↳ @matthewjanssenAutoSavvy (0): "What state?@phylliskalu3442"

Inbound calls and transfers from offshore call centers · 18 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (75): "Quitting insurance today and becoming a professional litigator lmao"

↳ InsuranceEvangelist (70): "New income stream unlocked..."

↳ DavidDuford (24): "For real =). I should start selling info-product courses on how to do it, and partner with a lawyer to do all the work. "Make an easy \$1500 a day with one simple trick.""

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only receive direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Have you ever considered, you know, actually generating your own leads with community engagement in a niche market? Seriously... It works. I have done it for nine years. Wouldn't even know where to get a lead that was purchased if I tried. Also, thank God this is happening. The number of spam calls I get per day is undodly and they interrupt my actual calls from call waiting. It's horrible. I hope all the overseas scammers shrivel up and go back to the holes they came from. I am tired of trying to tell my mom that I did not go to Mexico and will never be kidnapped there, she does not have a tax debt, and her Amazon order doesn't exist. Most of the time she is fine, and sends me an 'lol you are not in Mexico getting robbed are you?' text. But I know the day is coming when that fails and I will be very grateful if it comes after this happens."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/mx7qq7x/

No training: all recruiting, no selling · 15 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C266&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtq3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

↳ loan2you (6): "What IMO did you join since?"

↳ Will-Adair (6): "I work with Symmetry. I like it as an independent IMO. I buy only new leads generated in real time so that doesn't line with my experience. Value leads range from weeks to years. I've never seen a value lead over 3 years old. Culture does depend what agency you're with, sounds like you were in a bad one. I've owned my business for 3.5 years so not sure what happened wherever you were at. Conferences are optional but beneficial. Again sounds like your experience is much different than mine and I'm going on year four. How long were you there? National has decent training and good agencies have their own too, we have for over a year. Sorry your experience stunk. Did you reach out to corporate and use their mediation team? Even if that door is closed reach out because corporate may be able to help train your former up-lines. Alignment is key. Glad you found a better solution for you."

↳ OPlathome (3): "I work with Symmetry as well and I agree with Will. What owner you're with matters, and not all teams are built equally. I get tons of support and training, and I do pretty well even with the older d-e leads."

"Senior Life offers a few different options. Expensive live transfers at \$70 a call. Discounted Facebook leads at \$10-\$15 a call. I'm a firm believer that you can be successful at any imo with any lead cost. The trick is that you have to get good at your craft before going broke. That is what nukes most agents. There is no shortcut. There is no magical lead. There is no magical training, there is no magical IMO. You have to put in a massive amount of Reps to get good at this. Once you sell your first 30-50 policies then start looking into higher cost marketing. I know you can do it, push yourself to do it. Keep your head up, you got this!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mygsmm0/

Chargebacks and clawbacks · 9 documents

"It is definitely a grind the first 2 years. Our path is slightly behind the other gentleman's. Year 1 was ugly, thankfully we had savings. Year 2 was easier and 3+ are much better. We are a health insurance agency that sells ancillaries and the odd life policies.: There are pros and cons to all areas of sales. For instance: life insurance has more chargebacks than Medicare which is why we took commission as earned - less financial risk to payback Medicare is subject to rules and regulations and the vagaries of politics. Life pays more up front, health pays longer term - so short term cash for life, long term renewals for Medicare. Life is more sales because you have to sell people on the need for it. 10,000 seniors turn 65 every day and need insurance. Life is year round and you have no real busy season. Medicare has open enrollment which is similar to tax season for accountants, but January through May (after you are established) are 20 to 30 hour work weeks. As you can see I prefer Medicare, but I am not blind to the fact that if you hate rules and details, you will hate Medicare. Whatever you do, learn to read books on your industry and sales, associate with top producers and put your customers interest before yours and you will get paid back in referrals."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/pkdfdw/independent_insurance_agent_a_viable_career/hc4py0y/

"Congrats on passing! As a life agent, it is nice to get paid quickly and with the advance pay it adds up quickly as well. However, please be cautious of chargebacks if you are on advanced pay. A safer choice is to request "as earned" especially if you're not dialed in with managing your money. Have a solid schedule, good lead flow, and just stay consistent."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ju62n5/alright_i_passed/mm1gxco/

"AEP always feels like a gamble because the apps come in fast but the chargebacks hit months later when you least expect it. I've learned to treat a chunk of that commission as untouchable. Otherwise the clawbacks wreck your momentum and your sanity."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/nsx1skx/

Dialing all day for a handful of conversations · 9 documents

"anyone else hate receiving AI-voice generated cold calls? the usual AI-generated cold calls I got were usually those that assume you aren't interested. "hi. this is x from x company. we are calling to tell you that you are eligible for our medicare benefits. do you have plan A or plan B?" "plan A" "I understand, but this call will not take too much of your time. it will only take a minute to discuss your eligibility.""

— r/sales · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1fhlgv1/anyone_else_hate_receiving_aivoice_generated_cold/

↳ bitslammer (25): "Not really, because they get to speak to my AI (Google Assistant) and I don't even know it. I only see the notification and block/mark them as SPAM when I do."

↳ [deleted] (19): "My favorite thing to do is wait until the AI prompt is over and then when the other person picks up yell "Kashmir belongs to Pakistan!"

↳ Reddevil313 (14): "Sometimes I get a call and the person is so rehearsed that I'm not sure if it's AI or not. I have to be careful not to get frustrated with a human being by mistake. I did once ask someone if they were AI and the response seemed strangely off so I hung up. I got an email immediately after saying he wasn't AI but the speed at which I received the email after hanging up was suspicious. I think about that one sometimes."

"AVOID: Bankers Life Had the worst experience with BL. No base pay! Horrible leads, cold calling, no benefits, wasting gas to go to appts and door knock, no reimbursements and you basically have to pay to work for them. I had to share leads with 20 other agents and we were all paying for these crap leads that don't even answer. Your managers make money off you when you sell and it's all triangle shaped.. AVOID!!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gaf2yn/avoid_bankers_life/

↳ WorriedLow146 (2): "I'm 65 abd have an interview. Coming up should I go through with this or decline."

↳ OracleVision88 (2): "I just had an orientation with them today and I came on Reddit to do some snooping. No wonder they are all over Indeed, trying to get any and everyone they can, in the door. I'm going back next week for a one on one interview. I will keep you posted on whether or not I pursue this. The commission based system was of no surprise to me, and they claim they are looking for people that want to make a career of this, which at 36 and not quite so many prospects, this may be amongst the best I can get. Thoughts? Edit: I was told that Banker's Life provides the leads to the agents and that it doesn't come out of our pockets, but you're saying that these leads, in fact, do. I've heard of agents paying \$75-\$300 for leads, and that's not something that I am trying to do."

↳ Elegant_Support_8082 (1): "I would highly recommend you to find somewhere that pays a base salary. When I was with Bankers Life, they didn't pay any base and commissions were super low. 95% quit within 6 months. They are a very manipulative company and they're captive, which means every client you obtain is actually theirs and you don't get paid/get to work with them after you leave as they make you sign a non-compete so you can't try and switch firms and take your clients. They pay no base salary, so you'll have to invest your own cash alongside your time. Be prepared for lots of stops at the gas pump, long days walking thru neighborhoods door-knocking and getting yelled off properties. Most people don't appreciate strangers showing up to their door and some people thought I was a missionary, LOL. But what rarely happened is people buying from me. And guess what, even when you do get a sale, they can cancel for up to a year after you sold the policy to them and Bankers Life takes that money right back out your pocket and does what they call a chargeback. I remember one time I drove an hour away to an appt, sold the policy and the lady texted me on the drive back home she thought she made a rushed decision and wanted to cancel the policy, despite it being a very smooth appt in my eyes. So all that you earned is gone, all the time, effort, gas etc gone and it can happen at any point up to a year after. Man this is just the start. I would highly, highly recommend avoiding Bankers Life and most insurance companies in general. Look for something with a base pay, they can afford it. Goodluck!"

"How Keyboard Warrior Marketing Built My Commercial Book Faster Than Ads Ever Did I wanted to share a prospecting approach that has been huge for me, especially with small commercial accounts like pressure washers, lawn care, and other contractor niches. I call it **Keyboard Warrior Marketing**, and it is about showing up where potential clients already spend time online and leading with real underwriting insight instead of a hard sell. The workflow is simple. I join industry Facebook groups using my personal account, I watch for posts where people talk about pricing or ask coverage questions, and I jump in with quick risk checkups, not full quotes, just a few smart questions like what is your day to day, any employees, roof work, vehicles, or subs. It positions you as the expert and builds trust right away. After the comment I like and add the original poster and anyone else engaging. Over time Facebook starts suggesting me as a friend to more people in the same trade, which creates a passive lead funnel. From there I message when it feels natural, I quote small general liability policies in about five to ten minutes, I send PDFs and payment links so they can buy at their own pace, and I follow up one week, one month, and one quarter later if they do not close right away. It has been a steady stream of warm leads without ad spend. If you are an independent agent who wants to break into commercial, or you are tired of cold calls and expensive ads, this is worth trying. I am curious if anyone else here has been using something similar, or wants to share scripts and messaging strategies that work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/

↳ Monskiactual (5): "this organic marketing sometimes call engagement marketing, it works, i used it early on in my mortgage career when i didnt know how to work leads two things. 1. It takes a fair amount of time and it is not inherently scaleble.. there is only so people you can engage with 2. Its a unique skill set, not everyone can do it. but if you can do it and do it seriously you can get good business . Congrats!"

↳ InsuranceGnome (4): "100% it has pros and cons but it is free and generates revenue at \$0 cost, just time and sweat to grow is a good deal."

↳ InsuranceGnome (2): "You should consider finding yourself a virtual assistant who can buyback time and duplicate yourself in some of these tasks as well, I personally found a VA on Free Marketing was a better return then Paid Marketing funnels. I had a 50% to 60% margin with staffing cost with VA's averaged out over time."

Clients poached or switched by call centers and other agents · 7 documents

"500 in your first OE is actually insane, congrats on that. tbh the thing i focused on after a big enrollment push was just making sure i kept the clients i already had because churn kills you way faster than slow growth. like i spent a week in january calling everyone to check in and my retention was noticeably better that year. referrals from those happy clients ended up being how i actually grew without spending more on leads."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rx4iw2/enrolled_500_aca_clients_my_first_open_enrollment/ob4bx8d/

"I am partnered with a tax office, and we have been running into people getting penalties for not having proper coverage. Most of these clients have been getting switched out each month by their telesales agents. I plan to sit with the clients on calls with Healthcare.gov and CMS and report every single one of these assholes that are doing this. The most recent one owes over \$1,500 in penalties. I am all for heavier ethics standards and stronger disciplinary action to stop agents from taking advantage of unsuspecting clients. The first step I would want to see is abolishing the tele sales agent. I feel like most telesales agents care for the clients' needs as good as they should because they don't have good symbiotic relationships with their book of business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bd66ik/aca_shitshow/kuo7i2d/

"You just need to partner with car dealerships, boat dealerships, motorcycle dealerships. They get high volume of people. To drive off the lot they NEED insurance. This starts the wheel of high volume, once you have those people, you have your foot in the door. "Hey man, that's an amazing boat you have there, I guess it dosen't tow itself hahahah! What heavy machine you have upfront? Awesome my brother as that aswell I love it. Hey man if we combine both, the amount you'll save is astronomical, would you be open to see a price for both? Thats Great, I guess you don't park those in the street hahahah! You live anywhere near (popular location near boat dealership) right?" Bblablabla and it goes on. 1 lead turned into 2-3-4 policies = lower churn possible. Gave you some sauce, I love the hustle, keep going."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/ooh6ak4/

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Theme	Documents
Bought leads from vendors	440
Captive or call-center job first	281
Referrals and their own book	279
Live transfers and inbound calls	164
Cold calling, door knocking and seminars	163
Aged leads	141
FMO / agency leads and 'free leads' programs	137
Google, SEO and a website	130
Self-generated leads (Facebook ads, own marketing)	124
Dialers, CRMs and text campaigns	115
Facebook groups, social media and content	97
Direct mail and T65 mailers	92
Lead vendors by name	81
Pharmacies, doctors' offices and community partners	51
Appointment setters and telemarketers	45

Bought leads from vendors · 440 documents

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/

↳ zb0324 (33): "If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

↳ TheMatthewMurray (18): "This is good. I use the method called "Mimic it, Master it, Make it your own." However, copying and pasting will work for awhile, but understanding why ads work is fairly important. That way you're not constantly copying. When something goes wrong is when, people don't know how to fix it."

↳ Randomdeath (16): "did you just post Well thought out and simple strategies for success? Sacralige I say"

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (75): "Quitting insurance today and becoming a professional litigant lmao"

↳ InsuranceEvangelist (70): "New income stream unlocked..."

↳ DavidDuford (24): "For real =). I should start selling info-product courses on how to do it, and partner with a lawyer to do all the work. "Make an easy \$1500 a day with one simple trick.""

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

Captive or call-center job first · 281 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | I --- I --- I | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | I | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | I | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | I | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | I | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | I | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | I So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | I --- I --- I --- I | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | I | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | I | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | I | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | I | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | I | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | I | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | I | Terminology | Description | I --- I --- I | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | I | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | I | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | I | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | I | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | I Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"Insurance sales is a joke, right? Former insurance salesman here(notice that it doesn't say agent) and after having several sales roles with varying commission structures consistently the worst ones were always the insurance roles besides working for a moving company. Having to pay for my licenses, taking 20-60 hours of coursework, having to deal with some of the worst pools of leads I've had to work with from people who don't even know who you are, to having to try to sell a 500\$ monthly premium to the couple paying a fourth of that through a local farm bureau. It just never, ever felt rewarding. The icing on the shit-cake being that you never even saw a lick of commission until you reach a certain threshold. Even the other shitty companies would let you have a crumb of the pie, but insurance tends to fall on the "salary" model so that while your base is higher than most, you better get used to that base. I've gotten good training in my career from jobs like this, but unless it's a me issue how the hell has anyone survived there longterm besides outlasting and inheriting books of business? I work in the dealership side of things now and do not regret it a sliver. edit: "clarification""

— r/sales · 202 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1wknc2q/insurance_sales_is_a_joke_right/

↳ Direct317 (269): "In school we used to go on a field trip to this place called JA Biztown. It's a fake town where all the kids have "jobs" and pay for stuff and be an adult for a day basically. Long story short I got in trouble at school and my punishment was to be an insurance salesman at JA Biztown instead of the job I picked "Radio DJ". Ever since then I knew insurance sales was a fate worse than death. Get outta there man find something else lol"

↳ International_Cow198 (174): "No harder way to make \$50k, no easier way to make \$500k"

↳ jroberts67 (170): "Saying insurance sales is a joke is a bit like saying selling real estate is a joke. Failure rate is insane. Those who dig in and become experts kill it."

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

↳ MonLower (39): "Feeling good about being independent and part of multiple agent associations. While this industry is far from perfect, this is the best place to be in my estimation. I feel bad for the SF agents that are up against serious changes. State Farm is quite offended by Progressive taking their spot and is looking to get more flexible to compete. My carriers have lowered commission rates, but often times will renege due to our agencies ability to place with other carriers. Overall, comp has decreased in my 15 years but not to the point of being unsustainable. A few percentage points with most large carriers."

↳ Splodingseal (19): "It's a shit or get off the pot approach. They want agents that are hungry to write as much business as possible and to get rid of Bob and his secretary that kinda coast along only writing as much as he needs to keep the lights on."

↳ firenance (18): "Independents are more insulated as carriers tend to influence performance with contract terminations or adjusting profit share or bonus commission metrics. They don't like you, they just fire you."

Referrals and their own book · 279 documents

"I am a licensed agent since 2006 and have clients on both Medigaps and Advantage Plans. It's our duty and obligation to give each client to do a thorough presentation and give them their options. Medigap plans are excellent but not all can budget a Medigap plan which increase every year and when it's a husband and wife the expense can really be a hardship. Then they have to pay separate for their part D and separate for dental insurance and so on. On the other hand, my parents and in-laws with medical issues like cancer and diabetes have done very well with advantage plans and still continue up to this day. Not to mention some clients may also qualify for Low-income Subsidies and Medicaid programs from their state so truly they are covered even 100% for all Medicare costs. Although they are managed care plans there are many professional physicians who participate in these advantage plans and the referral process is not a headache. There are not a one size fits all plan. Every client has unique situations, lifestyles, income and so forth. So, at the end of the day give your clients the option because if you don't do a good job explaining their options as discussed on Medicare and You handbook, another agent will come along and enroll them in a managed care plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 93 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugz1PoRQzLPt1BvWDah4AaABAq>

↳ @davidcampo2902 (13): "Everything you said is spot on! I I don't understand how this guy can generalize something as broad as a medicare into a little 16 minute video. There's so many other reasons why somebody would choose a Medicare Advantage plan as opposed to a supplement plan. Aside from your part B why would you pay a monthly premium for some thing that keeps going up for the most part every single year plus pay a separate premium for your part D drug plan plus pay copayment on top of that. You mentioned low income subsidy there's also state Medicaid and that comes along with a bunch of other benefits."

↳ @roberthoeller5516 (5): "I too sell both and agree with you 110%."

↳ @rodbutler4054 (4): "Spoken like a true insurance salesman!"

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

↳ Samwill226 (38): "24/7 cell is going to be your downfall."

↳ Samwill226 (10): "You know what huge risk it really opens up? E&O. I've been in this a long time. I can't tell you how many E&O claims come from cell phone communications. It's a HUGE vulnerability"

↳ Samwill226 (8): "It really is a huge hole for a claim. I have clients find me on social media and send me a message on a Saturday night about a change or coverage question I won't even look at it or respond. You gotta protect yourself on your personal time because they'll throw you under the bus quick! "I called and told him....""

Live transfers and inbound calls · 164 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought *pre-sold leads* from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the *insurance carrier, not the agent*, for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (75): "Quitting insurance today and becoming a professional litigator lmao"

↳ InsuranceEvangelist (70): "New income stream unlocked..."

↳ DavidDuford (24): "For real =). I should start selling info-product courses on how to do it, and partner with a lawyer to do all the work. "Make an easy \$1500 a day with one simple trick:""

"Had my first sale today! I'm a new agent in Florida, independent. All inbound leads. Today was my first day on my own after training. Just super excited n I needed to put it out there!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 122 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/

↳ DJSimmer305 (25): "Congrats! May your commissions be fat and your chargebacks be minimal!"

↳ Staugbeachbunny (7): "I work at an agency where we receive only inbound calls. We have a weekly charge of around \$850. This covers everything from the dialer to the office space and the leads as well The first two weeks are free though. My one call today covers that charge so I'm ok with it. People who have been doing it for a while are just killing it there. I used to work furniture sales and during slow season when the snowbirds were out of town, that was all I would make in one or two weeks occasionally. Definite Upgrade!"

↳ RancidSmellingShit (7): "How many inbound leads are you receiving for that \$850?"

"Let go at 6 months pregnant This happened yesterday. I'm still processing. Couldn't sleep all night. And this is long. I apologize in advance. Been an AE at this small private tech company for almost 2 years. They recently went through a rebrand and wanted us targeting completely new verticals. Leadership and overall processes were a complete mess, and it was honestly a shit show. I wanted to leave, but was holding out until after baby arrived this summer. Q4 was rough. Partly because we have zero good inbound leads and are 100% reliant on outbounds, and we have a 6 month sales cycle on average. Except our CEO acts like it should be a 2-meeting close. My old boss was fired and I got a new boss in January. In February, I was told I needed to hit my revenue numbers by end of March, along with all these KPIs metrics, and training a new guy he hired. I've never been on a PIP in my life (been an AE for 7 years), but it didn't feel formal in that there was no document and I never signed anything. Just told I need to do this and this. Now, normally the advice is to start applying immediately. And I did. However my situation is a bit different as I'm pregnant and due this summer. Made it to the offer stage at another company and then informed them I was pregnant, hoping to negotiate some sort of leave. Unfortunately they couldn't offer me any paid leave and my job also wouldn't be protected since I wouldn't qualify for FMLA. At my current company, I would. So it felt safer in the moment to stay. I worked my ass off. Consistently delivered on outreach KPIs, spent hours training the new hire, helped with new marketing initiatives developing new 1-pagers and helping with new outreach playbook development. Really trying to show I'm an asset and praying I could stay on through the summer. After that, I wouldn't care. Still, my revenue was down and my other deals were tied up in legal and I was starting to worry. But out of nowhere one of my old deals I closed last summer was acquired and the new company reached out per their recommendation, and wanted to move forward. This new deal would single handedly hit my revenue numbers. However the compliance aspect took forever. Our team is so disorganized and makes it so hard to buy. Then onboarding. Unfortunately I also sell a consumption based product. So even though they sign the contract and commit to X volume, the revenue generated is dependent on their ramp...which is in the hands of the client success team. And then wouldn't you have it, this CSM did the bare minimum to help them ramp. I felt like I was being sabotaged. Even my boss agreed that they were not doing their job. I stepped up and held meetings to help the client onboard, go through the set up and integration. The CSM completely dropped the ball. No reoccurring meetings in place until they fully ramped, nothing. Basically told them "if you need help lmk". Insane. So, yesterday arrived and I was below my revenue number. But I SHOULD have hit it. And I've been doing so much I really didn't feel worried. Mind you, my entire team was below as well. Revenue was stagnant across the company. But my boss called me out of the blue and I was terminated on the spot. No emotion. No severance. No paid out PTO. No extended insurance. Nothing. My income makes up 60% of our household income. And I use their insurance. Which I have doctors appointments set up every 2 weeks. They've completely fucked me as no company is going to hire me when I give birth in 3 months and also pay me for leave. I dont know what the fuck to do. We genuinely cannot afford to not have my income until Fall. Do I have any legal leg to stand on, or can they just say I fell short of performance, even if I'm dependent on others to do their job AND the entire company was stagnant on revenue? (For reference, I was the only one with a contract signed in Q1 and I had 2 others under review)."

— r/sales · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1jp0avi/let_go_at_6_months_pregnant/

↳ IdgyThreadgoodee (145): "200% file a lawsuit. If they didn't formalize the PIP they fucked up. Also apply for ANY job with a good maternity policy and do not let the old guys know you're working (if hired). Edit: I did not state the PIP is required. I said they fucked up because they did. They now have zero formal documentation to support her firing. And I'm not gonna fight with people hating on women, y'all have serious issues and just get blocked when you come at it like that."

↳ Motor-Over (121): "What state are you in? Always free to talk with a lawyer. In the mean time file for unemployment."

↳ IdgyThreadgoodee (50): "The pip is part of it. They won't have documentation to support their claims. Source: just won against the biggest tech company in the world."

Cold calling, door knocking and seminars · 163 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLLHQAIVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | --- | --- | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"Why are we selling insurance like its 2005? Not trying to start drama just genuinely curious. We've got tech for everything now food shows up in 15 minutes, people find houses on their phones, we match with dates using algorithms. But when it comes to insurance? We're still cold calling, chasing unqualified leads, and quoting people we were never gonna close in the first place. We spend hours dialing and quoting but half the time it's with someone we can't even write a policy for. What if there was a smarter way to work where we only connect with people based on what they actually need and what we actually offer? Not saying tech solves everything, but there has to be a shift from the old school hustle to something more intentional. Anyone else feel like the traditional model is wearing thin?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 57 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l3wj8v/why_are_we_selling_insurance_like_its_2005/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (41): "I cold called in my first 6-8 months and completely stopped after that. That was years ago. Personally I just got out of the office and started talking to people. I enjoyed it way more. I'm mostly commercial these days so it's even different for me now, but I joined clubs, associations, so on so forth."

↳ pi20 (20): "You say 'connect with people based on what they need'. The reason consumers need agents is they don't always know what they need. The agent should be performing an exposure and risk analysis of the customer, their home and household, exposures, etc. and helping them select the coverages they should have. The agent has knowledge and expertise to know which coverages should be applied, and which carriers offer those coverages at competitive prices."

↳ DWIGHT_69_SCHRUTE (14): "Na fuck technology honestly and all this Ai bullshit"

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGANT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

Aged leads · 141 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (75): "Quitting insurance today and becoming a professional litigator lmao"

↳ InsuranceEvangelist (70): "New income stream unlocked..."

↳ DavidDuford (24): "For real =). I should start selling info-product courses on how to do it, and partner with a lawyer to do all the work. "Make an easy \$1500 a day with one simple trick.""

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeee/

↳ Typical-Mouse-4804 (231): "Ride the clock. Do bare minimum. Apply for jobs. Block calendar for interviews with DOCTOR APT and DMV and shit like that."

↳ Eswift33 (101): "Pre-record a script and have the recording play when someone answers. If they bite then close the deal. Do this all while playing PlayStation 🤪"

↳ ATLs_finest (88): "I'm always amazed when I hear about the sheer number of calls some SDR types make. 200 calls per day is 25 calls per hour for 8 hours per day. In my first sales job I was making 60-70 calls per day and I thought that was a lot. You would basically never put the phone down. Do you have other training, reporting or administrative tasks to do or do you literally just pick up the phone and dial for 8 hours straight?"

"I'm learning off 5-10 year old leads making 300+ dials a day to learn as fast as possible made my first sale yesterday thanks for the video"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 52 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=Ugybs2i2wGd1cChHPq54AaABAg

↳ @thomasmorris2245 (6): "Congratulations on your first sale"

↳ @15pluna (4): "hey quick question do you mean the leads are 5-10 yrs old???? impressiiveeee!"

↳ @oExlucive (0): "@15pluna I was calling aged mortgage leads, the company that had sent out the ads, sent mailers in around 2018-2022 was the earliest lead I seen, and so many people have already called on these people so the 2 sales I had off 600 leads had a lot of smoke screens and they already had policies so I had to switch them over, Mutual of Omaha and royal neighbors are the 2 carrier's we used to find more coverage at better rates"

FMO / agency leads and 'free leads' programs · 137 documents

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

↳ Heavy_Following_1114 (19): "You view it as a job, not a career, You have an income requirement that's initially unattainable, You're intimidated by being undercut, You don't have a solid support system, You need to be nurtured, You're not driven enough, You never learned sales and marketing, You don't forge good enough relationships with clients, You don't study enough, You don't adapt, You're not an effective communicator, You aren't familiar with the markets, You don't have enough confidence in your products, You don't have a mentor, You don't market online, You don't do enough prospecting, You don't try hard enough, You don't stay on top of trends, You don't use new technology, You don't network enough, You don't treat your role as a business, Your expectations are too big from the start, Your expectations are too small from the start, You didn't get a quality education and training, You aren't focused enough, You didn't save enough money to support yourself while you grow a book, You're using dead-end leads, You don't have the right mindset, You're not qualifying your clients, You're too emotional, You're easily intimidated, You're not hungry enough to succeed, You're selling insurance and not solutions, You don't know how to set appointments, You're not a good presenter, You're not picking the right carriers for your prospects, You're not locking down the markets, You're not offering enough value, You don't have enough practical knowledge, You're focusing on the wrong things, You have too much freedom, You're limiting yourself, You're not making good first impressions, You're not following up enough, You're following up too much and scaring clients away, The job is too stressful, You lack patience, You're not making yourself available enough for your clients, You're not being proactive, You're not participating enough in your community"

↳ ThatWideLife (12): "There's one main reason why agents leave, they are in poverty with a full time job. Insurance is great for those who live with parents and have minimal bills. I'd say for a majority of people, they don't have a year to sit back and hope they start making money."

↳ [deleted] (10): "Selling isn't for most people. Selling insurance isn't for most sales people.. selling life insurance isn't for 99% of licensed insurance agents.. I just started a few months ago and I write 5K issued AP per week on a bad week, 7K -8K on average weekly with a high of 11K weekly... this sht isn't rocket scientist like everyone makes it seem. It's ad spend, closing ratio and systems."

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGANT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

Google, SEO and a website · 130 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: I Industry I Description I I --- I --- I I Tech I You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. I I Med I You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. I I Finance/Insurance I You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. I I Hardware/Construction I Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. I I Cars I You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. I I Door to Door I Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. I So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. I JOB TITLE I PAY RANGE (Salary) I PAY RANGE (OTE) I DESCRIPTION** I I --- I --- I --- I SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) I £25,000 - £40,000 I £50,000 - £80,000 I Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. I I SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive I £30,000 - £60,000 I £50,000 - £140,000 I Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. I I MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive I £40,000 - £75,000 I £60,000 - £150,000 I Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. I I ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive I £50,000 - £100,000 I £70,000 - £250,000 I Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. I I SALES MANAGER I £60,000 - £120,000 I £80,000 - £200,000 I Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. I I MD: Managing Director I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. I I HEAD OF SALES I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. I I Terminology I Description I I --- I --- I I Cold call I When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. I I Lead I This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. I I Account I This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. I I Contact I This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. I I Example of a lead, a contact and an account. I Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/

↳ zb0324 (33): "If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

↳ TheMatthewMurray (18): "This is good. I use the method called "Mimic it, Master it, Make it your own." However, copying and pasting will work for awhile, but understanding why ads work is fairly important. That way you're not constantly copying. When something goes wrong is when, people don't know how to fix it."

↳ Randomdeath (16): "did you just post Well thought out and simple strategies for success? Sacralige I say"

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

↳ SHURP (14): "I'm was actually thinking about finding a property and casualty specific subreddit. It hadn't even dawned on me till I saw the posts here that people actually view life and health in the same vein. I hate to sound like a purist or something but due to the way health and life insurance in American works, I feel like it's crazy to call any of the programs that isn't single payer, anything but MLM."

↳ Samwill226 (6): "I'd like a Reddit for just P&C Agents (no consumer questions there's plenty of that already). There's so much confusion on what someone is talking about sometimes you get an answer and its a life person thinking you are talking about life policies. I would like to be able to talk just to folks I can relate to."

↳ malachi347 (5): "did you ever find or make one? I'd love to be a part of a community like that as well. can't stand life/group med.. or personal lines for that matter heh"

Self-generated leads (Facebook ads, own marketing) · 124 documents

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/

↳ zb0324 (33): "If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

↳ TheMatthewMurray (18): "This is good. I use the method called "Mimic it, Master it, Make it your own." However, copying and pasting will work for awhile, but understanding why ads work is fairly important. That way you're not constantly copying. When something goes wrong is when, people don't know how to fix it."

↳ Randomdeath (16): "did you just post Well thought out and simple strategies for success? Sacralige I say"

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 😊"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

↳ UnfairFloor3347 (25): "My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

↳ [deleted] (13): "I looked into it and they were very expensive in my opinion. Plus it's usually some room full of very hungry people in the Philippines or someplace like that bullying people through a script and that could turn out to be a waste of time in many cases. So I bought the call list myself with certain parameters I set according to people of the ages that typically are thinking about life insurance (because they typically still have people they feel the need to provide for unlike Mrs Jones at 69 years old whose kids are all in their 40s and whose husband is typically dead. I figure if people get to their 60s or older and still have absolutely no final expense coverage it's usually either because they don't see the necessity of it or they just can't afford it. Sure there are exceptions to that but they're exceptions. That brought me to my other parameter of 40K plus income, people that can actually pay the premium. The way I see it I'll just call them myself and I'll be very direct. I won't tell them I'm a "benefits coordinator" or any other BS line. I'll flat out tell them I sell life insurance and if they have about 2 minutes I'd like to give them a quote and that if they like the price I'll come by and we'll do the paperwork in person and they can take out the policy. Then I'll tell them that I'll make no attempt to talk them into buying anything they don't want or can't afford. Then I'll pause for a second. They'll either let me quote them or they won't and then I'll move on down the list. No shady practices at all. Some people will appreciate that and may actually buy a policy. Some won't. Either way I won't feel smarmy and I won't waste several hours and x amount of money on gas driving all over the place trying to talk to people that don't want to talk to me anyway and probably have no intention of buying anything."

↳ Deadly3ffect (12): "I always hated this. "34 year agent and I've never used leads." Back when people would walk into your office to get an insurance policy. Fucking shocker, you started before anyone used the internet. By the time the industry changed you were already established. What you started with is completely different to what the insurance industry is now. Sorry, that shit seriously pisses me off. All these old timers are sitting below me on the monthly sales because they have this outdated mindset. You want to sell insurance? Buy fucking leads."

Dialers, CRMs and text campaigns · 115 documents

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** — How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** — How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** — How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kfmbhp/8_tips_for_new_agents_to_sell_insurance/

↳ hawkwood76 (11): "Love it. I will only add If it isn't on our calendar, it doesn't exist."

↳ CGWInsurance (5): "Congrats on doing this for new agents. Extremely well written. I would have put thick skin at either 1 or 2. Seen many leave this industry who rocked everything, but just took everything that was said to them personally and they had to quit for their own mental health."

↳ DavidDuford (2): "Appreciate it. Selling insurance or doing something totally performance-based is not for the faint of heart."

"Independent Agency Owners, What Would You Do Differently Starting From Scratch? If you were starting a brand-new independent insurance agency today, knowing what you know now, what would you recommend? I'm especially interested in hearing about: \- Agency networks / aggregators / clusters: Who would you join—or avoid? \- Carrier appointments: Which appointments would you prioritize first? \- Programs & software: AMS, CRM, comparative raters, quoting tools, automation, accounting, etc. What's actually worth paying for? \- Non-negotiables: What absolutely needs to be in place from day one? \- Negotiables: What can wait until the agency starts producing revenue? \- Contracts: What terms would you refuse to sign? Book ownership, commission splits, exit provisions, non-solicitation, production requirements, fees, etc. \- Expenses: Where is it worth spending money upfront, and where would you stay lean? \- Lead generation: What actually worked for you versus what was a complete waste of money? \- Niches: Would you start broad or specialize early? \- Lessons learned: What mistake cost you the most time, money, or headache? Basically, if you had to build your agency again from \$0 in premium and no existing book, what would your blueprint look like? I'm less interested in sales pitches and more interested in hearing from agents who have actually built or operated an independent agency, give me the good, the bad, and the "absolutely do not sign that contract" lessons."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadqv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/

↳ InstructionWarm2840 (20): "Man I wish someone told me about the cluster trap earlier. Joined a big one first year and the exit clause was basically "we own your book forever" - took me 3 years to buy my way out of that mess. Read every contract like your life depends on it, especially the part about who actually own the business when you leave For software don't go crazy at start. I spent like \$800/month on fancy CRM that I barely used first 6 months. Get good rater and simple accounting, rest can wait until you got actual revenue coming in. The only thing worth paying for right away is a decent phone system and maybe EZLynx if you do personal lines What worked best for leads was literally just walking into real estate offices with donuts on Saturday morning. Cost me 15 bucks and got more referrals than the \$500/month online leads I tried. Would specialize early too, I wasted 2 years trying to write everything and made no money until I focused only on contractors"

↳ broker965 (8): "Riches are in the niches. Pick one. One niche makes market selection and appointments much easier. Promote only that niche, become known for that niche, watch the money pile up. Promote. Promote. Promote. If you're bashful to self-promote, do not become a small business owner. When you're a scratch agency, no one other than your mom will know you exist. It's 100% up to you to get the word out. Most agency owners get side tracked with this and that marketing system and lead gen yatta yatta... 99% of it is pure BS marketing hype trying to sell you something. Stick to the basics. Pick a CRM, AMS and phone system you can afford and block out all the other noise. And for God's sake, don't open an agency if you've never spent 1 hour of your life working in one. This is a non-negotiable. If you don't have industry experience and you open an insurance agency, you're doing your future clients a disservice by being an inexperienced insurance agent."

↳ Knucklecum (7): "I'm literally about to start my own independent agency, as a new agent. Thank you for submitting this post. lol"

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will make me feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (39): "I didn't read everything you wrote, but just keep in mind, it's a tough insurance climate right now (Assuming you're in the US). Doing it right now would leave you struggling to get contracts. I'm an independent and almost all of my major carriers are not giving new contracts at this time. This will drain your assets extremely fast. I'd hold out until it softens up a bit."

↳ Acceptable-Tip7886 (28): "Times are tough, if you're making 200k plus I would stay and invest. Money now is more important than money later plus you'll retire sooner"

↳ HamiltonSt25 (10): "I'm sorry, let me clarify. I'm speaking as far as P&C goes. So if you're asking about life/health, I have no idea. If you're talking P&C, then I'm speaking about direct contracts with carriers/companies."

Facebook groups, social media and content · 97 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | --- | --- | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** — How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** — How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** — How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kfmhbp/8_tips_for_new_agents_to_sell_insurance/

↳ hawkwood76 (11): "Love it. I will only add If it isn't on our calendar, it doesn't exist."

↳ CGWInsurance (5): "Congrats on doing this for new agents. Extremely well written. I would have put thick skin at either 1 or 2. Seen many leave this industry who rocked everything, but just took everything that was said to them personally and they had to quit for their own mental health."

↳ DavidDuford (2): "Appreciate it. Selling insurance or doing something totally performance-based is not for the faint of heart."

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

Direct mail and T65 mailers · 92 documents

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trusted lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"First off, get the MLM idea out of your head. The whole insurance industry is built upon uplines and downlines that is fully commission based. If you want a salary, you'll have to find an agency (whose commission based and has an upline) that'll pay you something fixed. Tough to find something like that for L&H compared to P&C. FE is great for upfront funds, but know that there can be quite a few chargebacks, so 30% of your commissions should go into a side-account to pay for these until you get your lead saturation up and your sales skill level established. Yes, Medicare is a grind unless you know how to cross-sell ancillary, then it's better than FE. In fact I recommend this track for newer FE agents: 1. Contract with someone that can train you and gives you fair contracts 100+% for FE and 20% for Medicare Supplements. 2. Get leads (facebook and direct mail) EVERY week in the same 50 sq mile area, and work them hard, spend 40 hours a week in the field, getting in front of as many people as possible. Build up a saturation level so that when you invariably door knock your leads and they say no or they're not home, you can just simply go two streets down and knock the guy you could never get ahold of a month or two ago. 3. Take some sample lead info and put it into a Medicare Quoting tool and find out whose competitive in your area for supplements, advantage plans etc. Start building your Medicare knowledge up. Of course, first past the AHIP so you have a base understanding for it. Just a few hours a week can help build up a wealth of knowledge. Once you understand how everything works, any changes to plans, companies or Medicare itself is easily assimilable - whereas there's no changes to FE usually. 4. Tell every lead you'll follow up with them in September to schedule a meeting in October to go over their Medicare options - because you do that too. If you don't sell anyone any FE, that's ok, offer to contact them in September for their Medicare, you "help seniors save money on their prescriptions and get extra benefits at no cost to them." If you paid for the lead, might as well get as much use out of them. 5. Selling FE sucks in November to December, the holidays. It's way easier to work with warm leads, sell them Medicare, and also increase your persistency lapse rate on your FE policies as well as bring in tons of referrals and get paid 2x as you would've just selling an FE policy. You could have enough leads to keep you busy all AEP, so that when that ends, you have a 2 week lull before New Years where you can start the whole cycle up again. THIS is the secret to making big bucks imo. Cody and Dave are good guys, Dave helped me out when I was where you were at, 12 years ago. He comes on here sometimes, haven't seen Cody on here yet."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/svjgsv/help_i_passed_accidenthealth_and_life_now_im/hxgcw8n/

"What lead vendors work for you? I'm a face to face final expense agent. I was using cheaper internet leads from integrity, social insurance leads, and leads direct. They aren't exclusive but they're anywhere from \$1-11 so I can get a lot of them, and if you dial enough you'll set up enough appointments. The ROI was great. As of recently though, they're just bad. And I've been with companies in the past that have had BAD leads before, I'm used to having to dial a lot and overcome objections, but this just isn't the way anymore. I've tried Facebook ads myself and I've come to the conclusion I'm just not a good marketer. It takes a lot of trial and error and time to figure it out so unless there's somewhere that'll give me a copy and pasted proven ad to post, I've decided it's not worth it. I'll take any recommendations on any direct mail or internet lead vendors. What works for you guys?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxcl1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/

↳ DavidDuford (5): "I'll second u/NAF1138 - just work direct mail leads. Aged direct mail leads can be great if you can find a quality distributor. Facebook leads can be good but you'll have a bunch more travel time to work them effectively."

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you sell face to face, you should ONLY work direct mail. All other lead types are only good for filler leads or telesales. There are lots of good direct lead vendors The Lead Connection Lead Concepts Need a Lead RGI Are some places to start."

↳ dis_iz_funny_shit (4): "I've got a direct face to face method for finding new leads in the field - mortgage protection leads --- so the tool helps you find people in any area that just bought a home in the last few months. It helps you locate a phone number also about 60-70% of the time"

Lead vendors by name · 81 documents

"I have no idea how internet leads are profitable, even by their own claimed results. I spoke with Smart Financial last week because I could use another source to supplement my office's quote volume. Leads are \$10 each. They are claiming a 3-5% close rate based on the internal agent dashboard results they can see. I started to build a spreadsheet out to model both 3% and 5% scenarios, using my average new policy auto premium. After paying between \$200 and \$330 for the sale, and paying my sales guy out on it, my break even would be like 1.5 to 2.5 years. 2.5 years is longer than the average customer lifespan for the internet leads we have previously written. I'd say "well, we make money by selling additional lines of coverage" normally. But the customer quality on internet leads is usually renters. It's been a long time since I've run internet leads at any volume. Are any of you actually tracking ROI and coming out ahead on these?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ucbfrx/i_have_no_idea_how_internet_leads_are_profitable/

↳ Routine-Wish-4984 (9): "the math really does not work out the way they present it, and I think most agents figure this out only after they already spent the budget the only way I ever saw it pencil out was if your retention on those customers is unusually high, but like you said, internet shoppers tend to be the first ones to re-shop at renewal"

↳ flobblobblob (9): "Carriers and bigger agencies are buying those and like you calculated, lose money on year 1 and often 2. Because they are funded or have revenue in the millions, they can play the long game. The fastest growing agencies I've seen put their effort into finding referral partners, typical lenders and realtors for personal lines."

↳ MikeTouchedMyDitka (8): "Build a website (doesn't have to be great) and do google ads. Would you rather talk to people that searched "insurance rates" or someone who sees your ad while doomscrolling"

"150 Internet Leads Bought & ZERO Sales. Just took over an agency (P&C) from an agent that sold out and since the start of the month we've been getting internet leads. I am using Smart Financial but we haven't gotten any closes on these leads or even really any correspondence. Are we doing something wrong in the office or is that just the name of the game?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vyv0ou/150_internet_leads_bought_zero_sales/

↳ KindlyWelcomeAdvice (27): "Internet leads are the worst, 95% of them are just people clicking around for fun while they wait for their coffee. They fill out one form and suddenly 15 agents call them in same minute, nobody picks up after that. Smart Financial leads are recycled like crazy, you're probably the fourth person calling that same number today. Try calling at weird hours, early morning or late evening, I got few people that way when I did P&C. Also check if your team is waiting too long to call, if you're not dialing within 30 seconds someone else already got them."

↳ KiniShakenBake (13): "I generate all my own leads. We spend time at local events, being interesting and fun collateral to share, and usually lace our conversations with puns and things like "have an agent? Want one?" It's so ridiculous that it works. The last one I did was a back to school event where we took yo-yos from Progressive and handed them to the kids who promised to take the saving pledge and not to walk, ride, or drive distracted on their way to school. We had so much fun! 3 hours, we got fed while we were there, and we had three of those folks call into us, asking for help with their stuff. Then we did a lunch which ran about \$8 per head, and \$10 per lead we got out of it. But they are also calling in and responding when we call them. They had to use a QR code to let me know which protein they wanted, and of course the lead was part of that. I love local events because we paid nothing to be at the first one. We talked to one of our reps to get help paying for the second (the market served is right in their pocket of happy clients) and the most recent one is one I have done literally every year for the last ten years, and is a great time, every time. Those three events, all in the last two weeks, generated about 150 leads. I probably spent about \$10-12 per lead and we actually struggle to call them fast enough because they genuinely want to talk to us. That's why they filled out the card or mentioned they wanted to talk about something on the form. For give aways, I usually have a table full of random snacks from Costco and a paper bag with a label on it. They pick and choose their snacks for the bag and we chatter about how important protection from the little stuff (hangry at work) vs. The big stuff is. And we handle both gracefully. I always have my table littered with random swag from various carriers, stuff I ordered that is agency branded, and literature relevant to the audience. Telling kids they could have a yo-yo if they promised not to drive, walk, or ride like a yo-yo was one of my favorite marketing campaigns to date. Giving folks little folders from travelers with the pockets and car accident info list was great. Travelers also has 10 minute fire audits available and I ordered a bunch of those in both English and Spanish. Those were super popular, and lots of people took them because a lot of folks in these groups were impacted by fires to homes last year. The other piece I love is travelers personal household inventory. Those are customized and I take them to every event. I am slapping a label on the back that suggests taking a video of the home alongside the inventory itself. I don't go to events with the idea that anyone there is going to magically want to become my client. I go there to let the community know that there is a great resource for good information about insurance in their community and we would love to be their agents. I have a meeting tomorrow that will likely generate about 750 in revenue, from one such event. I already told the client that they need to start teaching their kids to drive with their brains before they drive with their feet and hands, so all the kids are now "licensed side-seat drivers" who can and should ask questions, look around the car for hazards and people driving like yo-yos to let their driver know that they are there, and to mentally think about next moves and timing them, spacing them, etc. The parents love the idea of teaching their kids to drive with their brains before their hands and feet, and are sold on the kids side-seat driving. That family is going to have a great time for the next six years or so while all three of their kids get to 16. Come up with a value add and really lean into it. Make it something your community can get excited about. Improving community safety and resilience is one of my favourite things to do."

↳ jake112399 (3): "Any other recommended avenues? lol"

"Online leads Hello, been an agent for 8 years never had a good experience with online lead companies. I see most people here are active with online leads. Any life lead companies worth suggesting to try out ? Appreciate all the suggestions. Not afraid of the competition I believe it's enough money to go around for all of us that put in the work. These are the companies that were pretty much trash and disappointments for me, I wouldn't suggest any of you wasting time and money with them. A plus leads , Hometown quote, Everq, QuoteWizard, Smart financial."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dfe69c/online_leads/

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (5): "Agent here. I don't sell leads, but I buy lots of leads lol. What type of life leads are you looking for (Final expense, annuities, mortgage protection)?"

↳ Any_Narwhal6344 (3): "I currently work with White Glove, and they do it all for me, from marketing to booking the venue and help with follow-up. They also offer a webinar that allows you to record the seminar and run it all year. My other thought is that we have 13 tax preparers in my city on 20k. I was planning to chat with them to see if they see a need with their clients for even basic information about taxes in retirement. If so, offer to host a no cost seminar and offer the preparer \$25 per person that shows. It get them extra income and get me a lower seminar cost."

↳ Quiet-Knee2142 (3): "Quote Wizard was the worst thing I ever tried..... horrible they did give me my money back though"

Pharmacies, doctors' offices and community partners · 51 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: I Industry I Description I I --- I --- I I Tech I You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. I I Med I You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. I I Finance/Insurance I You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. I I Hardware/Construction I Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. I I Cars I You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. I I Door to Door I Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. I So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. I JOB TITLE I PAY RANGE (Salary) I PAY RANGE (OTE) I DESCRIPTION** I I --- I --- I --- I SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) I £25,000 - £40,000 I £50,000 - £80,000 I Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. I I SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive I £30,000 - £60,000 I £50,000 - £140,000 I Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. I I MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive I £40,000 - £75,000 I £60,000 - £150,000 I Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. I I ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive I £50,000 - £100,000 I £70,000 - £250,000 I Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. I I SALES MANAGER I £60,000 - £120,000 I £80,000 - £200,000 I Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. I I MD: Managing Director I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. I I HEAD OF SALES I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. I I Terminology I Description I I --- I --- I I Cold call I When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. I I Lead I This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. I I Account I This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. I I Contact I This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. I I Example of a lead, a contact and an account. I Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"I agree with the pro of being independent and not micromanaged. Long rant but I just quit my fairly new job where I knew NOTHING. I had no experience. They said training would be 2 months.. Unfortunately, only 3 weeks in the boss kept pulling me aside literally every day and telling me I was too slow, not doing good enough, and that I should know a lot more. Then she wanted me to study at home to "catch up" without paying me. As well as the senior staff member would make comments throughout the day like "come on. you should know this already" The problem was I knew the information. It just got very difficult to focus because of the negativity. I was sweating and so anxious all day and because of that kept making mistakes. I woke up one day and said fuck this and quit. I work best when not micromanaged. I need to take the time to learn things at my own pace. I cannot tolerate negativity. My previous job was a pharmacy technician. I did it for 5 years and I loved it and I was badass at it. It made me realize that I love talking to customers about health insurance. I hope I do well as an insurance agent :D I'm about to take the licensing exam. Yay!"

— YouTube · PROS & CONS OF BEING AN INSURANCE AGENT · 122 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UfHT3xWq4TY&lc=UgwNWyFPgvNrc06hZcd4AaABAg>

↳ @ErinNogueira (15): "Best of luck Jane! Proud of you for sticking to your guns and doing what's best for you!!"

↳ @nerd6646 (5): "how is it going? i'm about to do the same move you did lol"

↳ @dianaag28 (1): "Good for you, good luck 🍀👍"

"Thank you, Matthew. Until I watched this podcast, I had no idea that my Aetna Medicare Premier Advantra PPO was actually provided by a privately owned company. Now it makes sense why I was suddenly being encouraged to change my pharmacy to CVS. My local CVS employees are great, but I was a happy, dedicated Walgreens customer for decades. Of more significance is the frightening information about the proven interference in health care delivery from doctors to patients based on the Inspector General's published three-year study. I realize that you earn a living as an insurance agent, but you are earning an honorable living by spreading truth and educating consumers like me. Thank you."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 39 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgyikF0_s_gj4oa98_B4AaABAg

↳ @MedigapSeminars (13): "There is a lot more money made selling Medicare Advantage Plans than Medicare supplements, by a wide margin. I set myself and my company up as a true independent, able to offer anything the customer needs. That way we can represent the clients best interest. It's what I call good business"

↳ @jleechedwick (2): "@MedigapSeminars I discovered this listening to some other videos here on YouTube. I decided to switch to original Medicare and got both a Part D and Part G (I was approved for both). I am so thankful that I watched these videos (and I'm impressed by yours as well)."

↳ @toriless (1): "Drop them! Get medicare!"

Appointment setters and telemarketers · 45 documents

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** — How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** — How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** — How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kfmhbp/8_tips_for_new_agents_to_sell_insurance/

↳ hawkwood76 (11): "Love it. I will only add If it isn't on our calendar, it doesn't exist."

↳ CGWInsurance (5): "Congrats on doing this for new agents. Extremely well written. I would have put thick skin at either 1 or 2. Seen many leave this industry who rocked everything, but just took everything that was said to them personally and they had to quit for their own mental health."

↳ DavidDuford (2): "Appreciate it. Selling insurance or doing something totally performance-based is not for the faint of heart."

"How I retired my wife with my insurance agency, AMA I launched my agency in 2023 after working for years as a producer, underwriter, and consultant. It started as a side project with one goal in mind, to build enough recurring income to retire my wife and give us both more freedom. Within the first year I turned it into a full-time operation using an aggregator for market access and an organic marketing system that focused on building real relationships instead of buying leads. If you are trying to start or scale your own agency, here's what I can share: • How I used social media to generate consistent inbound leads without paying for ads • How I manage quoting, follow ups, and virtual assistant support to keep volume moving • How niche markets like pressure washing and contractors helped create stable renewals • What commission structures and business habits made the biggest difference early on • How to build an agency that supports your family and gives you time freedom Ask me anything about licensing, operations, staffing, lead generation, or what it actually takes to build an agency that can change your lifestyle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/

↳ InsuranceGnome (10): "I never spent a dime on ads. Once you pick a niche, join the industry Facebook groups where your clients hang out. Do not spam, just wait for conversations where you can add value and show you understand their world. When people start asking for help, that is when you message them directly. I built trust by sharing tips that had nothing to do with buying from me, like safety guides since I am OSHA certified. Leave your two cents on as many posts as you can genuinely contribute to. Ideally do it from a personal profile instead of a business page, it gets much better organic reach. Once you start adding clients as friends, Facebook's algorithm does the heavy lifting. It will show you more people just like them, and that is where your next batch of leads usually comes from."

↳ InsuranceGnome (7): "TL;DR: Start with one niche and master it, keep costs low, lean into your strengths, buy back your time, and focus on turning your best skills into your biggest assets. P&C Insurance. Find a niche industry and learn as much as you can about it. For me, I did really well with service contractors and kept learning one trade after another. I often read policies cover to cover. I skim some sections, but I like to get a full understanding of how everything fits together. I kept software costs low at the start and added tools only when I could afford them. You do not need everything perfect to begin. It is better to get the ball rolling and improve along the way. Lean into your strengths. I am better with social media and chat since I am a gamer and always on my phone, so I made social media my number one funnel. Work with what you are naturally good at. Buy back time when you can. If you are bad at something like AMS entry, do not try to turn a zero into one hundred overnight. Hire someone on Fiverr to help while you also improve your own skills. Focus on turning A skills into A plus skills. The things you are weak at will improve over time, but your strengths will move the business forward faster."

↳ InsuranceGnome (5): "I went with Agentero because I was not planning on selling, and I was able to get my best commission rates by compiling everything under one broker. They were the only company I found that was willing to negotiate the contract. If you tell them you want to amend something, they will actually listen. It was by far the most personalized experience compared to Bolt, First Connect, or any others I reviewed."

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

↳ BluebirdFast3963 (16): "Work for an independent that has the best prices in my province, so nothing. They come to me. We have 25 companies. Provide quick quotes, quick binds, quick service when they need something done to their policy. A variety of ways they can reach out. Retain most of my clientele year over year. Re-market my current clients if I need too. The way it should be. This lead factory head hunting, farming for clients you barely know and paying for someone to send you a list of numbers is wild to me - is this common in America? I think the Canadian industry is a bit different. I don't know anyone who has to buy leads. Seems like an awful way to retain a trustworthy client base. Is it just dog eat dog down there, constantly churning through clients or what?"

↳ registeredfake (9): "I've got to say, it does not matter what question is asked by anyone in this sub every one think the answer is Independent this independent that. OP is asking for marketing ideas, is already an agent where he has invested his time and money to build something and your first thought is to go independent. stupid"

↳ Armstrongs_ball (7): "Stop. Buying. Leads. Go independent, network, build your book of business by referrals and word of mouth. After a few years, you'll be living off your book of business and getting referrals left and right from clients, assuming you provide good service. Buying leads is literally the biggest waste of \$ in this industry and it's not even close. And good luck actually retaining those clients. They'll be the first to leave after their auto rate increases \$10/month of their first renewal."

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Solution Soundbites are questions more than wishes: who to buy from, which FMO, what system.

Theme	Documents
Looking for a lead source that isn't a scam	27
Wanting a CRM or system that does the follow-up	21
Wishing for a mentor or real training	16
Looking for a new FMO / IMO that delivers	13
Wishing someone had told them the truth about the job	9
Wishing for leads that are real, exclusive and consented	7

Looking for a lead source that isn't a scam · 27 documents

"Best leads in 2024???? This video had nothing to do with helping agents find reputable lead sources. You mentioned 10 different lead gen sources (none to be named) and said nothing referring to the actual title of your vid. Try renaming to " Don't make these mistakes ". I was looking for actual usable content with names of companies that are skilled at lead gen and are reputable. Waste of 14 minutes."

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 I My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37g7CBMR8CY54AaABAq>

↳ @Peter_Roberts01 (44): "Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

↳ @itssmee1597 (9): "@Therealjames100you legit just did the same thing"

↳ @Therealjames100 (5): "You just wasted alot of time typing this pointless comment lol."

"Leads! So here's my situation. In the last few years, I've consistently closed 2 to 3 out of every 10 phone calls, and about 1 out of every 3 full pitches. But the agency I used to work for masked the lead provider and changed the names, so we never actually knew where the leads came from. Now that I'm working for myself, finding a solid lead provider has been way harder than I expected. I really didn't think it would be this difficult. Out of 46 ACA leads from NextGen, I've closed zero. Not even a maybe. Does anyone have recommendations for good lead providers, or even insight on how they generate their own leads? Open to any direction at this point."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/>

↳ FirearmConcierge (7): "DO NOT HIRE LEAD PROVIDERS They are all shit and will just take your money and not deliver and do dirty things to fuck you and your upline."

↳ Ashamed_Promise7726 (6): "Following to hear others input. We have been struggling with quality leads as well. And I'm not talking we expect to close every deal, but we have purchased a ton of internet leads who said that they never requested a quote in the first place (InsuranceQuotes, Everquote, etc.). We understand its a numbers game at the end of the day. But we at least want a chance to win their business, and we aren't even getting that most of the time and just spending money on leads with 0 potential."

↳ MysticMaxwell (3): "This is your chance to stand out and be helpful. I get leads all the time that say they didn't request anything, tired of the calls/texts, or any excuse they want to use. Call with purpose. You are calling because you are reviewing the recent changes, since it shows they have not updated their options for next year. Hey \ [first].....glad I was able to catch you. I am actually calling to review your \ \ \ \ \ options for next year. Now this is not a sales call quite yet, but if you give me 2 mins, I can review a couple options and make sure you are in the best spot. If so, we end the call there.....sound fair? Generate your own leads. Talk to everyone you meet. Figure out your advantage and find the people that can use the help."

"What lead vendors work for you? I'm a face to face final expense agent. I was using cheaper internet leads from integrity, social insurance leads, and leads direct. They aren't exclusive but they're anywhere from \$1-11 so I can get a lot of them, and if you dial enough you'll set up enough appointments. The ROI was great. As of recently though, they're just bad. And I've been with companies in the past that have had BAD leads before, I'm used to having to dial a lot and overcome objections, but this just isn't the way anymore. I've tried Facebook ads myself and I've come to the conclusion I'm just not a good marketer. It takes a lot of trial and error and time to figure it out so unless there's somewhere that'll give me a copy and pasted proven ad to post, I've decided it's not worth it. I'll take any recommendations on any direct mail or internet lead vendors. What works for you guys?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxcl1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/

↳ DavidDuford (5): "I'll second u/NAF1138 - just work direct mail leads. Aged direct mail leads can be great if you can find a quality distributor. Facebook leads can be good but you'll have a bunch more travel time to work them effectively."

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you sell face to face, you should ONLY work direct mail. All other lead types are only good for filler leads or telesales. There are lots of good direct lead vendors The Lead Connection Lead Concepts Need a Lead RGI Are some places to start."

↳ dis_iz_funny_shit (4): "I've got a direct face to face method for finding new leads in the field - mortgage protection leads --- so the tool helps you find people in any area that just bought a home in the last few months. It helps you locate a phone number also about 60-70% of the time"

Wanting a CRM or system that does the follow-up · 21 documents

"These appointments are good, but there is an additional follow up question that I would believe needs to be asked to ensure the actual appointment is able to be closed. An additional question I would ask is, "besides yourself, is there anybody else that needs to hear and see the information when I arrive? If so, will they be there, too?"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 115 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=Ugww1Q61-0Bd46Njlv4AaABAq>

↳ @charlesphoenix4383 (12): "Yes. You want all of the decision makers present. A husband may be the prime decision maker, but he will require input from his significant other... Your statement is on point."

↳ @MyDiscountsNow (5): "@ModeCyber I have 25 years in sales. :)"

"Advice for Final Expense Startup (High-Volume Cold Calling Team) Hi everyone, I'm planning to start selling final expense insurance within the next month or two. I'll be going all-in on cold calling and wanted to get feedback from experienced agents before launch. My Plan: I'll (22M) be working with my two 18-year-old brothers and operating in new york state Each of us will make 1,000 cold calls/day, 6 days a week We'll work 12-13 hour shifts, using a CRM + power dialer system We plan to buy leads daily at \$0.30 to \$0.50 each We're all bilingual (English/Spanish) and comfortable with high-volume sales We're not strangers to long hours or consistent effort — and we plan to maintain tone and energy throughout. Goals: Start with final expense sales Gradually add Medicare Scope of Appointments (SOA), enrollments, and eventually Medicare Supplements After a few months of production, I plan to negotiate a 140% commission contract We're expecting a 0.3% to 0.5% close rate based on what we've researched A friend of mine who only does medicare will share his hot leads with me since i will do final expense so i am guaranteed some early success at least if i dont screw it up --- My Questions: 1. Is this call volume and close rate realistic for a new team using aged or low-cost leads? 2. Is there anything crucial I'm overlooking in terms of compliance, licensing, or daily execution? 3. Are there any CRM + dialer combos you highly recommend for high-volume final expense/Medicare telesales? 4. For Medicare broker changes, is it realistic to expect consistent volume or are those more seasonal? 5. Are there any major red flags or rookie mistakes we should avoid early on? 6. Any advice for scripting, retention, or mental pacing during long dialing days? Thanks in advance — I really respect the grind this industry takes and want to do it the right way."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkha/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/

↳ DavidDuford (7): "Guaranteed Issue = lapse-o-matic. Arguably better to just not write it."

↳ SnooLemons398 (5): "If you're gonna do final expense, make sure one or more carriers can do guaranteed policies. There are a lot of sick people out there. There are also many poor people out there. Make sure they can afford it, or you'll see more chargebacks than you think. Try to close on the first call. 80% of FE appointments are a no show. Good luck!"

↳ DavidDuford (3): "What I would do if I were you: 1. Scrub your data against a litigator and changed number list on a regular basis. 2. Get Convoso. Kixie is OK. Most other dialers are terrible. Connection rate is everything. 3. Move out of New York. You cannot get contracted in New York with American Amicable as a New York resident. AmAm is arguably the best final expense telesales carrier available. Answers to your questions: 1. Maybe. Biggest levers to get best results: 1. Script and skillset 2. Dialer to maximize connection rates. 2. See above. 3. Convoso only. 4. Stay away from DSNP. 5. 100% TCPA compliance adherence. 6. Set daily activity goals. Consider bonuses/rewards for hitting call/conversion goals."

"I would strongly recommend automating reminders. Use every channel available. Email. SMS. Phone calls. Voicemails. Every missed follow up is a leak in your funnel. Plug those leaks and the same leads you already have will start producing far more revenue over time. If you are serious about growth, this massive fix you can make."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qrb80b/none_of_my_prospects_are_answering_my_calls_after/o2mxixs/

Wishing for a mentor or real training · 16 documents

"I'm a new agent and looking for a IMO that provides proper mentoring and training. I'm currently with an IMO but not a fan of the environment. I want honest sales and reliable income."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq8czox/

"@RedShipsofSpainAgain To be clear Im talking about dental insurance, not health insurance. The original commentor I was responding to said they were looking for dental. The waiting periods for dental make 100% sense. If there werent waiting periods then dental insurance companies would go out of business immediately and dental insurance wouldnt exist. Just think it through logically, if there is no waiting period, then people wouldnt buy dental insurance until they need it. So now, in this example, someone needs some work done thats going to cost them \$3000. They then buy a dental insurance policy for like \$30 - \$50/month, get the work done, make the dental insurance company pay their claim, and then they just cancel the insurance once the work is done. The insurance company made \$30 - \$50 off you but you made them pay hundreds or thousands of dollars. There would be zero reason for you to keep paying your monthly premium because you would just wait until you need some work again and then buy the insurance again. Obviously, that wont work and the company would go under in month 1. With that said for health insurance, its normally just a 14 or 30 day waiting period. And thats because plans have a 30 day free look period. Meaning if for any reason you decide to cancel your plan in the first 30 days, they would refund your first premium. So imagine you get the insurance, go to the hospital or put any claim in and make the insurance company pay out your claim, which again is hundreds or thousands, then you just cancel the policy during the free look period and they refund you your money. You just stole from the insurance company, in that example, they made nothing from you but you got paid out thousands. With that said, I do have access to plans where you could get service immediately, although maybe at a slightly reduced benefit amount, but I always advise my clients to just wait the 30 days. Also, in any other insurance, whether its car insurance or house insurance. You cant wait for your car to get into an accident and then try to buy car insurance and make them pay for your accident. Or wait till your house burns up in flames and then buy house insurance and make them pay for it. No insurance works that way, you need to be responsible and buy it before the issue occurs. So people, wait till they are really sick and need an operation and THEN want to finally get health insurance, once they already have a pre-existing condition. At that point your only option with pre-existing is employer plan or marketplace plan if its open enrollment. Marketplace plans have some waiting periods as well on pre-existing. But again, its just like any other insurance on anything, you cant expect to only buy insurance AFTER the thing they insure comes into question and then say, "insure this immediately!"

— YouTube · The Best and Cheapest Health Insurance for Freelancers in 2020 #freelance #healthinsurance · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pif7NmPTF-k&lc=UgZCKbTOPfgH56DiQZ4AaABAg.994WrBp-VGw99e48xTIVwW>

"Addiction Treatment Facility's Receptionist is Playing Medical Insurance Agent. A "Provider" can't make these types of recommendations? (hint: i'm noticing so much corruption in this industry...but I forget the specific laws regarding this situation). Hi All! I was a Group Medical Benefits Agent/Producer for 6 years...licensed...stopped in 2018. (I live in WA State but I imagine the laws for what I'm explaining here should probably be similar from state to state). I'm not in insurance now...I'm in an "adjacent" industry. Anyway, in late 2018 I got a DUI...and I've been completely sober since...don't judge. 😊 However, as part of the conditions from the court I was required to attend Intensive Outpatient Treatment. I went to a place my lawyer recommended. (I'm 90% positive he receives kickbacks from the treatment center for sending his clients with court orders...but that's for another post...this could easily become a series...truly...the crookedness—on so many layers—in the treatment industry is shocking...and they're doing it all in plain sight). Anyway, I'm 45-years-old...and there are a lot of young folks who attend the program with me. (Learned my lesson later In life maybe? 🙄) I found out that I'm paying MUCH more than MOST of the other people in my "group". My monthly out-of-pocket cost/monthly bill is much higher—obscenely higher—than most everyone else I attend with. I understand VERY well how every plan is different...they reimburse differently...cost shares vary as do deductibles and OOP Max's. I get that...I have BCBS of IL...I work for a large public ally-traded company and my insurance is considered "really good"...it reimburses well...\$1000 ded...and it's a 90% plan...but that's not the point of this post. This specific question came from a girl named Megan who just turned 21. (I changed her name to protect the...er...young :)). Anyway, when i asked her about her costs each month she told me that after a month of evening "groups" at "The Center"...the girl who answers phones at the front desk of the treatment center (she makes coffee for before groups too) told her, "Oh you should definitely change your insurance carrier to Amerigroup...it has WAY better coverage and "pays more". Then she said, "I tell EVERYONE to switch to them...I should get commission , haha!". Well...i talked to an old coworker who sells individual policies and, sure enough, Amerigroup definitely reimburses/pays the Treatment Provider aka "The Center" more...so Megan pays less. In other words...it's much better for "The Center" if more of their patients have Amerigroup as their carrier. When I heard this, my ex Agent/Producer ears perked up and I thought, "Wait...I'm pretty sure that NOBODY—in a professional setting, dealing with customers—is supposed to give insurance advice to relative strangers on what insurance to buy or what carrier they should choose, right? Or can they? But I'm pretty positive that Medical or Treatment Providers, specifically, aren't supposed to recommend specific carriers to their patients...or can they?" That's why I'm here asking. My opinion—due to several other reasons—is that this place is crooked and corrupt. First, I want to look into this practice at "The Center". In this specific instance, I'm quite sure the front desk staff has been coached on what plans to recommend "in passing"...and she is making these recommendations based on which Carriers/Plans "reimburse" the most to "The Center"...and she interfaces with 100s of clients/patients every day. Seems like a conflict of interest...right? The WA OIC probably wouldn't like this...ya? Pretty sure I had to take a test, work for a broker, and take C.E. classes periodically; in order to sell health insurance policies...yep...I do remember that. :) Can anyone explain the law here...I'm a bit rusty. Can the Provider in this case potentially be in hot water for this practice? What about the front desk receptionist herself? She is giving advice to people to switch carriers specifically based on how much it reimburses the Provider...or, "because this carrier covers more than your current carrier"...can she potentially be in trouble? Or is it "The Center" who would take the heat for training her that way? She's a nice girl...the front desk gal...but I'm afraid her corrupt overlords could get her in trouble. Thanks for reading all of that!!! This place is advising and billing lots of youngn's...but mostly bilking ACA/State-sponsored insurance plans/carriers...aka Uncle Sam. I kinda wanna "get em". Feel free to ask what else is corrupt there...I'm learning a LOT! :)"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/f4n1tg/addiction_treatment_facilitys_receptionist_is/

Looking for a new FMO / IMO that delivers · 13 documents

"Independent agent looking for IMO with no requirements — just carrier access Independent agent here. I run my own leads and dialer and don't need training or a system. Looking for a true hands-off IMO/FMO that offers: \- Street-level comp \- No required meetings or Zoom \- No CRM fees \- Full contract ownership Just want carrier access and to be left alone to produce. Any recommendations?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s75pbn/independent_agent_looking_for_imo_with_no/

↳ Hot-Trainer1209 (2): "Safe Life - use go high level for CRM, it's \$10/yr. Meet all your other requirements, if you want to learn about inbound leads, we have those too."

↳ Tahoptions (1): "Any of the large IMOs that service the financial advisor world would fit these requests. Crump, Ash, FIG, Back9, TMA, CPS, there are a ton of them."

↳ Dependent_Estimate83 (1): "Yeah, looking into crump right now, looks good!"

"I'm a new agent and looking for a IMO that provides proper mentoring and training. I'm currently with an IMO but not a fan of the environment. I want honest sales and reliable income."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq8czox/

"I'm primarily looking for a FMO that will send me a birthday card."

— Insurance-Forums.com · What is important to you in selecting an upline FMO? · 4 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/what-is-important-to-you-in-selecting-an-upline-fmo.94948/#post-1259111>

Wishing someone had told them the truth about the job · 9 documents

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This lead to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

↳ UpOutThatJam (36): "I'm always confused on if big red is the umbrella or the farm."

↳ TheHiddenMessenger (26): "In this case the farm lol. I'm the same way with "big blue". Is it the emu or the good hands"

↳ snuggly-kitten (18): "This is one of the reasons I'm terrified of leaving my position at a smaller carrier. I've been asked to apply at places that pay more and couldnt do it. I can figure out almost anything on my own with a couple emails. Your experience is my worst nightmare. What are your next steps, if you don't mind sharing?"

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

↳ idontknowhow2reddit (7): "I agree with all of this. Insurance is a crazy world so there's a ton of things to learn. The textbook and real world are very different so I would try to find an established company with good training to work for first. Without that, it will be hard to build a referral base or to gain that trusted advisor role. Your network and other professionals are going to need to see you in the industry a bit before they will trust you on your own."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (5): "Congrats! For someone who also got into insurance later in my career. 1. Pick one product and master it, then move into the second one, and so on. Medicare, ACA, Final Expense, Annuities, etc. 2. Training. Master that product and then move to the second. W 2 or Captive will give you the most training. 40 a week of training vs 1 or 2 hours a week. 3. Pick the right organization. Know the difference between recruiters selling me vs legitimate interviews. I wish someone told me about how many recruiters would try to sell me and then offer no support. I am so glad I left and went into a W2 to learn and get practice but I wish someone told me how difficult releases were! Best of luck but honestly someone with your degree of previous success should be fine. Just remember you're not gonna make as much money at first. You'll probably need to go independent to make more than 125k. However, I would suggest to build that foundation first but as long as you know what you're getting into I think you'll do great."

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (5): "If I had to start over today, the first thing I'd do is choose my upline very carefully. The wrong agency/upline can cost you years of your career. Second, I'd pick one niche and master it before trying to sell everything. Too many new agents want to do Medicare, ACA, final expense, annuities, group benefits...and end up not getting very good at any of them. Third, I'd get in front of people every single workday. Nothing replaces activity. I'd rather have a decent script and 15 appointments than the perfect script and no one to talk to. The biggest mistakes I'd avoid are buying into recruiting hype (MLMs), signing contracts without understanding release policies, and spending time on useless activities, like tweaking logos, trying to figure out every detail of CRMs, or building websites than actually selling. I would absolutely suggest joining an agency first. I'd choose one based on transparency, track record, proven training and scripts, and upline (again, upline is very important). Make sure you're paid directly by the carriers, understand exactly how releases work (get it in writing), and ask a lot of questions before you sign anything. Once you start selling, consistency is key. Focus on activity, because your input determines your output. Work hard, follow your upline's advice and system, and don't get distracted by other opportunities or anything else."

Wishing for leads that are real, exclusive and consented · 7 documents

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

↳ Neither-Historian227 (19): "I had a dozen death threats during the pandemic when government locked everyone down and destroyed their businesses, this is cake walk"

↳ NovelMotor7972 (13): "Are you kidding me? I deal with crazy people for a living. Lol I've literally had people misstate their income on a recorded line, make a complaint against me to the office of financial regulation, and cause a whole ordeal over their own tax penalty, because they misstated their income. I learned my lesson, every single one of them signs a disclosure that this is the income that they are stating."

↳ BroWeBeChilling (12): "It wears on youafter ten years I have heard it all. About 20% of the people are always unhappy. This has worn on me everyday especially since most people don't take responsibility for not paying their bills, their bank made a mistake, they never got a notice in the mail or to their email. Then they take it out on me. I try brushing it off but for sure after one heart attack my life is shortening everyday."

"You are spending a grand a week and your ending up with only a few "premium" ...your stuck in a tiered system. Who is your imo ...symmetry ...NASB...ffl...they all do that to agents. Not cool. For a grand a week (which is a good budget) you should be getting brand new exclusive leads ...no aged recycled leads....none. Aged are good if they are super cheap ...but why bother if you have the budget for new? As far as the FB lead campaigns ...we use them ...they are good for agents so you have the control of your own leads. All fresh ...never re sold...and you know where they come from. The cost is so much better. We also use live transfers...again that way you know its your lead...and they are interested. Good luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mfu7pr/considering_trying_a_facebook_lead_campaign/n6jpo6o/

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage.m, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Theme	Documents
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A book of business paying renewals · 64 documents

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

↳ MonLower (39): "Feeling good about being independent and part of multiple agent associations. While this industry is far from perfect, this is the best place to be in my estimation. I feel bad for the SF agents that are up against serious changes. State Farm is quite offended by Progressive taking their spot and is looking to get more flexible to compete. My carriers have lowered commission rates, but often times will renege due to our agencies ability to place with other carriers. Overall, comp has decreased in my 15 years but not to the point of being unsustainable. A few percentage points with most large carriers."

↳ Splodingseal (19): "It's a shit or get off the pot approach. They want agents that are hungry to write as much business as possible and to get rid of Bob and his secretary that kinda coast along only writing as much as he needs to keep the lights on."

↳ firenance (18): "Independents are more insulated as carriers tend to influence performance with contract terminations or adjusting profit share or bonus commission metrics. They don't like you, they just fire you."

"Imo owner now, it when I was independent as a Final Expense and Medicare agent I grossed 500k a year for 7 years in a row and 300k for several years before that. My first year in the business it was 180k. Net was lower, I had to buy my own leads, pay my own business expenses. But I don't know that I ever had more than 100k in expenses a year. I was an exceptionally good agent and I made sure to write business that paid renewals which is how my income grew to be so high."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq85spe/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

↳ DonicaLewinsky69420 (16): "Ask every client and new prospect for referrals. Let them know how important it is to you. Be the business. Not the Business professional. Live it, breathe it, learn it."

↳ FuzzyDice_12 (7): "My tips: 1) Networking: I'm an introvert that comes across as an extrovert. Great for sales but I dread going to events and force myself to go. Staying connected and going to Insurance Events, opens up connections, some you may not realize for years later. Perfect example is while I'm young, I got into insurance and owning my agency at 21ish. Many of the contacts at brokerages I've made, jump ship to other brokerages. The friendship will get you an appointment where normally you couldn't have. 2) Agency Software: This one is a big one. Many of the softwares are expensive and slow. Sometimes agents, when opening their own agencies, use the software from their previous agency, with outdated tech, solely because of familiarity. I learned this lesson the hard way. Thousands a year on crappy agency software. 3) Turning 1 New Business Insured and the policy they chose to have you quote, into multiple policies and new leads. This one is big. 4) This is personal to my niche (small/medium accounts are \$100k+), and builds on 3. Offer several smaller quotes for lines of insurance applicable to your line of business the insured may not have/have been offered previously, even if you don't think the insured will be interested. "If Any" Workers Comp would be applicable for my lines of business. 5) create partnerships with other independent agencies and agents. Self explanatory I would think. 6) SOP's, and building the agency with Franchising in mind. 7) Calendar: setting up reminders to touch base on insured's. If you are coming around only at renewal time, you easily become an agent that is replaceable. 8) As an agency owner, not only having SOP's, but understanding how every moving part of your agency works. From accounting, to customer service, to certificates of insurance, and on and on. Excuse any typos (at the barber shop), but this is what I could think of off the top of my head, and while some sections are more important than others, I didn't number them in any particular order."

↳ ChrisPbacon969 (5): "Commenting to follow along. I'm about to get started on my p and c journey."

Six figures, or the month it finally worked · 58 documents

"Sales jobs that pay more than 100-120k a year Just curious it seems like most of us are around 80-120k a year in our sales jobs no matter what industry we are in. Is there industries that pay more? Like 150-200k a year? I do have one of my ex coworkers that just reached out to me and sent me his ytd\$ for last year and it was 265k selling Medicare supplements/FE&life seems too good to be true tho."

— r/sales · 154 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/ru0huv/sales_jobs_that_pay_more_than_100120k_a_year/

↳ [deleted] (146): "Saas. I have a \$200k OTE in midmarket. Enterprise is \$250-260k. That's just the OTE. A guy in my team took down over \$300k this year"

↳ Both-Ad-7757 (90): "Cloud sales is really lucrative. I made 150K as an SDR at a FAANG company my first year."

↳ Hunththatmoney (42): "Damn, like it's only been a couple of days"

"Imo owner now, it when I was independent as a Final Expense and Medicare agent I grossed 500k a year for 7 years in a row and 300k for several years before that. My first year in the business it was 180k. Net was lower, I had to buy my own leads, pay my own business expenses. But I don't know that I ever had more than 100k in expenses a year. I was an exceptionally good agent and I made sure to write business that paid renewals which is how my income grew to be so high."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/hq85spe/

"Independent insurance agent a viable career? I have a buddy who's been in the industry for 11 years and he's quite obviously very successful. He suggested that I get into the business as he knows I'm at a career crossroads and looking to make more money. For a bit of background, I'm married with 3 young children. My wife is in a position to keep us afloat while I build my business. I'd be working as an independent sales agent utilizing warm leads and marketing tools from Alliance Group. My buddy said he made 110k his first year (with a few years prior sales experience) and he said he's confident I can make at least 70k my first year without working 80 hour weeks. He's going to fly down to take me out on sales calls. We'd split the initial commission from whatever sales we close that week. This sounds like a great opportunity and I don't mind hustling to get myself established in the industry but I don't want to put everything I have into this if what he's saying sounds far fetched."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/pkdfdw/independent_insurance_agent_a_viable_career/

↳ Islandbeachandrum (23): "To be honest, insurance is a GRIND the first couple years. It is incredibly rewarding once you have built up a book of business though. As an agency owner, I caution people who are the breadwinners of the household against jumping into the industry unless they are highly motivated by pressure, or are able to land a job at a large agency where there is a base plus commission (which can be shark tanks). Your situation sounds a little different since you have a wife who is able to float the family for a period of time, so you can take on more risk. One thing I would caution you on is that you'll be taking quite a bit of time away from your family the first couple years. They may not be 80 hour weeks, but there will be networking events, association events, breakfast meetings, etc, multiple times a week that carve into your family time. I viewed it as delayed gratification - I was investing in a much brighter future, and more time with my family, by putting in a ton of hard work while my kids were little. I don't know if this is helpful, but sometimes seeing real life numbers help me in evaluating a decision. And hey, I'm just a random guy on the internet, so I don't mind sharing details. Here is my career income progression as best as I can remember: * Year 1: \$18,500 * Year 2: \$34,000 * Year 3: \$57,000 * Year 4: \$104,000 * Year 5: \$130,000 * Year 6: \$237,000 (The year I opened my own agency with a partner) * Year 7: \$252,000 * Year 8: \$330,000 * Year 9: \$410,000 * Year 10: \$450,000 * Year 11: \$512,000 * Year 12: \$550,000+ As you can see, there is definitely a couple years where you are just trying to figure things out. Once you have a solid knowledge base, then you can work as hard as you want, but at a certain point, the growth becomes more linear than exponential due to the time constraints of dealing with your clients, staff, accounting, etc, etc. If there was one thing I would recommend, it's pick your niche early on and become the top 1% in the country in that one area. That was the year my income almost doubled. The years prior to that, I was floundering and writing anything and everything that came my way. You just can't optimize or streamline a bunch of random accounts like you can a niche or program. Edit: hit enter before I finished typing."

↳ aschaefer63 (9): "It is definitely a grind the first 2 years. Our path is slightly behind the other gentleman's. Year 1 was ugly, thankfully we had savings. Year 2 was easier and 3+ are much better. We are a health insurance agency that sells ancillaries and the odd life policies.: There are pros and cons to all areas of sales. For instance: life insurance has more chargebacks than Medicare which is why we took commission as earned - less financial risk to payback Medicare is subject to rules and regulations and the vagaries of politics. Life pays more up front, health pays longer term - so short term cash for life, long term renewals for Medicare. Life is more sales because you have to sell people on the need for it. 10,000 seniors turn 65 every day and need insurance. Life is year round and you have no real busy season. Medicare has open enrollment which is similar to tax season for accountants, but January through May (after you are established) are 20 to 30 hour work weeks. As you can see I prefer Medicare, but I am not blind to the fact that if you hate rules and details, you will hate Medicare. Whatever you do, learn to read books on your industry and sales, associate with top producers and put your customers interest before yours and you will get paid back in referrals."

↳ jhark1 (7): "This is why I became a broker 3 years ago, Already getting close to the 150k as an independent."

A lead source that finally paid · 22 documents

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"First off, get the MLM idea out of your head. The whole insurance industry is built upon uplines and downlines that is fully commission based. If you want a salary, you'll have to find an agency (whose commission based and has an upline) that'll pay you something fixed. Tough to find something like that for L&H compared to P&C. FE is great for upfront funds, but know that there can be quite a few chargebacks, so 30% of your commissions should go into a side-account to pay for these until you get your lead saturation up and your sales skill level established. Yes, Medicare is a grind unless you know how to cross-sell ancillary, then it's better than FE. In fact I recommend this track for newer FE agents: 1. Contract with someone that can train you and gives you fair contracts 100+% for FE and 20% for Medicare Supplements. 2. Get leads (facebook and direct mail) EVERY week in the same 50 sq mile area, and work them hard, spend 40 hours a week in the field, getting in front of as many people as possible. Build up a saturation level so that when you invariably door knock your leads and they say no or they're not home, you can just simply go two streets down and knock the guy you could never get ahold of a month or two ago. 3. Take some sample lead info and put it into a Medicare Quoting tool and find out whose competitive in your area for supplements, advantage plans etc. Start building your Medicare knowledge up. Of course, first past the AHIP so you have a base understanding for it. Just a few hours a week can help build up a wealth of knowledge. Once you understand how everything works, any changes to plans, companies or Medicare itself is easily assimilable - whereas there's no changes to FE usually. 4. Tell every lead you'll follow up with them in September to schedule a meeting in October to go over their Medicare options - because you do that too. If you don't sell anyone any FE, that's ok, offer to contact them in September for their Medicare, you "help seniors save money on their prescriptions and get extra benefits at no cost to them." If you paid for the lead, might as well get as much use out of them. 5. Selling FE sucks in November to December, the holidays. It's way easier to work with warm leads, sell them Medicare, and also increase your persistency lapse rate on your FE policies as well as bring in tons of referrals and get paid 2x as you would've just selling an FE policy. You could have enough leads to keep you busy all AEP, so that when that ends, you have a 2 week lull before New Years where you can start the whole cycle up again. THIS is the secret to making big bucks imo. Cody and Dave are good guys, Dave helped me out when I was where you were at, 12 years ago. He comes on here sometimes, haven't seen Cody on here yet."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/svjgsv/help_i_passed_accidenthealth_and_life_now_im/hxgcw8n/

"General question about leads Hey everyone, I've been lurking the sub for a bit and have seen some similar issues arise but wasn't sure about my current situation.. \-I'm a P/C agent and working towards my L/H, hopefully within the month. \-I'm with a larger well known captive carrier. The Agency I'm with has been hit with non-renewals, some of the highest in the region. \-The new agent owner took on the role from the dying book of business (85% of the book was local, most of that was bundled with the non renewals) \-The name of the company is scarred in the area so there are no referrals and few renewals coming in to generate business. \-The majority of the agent owners time is spent saving the few renewals he is able to save *albeit as much as x4 the original rate. He is not generating any new leads for the business and hasn't for nearly 8 months. \-This agency being my first producer role, I was enticed with the prospect of (wait for it) paid leads. I didn't know better at the time and hadn't browsed this sub yet. Apologies in advance lol. \-I've had nearly 200 incoming paid leads since I started 6 months ago. I text often, email weekly and call daily. I even created my own spreadsheet to track the leads since no CRM is available. (I tried Monday and enjoyed it but couldn't convince the owner to adopt this.) \-The majority of these leads are instant denials without opportunity to give alternative answers. The few who do answer, the quoted rate isn't competitive. Still, I keep trying. I asked the boss and he said just keep dialing the leads, even after a "no". \-Of these paid leads, I've closed 1 thus far. A few in the "in progress " stage but that's it. I've had a few inbound calls and of the 5 available, I've closed 4... So assuming that someone wants insurance and I can beat the coverage, rate and service, people are buying. \-I'm supposed to bind at least 3% and need to hit \$20k in sales each month to be eligible for the "agent owner program". \-The owner has lamented to me that my minimal \$ value of premium is very low (I'm averaging about \$500 per lead) AND he is upset with his input of money to pay for the leads.. \-I have requoted everyone at least 3 times and reached out to the 3000 odd old leads to cross sell, win back, etc. Using some math, at this rate I would need to bind more than 50% of the leads in a month's time to generate about \$10k in premium. My questions are: 1) What do you do to increase the amount of premium bound each month? 2) What do you do to increase the probability of direct contact with outbound leads? 3) Which paid lead companies work best or worst? 4) If you are unable to prospect in your local region, how do you generate business? Thanks for the read. I'm in a bit of a pickle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1snoujd/general_question_about_leads/

↳ CFactor11 (4): "Sounds like you're beating up aged digital leads. Owner is cattle prodding you to maximize lead conversion. OR Take a look inward. How are you handling the call? Building rapport? Making human/genuine connection? Creating real value and urgency?"

↳ KN0W-IDEA (2): "I just reached out to the local chamber of commerce, made a social media page and am attempting to contact some of the local developers. Trying to put my name out there. But the agent owner doesn't have enough time to do these things himself."

↳ KN0W-IDEA (1): "Thanks for the reply! I've been curious myself for both.. it feels like the top answer but I'm always open to feedback. I have asked for input on my delivery for the few leads I've been able to connect with. I have tried many different approaches but the answer is usually the same: "stop contacting me"."

AEP numbers: applications written · 18 documents

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

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"Very very little of what I studied for is my real life day to day. I only sale final expense for one carrier. I meet with 90% seniors. My company finances leads and they are really decent leads. I've been on the field 3 days for about 20 hours total and was driving ten of those hours and I have already sold 3 clients."

— YouTube · What To Expect Your First 90 Days As An Insurance Agent! · 33 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HF4onytfV3c&lc=UgzSDbo33pREln35Gzp4AaABA9>

↳ @fatomasow5151 (1): "Any updates as of today? How is it going? I'm just curious!"

↳ @joshacox3110 (0): "@fatomasow5151 it was a crock. I got back into factory supervision. It's basically a ponzie scheme. A few make it but most leave owing money."

↳ @justjordan4995 (0): "@joshacox3110what makes you say this? I'm about to take my test and trying to see what non YouTubers say/think about it"

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3g/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Theme	Documents
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Dialing and the phone, all day · 68 documents

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeeee/

↳ Typical-Mouse-4804 (231): "Ride the clock. Do bare minimum. Apply for jobs. Block calendar for interviews with DOCTOR APT and DMV and shit like that."

↳ Eswift33 (101): "Pre-record a script and have the recording play when someone answers. If they bite then close the deal. Do this all while playing PlayStation 🤪"

↳ ATLS_finest (88): "I'm always amazed when I hear about the sheer number of calls some SDR types make. 200 calls per day is 25 calls per hour for 8 hours per day. In my first sales job I was making 60-70 calls per day and I thought that was a lot. You would basically never put the phone down. Do you have other training, reporting or administrative tasks to do or do you literally just pick up the phone and dial for 8 hours straight?"

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGANT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

Service work: renewals, changes, client problems · 29 documents

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

↳ Neither-Historian227 (19): "I had a dozen death threats during the pandemic when government locked everyone down and destroyed their businesses, this is cake walk"

↳ NovelMotor7972 (13): "Are you kidding me? I deal with crazy people for a living. Lol I've literally had people misstate their income on a recorded line, make a complaint against me to the office of financial regulation, and cause a whole ordeal over their own tax penalty, because they misstated their income. I learned my lesson, every single one of them signs a disclosure that this is the income that they are stating."

↳ BroWeBeChilling (12): "It wears on youafter ten years I have heard it all. About 20% of the people are always unhappy. This has worn on me everyday especially since most people don't take responsibility for not paying their bills, their bank made a mistake, they never got a notice in the mail or to their email. Then they take it out on me. I try brushing it off but for sure after one heart attack my life is shortening everyday."

"It's my first day as an independent insurance agent! I used to be a captive agent but I didn't feel like I was able to provide the service I feel my community of artists so I quit and decided to become an independent agent. After 2 months of hemming and hawing applying to jobs in other sales fields I finally decided it was enough and found 2 IMOs. One focused on health the other focused on life and P&C. Today I signed my last contracts to be appointed with their major carriers and I started prospecting. I sent out maybe 50-70 linked in messages with one simple goal in mind. Ask 5 people to sit for an appointment with you. I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set. Then I went out networking and was able to book a second. 5 is tomorrow's number as well. I want to go a full week with 5 tasks every day except Sunday. As a wise poet from the San Francisco Bay Area once said, "I'm feeling myself"."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/

↳ QuiriousCoyote (3): "Nice to hear a positive story. Keep up the good work and good luck!"

↳ theimprovednatee (2): "What's systems? I work with 7 realtors who send me business VERY consistently. I don't want to be a captive agent anymore"

↳ Toppoppler (1): "You work with artists? As a new captive producer, thats the market I want to work within as its the market I come from. Would you have any tips on finding/connecting with artists, what type of coverages they might need, etc?"

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

↳ idontknowhow2reddit (7): "I agree with all of this. Insurance is a crazy world so there's a ton of things to learn. The textbook and real world are very different so I would try to find an established company with good training to work for first. Without that, it will be hard to build a referral base or to gain that trusted advisor role. Your network and other professionals are going to need to see you in the industry a bit before they will trust you on your own."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (5): "Congrats! For someone who also got into insurance later in my career. 1. Pick one product and master it, then move into the second one, and so on. Medicare, ACA, Final Expense, Annuities, etc. 2. Training. Master that product and then move to the second. W 2 or Captive will give you the most training. 40 a week of training vs 1 or 2 hours a week. 3. Pick the right organization. Know the difference between recruiters selling me vs legitimate interviews. I wish someone told me about how many recruiters would try to sell me and then offer no support. I am so glad I left and went into a W2 to learn and get practice but I wish someone told me how difficult releases were! Best of luck but honestly someone with your degree of previous success should be fine. Just remember you're not gonna make as much money at first. You'll probably need to go independent to make more than 125k. However, I would suggest to build that foundation first but as long as you know what you're getting into I think you'll do great."

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (5): "If I had to start over today, the first thing I'd do is choose my upline very carefully. The wrong agency/upline can cost you years of your career. Second, I'd pick one niche and master it before trying to sell everything. Too many new agents want to do Medicare, ACA, final expense, annuities, group benefits...and end up not getting very good at any of them. Third, I'd get in front of people every single workday. Nothing replaces activity. I'd rather have a decent script and 15 appointments than the perfect script and no one to talk to. The biggest mistakes I'd avoid are buying into recruiting hype (MLMs), signing contracts without understanding release policies, and spending time on useless activities, like tweaking logos, trying to figure out every detail of CRMs, or building websites than actually selling. I would absolutely suggest joining an agency first. I'd choose one based on transparency, track record, proven training and scripts, and upline (again, upline is very important). Make sure you're paid directly by the carriers, understand exactly how releases work (get it in writing), and ask a lot of questions before you sign anything. Once you start selling, consistency is key. Focus on activity, because your input determines your output. Work hard, follow your upline's advice and system, and don't get distracted by other opportunities or anything else."

Texting, voicemail and follow-up · 13 documents

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This lead to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

↳ UpOutThatJam (36): "I'm always confused on if big red is the umbrella or the farm."

↳ TheHiddenMessenger (26): "In this case the farm lol. I'm the same way with "big blue". Is it the emu or the good hands"

↳ snuggly-kitten (18): "This is one of the reasons I'm terrified of leaving my position at a smaller carrier. I've been asked to apply at places that pay more and couldnt do it. I can figure out almost anything on my own with a couple emails. Your experience is my worst nightmare. What are your next steps, if you don't mind sharing?"

"Big Daddy leads (BDL) Leads Review TL;DR: Tried Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection. Lots of disconnected numbers (they did replace some), most people never picked up despite hammering them with 8–10 calls a day + texts, and the show rate was awful. The ones who did pick up all expected their entire mortgage covered at ~70 years old. I tried downselling to equity protection/payment protector, but they wanted all-or-nothing. Honestly, you'll get better results just running your own ads. And yes I did track my numbers for everything. --- I tested Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection recently and wanted to share an honest review for anyone thinking about it. Lead quality: Pretty bad overall. I got a lot of disconnected numbers — to be fair, they did replace those — but even with the "good" ones, most people didn't answer after I hammered them: 8–10 calls a day, double-dialing, leaving voicemails once, and texting every time. Show rate was rough. Expectations: This was the biggest killer. Every single MP lead I got seemed to expect their whole mortgage covered. I did try to downsell into equity protection/payment protector plans (covering monthly payments for a set amount of time), but they flat-out didn't want it. It was whole coverage or nothing. And look — I've been doing this for years, I'm a ~\$30k/month producer, I know how to handle objections, but I couldn't flip that expectation. These leads were just set up the wrong way from the start. How they generate leads: You don't control or even see the ads. They run simple image ads into Facebook lead forms, optimized for cheapest CPL, not quality. If you've been around marketing, you know that's not the same thing. Not trying to bash them unfairly — just being real about my experience."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nxhzu2/big_daddy_leads_bdl_leads_review/

↳ joeboo5150 (5): ">> you don't control or even see the ads This is one of the biggest problems with lead vendors. The ads they are using to produce clicks and gather contact info are RIDICULOUS. Auto insurance ads promoting \$19.99/mo car insurance. Home insurance ads promoting \$500/yr home insurance, etc. They run the most unbelievably ridiculous ads that prey on the most gullible and uninformed portions of the population and the entire process starts off under a horrible set of expectations."

↳ TeamDisrespect (1): "Had a lead provider run "Senior Citizens get FREE insurance thanks to (dubious made up government program)" Literally people answering asking how they can sign up for the free insurance."

↳ No-Background-4858 (1): "Thanks for the heads up"

"The date of the accident was today and she formally requested "both Comprehensive and collision please" over text last Wednesday to me. I tried going in there today and making an endorsement backdating 3 days ago but I'm sure they will see that and question it or deny the claim, so I don't know what I should do"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/nb2eytp/

Driving to appointments and kitchen tables · 13 documents

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

↳ idontknowhow2reddit (7): "I agree with all of this. Insurance is a crazy world so there's a ton of things to learn. The textbook and real world are very different so I would try to find an established company with good training to work for first. Without that, it will be hard to build a referral base or to gain that trusted advisor role. Your network and other professionals are going to need to see you in the industry a bit before they will trust you on your own."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (5): "Congrats! For someone who also got into insurance later in my career. 1. Pick one product and master it, then move into the second one, and so on. Medicare, ACA, Final Expense, Annuities, etc. 2. Training. Master that product and then move to the second. W 2 or Captive will give you the most training. 40 a week of training vs 1 or 2 hours a week. 3. Pick the right organization. Know the difference between recruiters selling me vs legitimate interviews. I wish someone told me about how many recruiters would try to sell me and then offer no support. I am so glad I left and went into a W2 to learn and get practice but I wish someone told me how difficult releases were! Best of luck but honestly someone with your degree of previous success should be fine. Just remember you're not gonna make as much money at first. You'll probably need to go independent to make more than 125k. However, I would suggest to build that foundation first but as long as you know what you're getting into I think you'll do great."

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (5): "If I had to start over today, the first thing I'd do is choose my upline very carefully. The wrong agency/upline can cost you years of your career. Second, I'd pick one niche and master it before trying to sell everything. Too many new agents want to do Medicare, ACA, final expense, annuities, group benefits...and end up not getting very good at any of them. Third, I'd get in front of people every single workday. Nothing replaces activity. I'd rather have a decent script and 15 appointments than the perfect script and no one to talk to. The biggest mistakes I'd avoid are buying into recruiting hype (MLMs), signing contracts without understanding release policies, and spending time on useless activities, like tweaking logos, trying to figure out every detail of CRMs, or building websites than actually selling. I would absolutely suggest joining an agency first. I'd choose one based on transparency, track record, proven training and scripts, and upline (again, upline is very important). Make sure you're paid directly by the carriers, understand exactly how releases work (get it in writing), and ask a lot of questions before you sign anything. Once you start selling, consistency is key. Focus on activity, because your input determines your output. Work hard, follow your upline's advice and system, and don't get distracted by other opportunities or anything else."

"Hey, I'm a new Agent, I got licensed less than a year ago. During my training, I was taught for that rebuttal was "I don't do any second appointments, because we shop every A Rated carrier today to see who you would get approved for." Something within them lines. To avoid that rebuttal, I was taught to ask who they make their financial decisions with & if they was around. Hope this helps."

— YouTube · LIVE Dialing: Cold Calling Insurance Leads (SCRIPT GIVEAWAY) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=POOoucTXJYc&lc=Ugxu8xdg4l-QqJxrU4x4AaABAq>

↳ @Countmoneyforever (4): "i think it helps! Also the better you qualify the better youll close. for example i always ask "who makes financial decisions for you?" and "if were able to find something affordable that meets your needs, when would you like that plan to start?" if they say today you keep going but if they say "im not sure" or anything else you gotta figure out why BEFORE you present any options! Our most important asset is time, dont let these ppl waste any"

↳ @bejrnews (0): "New agent here. How's your book of business doing?"

Quoting, applications and carrier portals · 12 documents

"Man, totally get how you feel. All week last week, I had 15 Medicare Appointments no show me. By some Miracle, I got 2 T65 enrollemnts yesterday and another 3 T65 today. about \$3900 in commission. Making me feel like me chasing people around last week was worth it I guess."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1le5o1e/i_bought_an_ad_funnel_and_while_ive_booked_a_lot/mydnrpy/

"Okay. I mostly just do Medicare. I am licensed in everything. I get \$250 - \$350 per enrollment, and they supply all the calls. I make my own hours. During AEP, which is 10/15 - 12/7, I did 170 enrollments working around 6 hours a day. The go-getters did 400+ enrollments. The second busy season is 1/1 - 3/31. After that, I'll do some odd jobs until next season. I do have the option of grinding it out all year. They are going to incorporate life insurance, along with Medicare and ACA, to keep us busy. I'd rather not work the slower season because you have more opportunities for personalities to clash when it's slow, and management needs something to do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pwf3y3/how_much_do_insurance_brokers_actually_make/nwgjplm/

"Well this is where thr studying comes in. I the first quarter you have OEP and in the rest of the year (ROY) you have various other enrollment periods and 10k people turning 65 every day. Lots of opportunities. But you have to learn to understand the system first. Your ability to sell is directly proportional to how well you can navigate Medicare and the various rules."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f81t9g/nyc_im_a_terrible_life_insurance_agent_can_i_sell/ldlzz3/

AEP and enrollment season hours · 8 documents

"Medicare Agent Needs Help Finding Clients Hello, I'm seeking advice from Medicare agents that are finding clients. I'm two years in and pretty much only have friends for clients. To pay the bills I'm working a part time job in the afternoons and evenings. I work on my Medicare business in the mornings. I have tried various things but have not gotten much traction. I have several financial advisors that send my name out with a list of other Medicare professionals when a client is a few months before 65. I have only gotten one client from that. I manned a table at CVS every day during AEP and spoke with a least a few people each day. That led to one client. I have been attending networking groups 3 times a week where we refer clients to each other whenever possible. I have had one referral and that has not become a client yet. The bulk of my clients have just been friends or friends of friends that I've known for years. My clients all really like me and feel that I have helped them tremendously. The problem is it is simply going too slowly. At this point, I'm planning to continue with the networking groups but maybe reduce to one or two days a week. I'm considering reaching out to more financial advisors. I'm considering hitting up all of the P & C folks in my area and seeing if they want to partner with a Medicare person. Reluctantly, I'm considering spending money on direct mail campaigns or maybe transfer phone call leads. I've heard such mixed opinions on those I'm not sure what to think but willing to try. I'm a bit on my own and could really benefit from the wisdom and experience of some of you that are succeeding. Would love to know what you consider worth doing and what you consider a waste of time."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kp95ck/medicare_agent_needs_help_finding_clients/

"Okay. I mostly just do Medicare. I am licensed in everything. I get \$250 - \$350 per enrollment, and they supply all the calls. I make my own hours. During AEP, which is 10/15 - 12/7, I did 170 enrollments working around 6 hours a day. The go-getters did 400+ enrollments. The second busy season is 1/1 - 3/31. After that, I'll do some odd jobs until next season. I do have the option of grinding it out all year. They are going to incorporate life insurance, along with Medicare and ACA, to keep us busy. I'd rather not work the slower season because you have more opportunities for personalities to clash when it's slow, and management needs something to do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pwf3y3/how_much_do_insurance_brokers_actually_make/nwgjplm/

"Well this is where the studying comes in. In the first quarter you have OEP and in the rest of the year (ROY) you have various other enrollment periods and 10k people turning 65 every day. Lots of opportunities. But you have to learn to understand the system first. Your ability to sell is directly proportional to how well you can navigate Medicare and the various rules."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f81t9g/nyc_im_a_terrible_life_insurance_agent_can_i_sell/ldlzz3/

Tab 10 — Buyer Summary

Who this person is, what they believe, what stops them and how to reach them. Counts are documents in this page's voice; every chart is measured from what they wrote about themselves, never assumed.

The one-line ICP: An independent Medicare, ACA or health agent (many in their first years, some building a team) whose whole year rides on leads: they have bought leads that were old, shared or never answered, they are doing the math on what a lead costs against what an enrollment pays, and they will buy again from a source that proves who consented, to whom, and what happens when the number is bad.

TLDRWho: 4,220 first-person agent documents (4,092 health / general agents, 76 life or final-expense agents talking about buying leads, 52 new or aspiring agents) from r/InsuranceAgent, agent Facebook groups, Insurance-Forums.com and agent YouTube. Property & casualty agents, call-center staff, vendors and recruiters are excluded. The lead is the whole job: Previous Solutions is the largest tab (440 documents bought leads from vendors, 141 aged leads, 164 transfers and inbound calls, 124 self-generated), and the top frustration after MLM recruiting is leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer (124 documents). What they pay (published prices, median of the vendors' ranges, Medicare Advantage): aged records \$1.00–\$6.50, shared \$15–\$31, exclusive \$35–\$75, T65 \$45–\$90, live transfers / inbound calls \$58–\$109 per call. The Lead Sources tab lists every price agents wrote themselves, with its link. What an enrollment is worth, and what each lead type costs to get one: \$725 for a new Medicare Advantage enrollment in 2027 (CMS maximum), \$363 a year after; Medicare Supplement about \$502 in year one; ACA \$20–\$30 per member per month. At published rates one MA enrollment costs the agent \$48–\$312 from aged data, \$233–\$437 from transfers, \$516–\$1,106 from exclusive leads and \$1,958–\$3,982 from shared leads. Self-generated Meta leads (the agent's own campaign, exclusive): \$764–\$2,484 at the published stage benchmarks, \$165 in ads at one agent's measured T65 campaign (352 leads, 12 enrollments and rising) (Metrics tab). Who sells to them: 550 agent-facing Meta ads — 298 from lead, transfer and call sellers and 127 from agencies and FMOs recruiting agents with leads included. The most-used hooks: name the audience, 'exclusive / verified / compliant', and 'inbound calls, no dialing'. The read for Vince (hypothesis): agents don't need more lead sellers; they need leads they trust. Two production routes clear the market: calling aged data into held appointments, and your own self-generated Meta campaign if it converts like the one measured agent campaign (\$5.67 leads, 19% reaching a real conversation). At the generic stage benchmarks Meta leads do not clear, so measure your first 300 leads before pricing. Consent to one agent, a verified phone and a written replacement policy answer the top complaint directly.

Who they are — measured, not assumed

Each row counts distinct documents in which the writer states it about themselves in a first-person sentence. A document that does not state its age, plan or premium is simply not counted, so the bars show the mix among those who say, not the share of the market.

Their own age (self-stated)

n = 33 documents state the writer's age · median 36 among those already that age

Group	Documents
18–24	13
25–34	3
35–44	8
45–54	2
55–64	5
65+	2

Lines they sell or ask about

documents naming the line

Group	Documents
Medicare (Advantage, Supplement, Part D)	1,026
ACA / under-65 health	428
Life, IUL, annuities	371
Final expense	220
Property & casualty too	170

Where they are in the business (first-person sentence)

one document can sit in more than one row

Group	Documents
New: first year, just licensed	261
Independent / own agency	179
Captive or call-center background	114
Runs or is building a team	58
States years in the business	22

What they say they pay per lead, call or appointment

n = 35 documents give a per-unit price in a first-person sentence · median \$25 (all lead types mixed; the Lead Sources and Metrics tabs split them)

Group	Documents
under \$5	5
\$5–14	4
\$15–29	13
\$30–49	9
\$50–79	3
\$80–149	1

Gender self-markers

'my husband' / 'my wife', 'as a mom', '54F' and similar; documents with one kind of marker only

Group	Documents
Female markers	6
Male markers	32

States they say they live in

n = 23 documents name a home state

Group	Documents
Florida	7
California	5
Texas	2
Massachusetts	2
Kentucky	1
Colorado	1
Maryland	1
Illinois	1
North Carolina	1
Georgia	1
Iowa	1

Where this voice was found

buyer documents by source

Group	Documents
Reddit r/InsuranceAgent	2,300
YouTube comment threads	1,030
Insurance-Forums.com	704
Reddit r/InsuranceProfessional	65
Reddit r/sales	25
Facebook groups	21
TrustPilot reviews	18
Reddit r/HealthInsurance	14
Reddit r/medicare	12
Reddit r/obamacare	11

Who they are — the read

- 4,092 health / general agent documents; 76 life or final-expense agents on lead-buying threads; 52 new or aspiring agents. Every buyer tab prints its split.
- Stage (measured by source, not assumed): r/InsuranceAgent skews new and early-career agents asking what works; the agent Facebook groups and Insurance-Forums.com carry more working, independent Medicare / ACA agents.
- Read of the charts above: the documents that name a line name Medicare most, then ACA / under-65, then life and final expense; new agents and agents with a captive or call-center background are the most frequent self-descriptions.

What they believe

- Read of Tabs 5 and 6: most purchased leads are recycled, shared or not what was promised; the phone is the job; the money is in the book and the renewals, not the first commission.
- Read of Tab 5: MLM and captive agencies recruit on promises (28 documents), and CMS rules and carrier commission cuts can change the economics overnight (26).

The moment it changes

- AEP (Oct 15–Dec 7) and ACA OEP (Nov 1–Jan 15) — the lead-buying season; starting out after licensing; a lead vendor or FMO that stopped delivering; carriers cutting commissions for new enrollments.

What stops them

- Burned before by bad leads (124 documents; Dislikes: 38 leads that never answer).
- Cash: money spent on leads that did not pay back (64 fear documents).
- Compliance and chargeback exposure (11 fear documents; CMS recovers the full commission on changes in the first three months).

Where they are and how to reach them

- r/InsuranceAgent and r/InsuranceProfessional; agent Facebook groups (Insurance Agent Opportunities (USA); Medicare, ACA, & Life Agents and others); Insurance-Forums.com; agent YouTube (Cody Askins, Peter Roberts, David Duford, Medicare-agent channels).
- Meta reaches them with named-audience ads ('Medicare agents:', 'Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers!'); their own words for the product are 'exclusive', 'real-time', 'inbound calls', 'live transfers', 'aged leads', 'T65'.

Who to write to, and who not to

Segment A — write to them

- Independent Medicare agents entering AEP without a pipeline.
- ACA agents after the subsidy change who need fewer, better-qualified households.
- Agents leaving a captive, call-center or MLM start who now pay for their own leads.
- Agency owners buying for a floor (volume transfers, appointment programs).

Segment B — not the buyer (exclude, or the ads pay for them)

- Brand-new agents with no lead budget (they ask for free leads; the recruiters own that segment).
- Property & casualty agents (different leads, different buyers; excluded by the voice gate).
- Captive and call-center employees who are handed leads and do not buy them.
- Life and final-expense-only agents unless they also write Medicare or ACA.

The frame that works (hypothesis)

- Hypothesis from Tabs 4, 5 and 7: 'Consented to you, verified phone, never resold, replaced if bad' answers the complaints agents repeat most; the sellers already claiming it in ads show the market pays for it.

Each clause of the frame with the documents behind it:

Voice by source (every document, stamped)

104,229 documents in the shared corpus; 4,220 are buyer documents in this page's voice. Other voices stay in the corpus, labeled, and never enter these tabs.

Source	Documents	agent	agent life	aspirant	employee agent	pc agent	vendor	medicare self	medicare family	aca self	provider	press	other
youtube	68,633	1,163	47	38	14	12	5,863	9,818	182	1,050	177	1	50,268
reddit_comment	29,438	4,613	54	34	204	1,470	144	394	17	551	34	9	21,914
insurance_forums	2,323	879	0	7	0	0	145	2	0	0	0	5	1,285
trustpilot	1,928	22	0	0	0	0	0	43	1	3	0	0	1,859
reddit_post	1,861	453	20	13	48	94	28	70	7	189	3	2	934
fb_comment	35	14	0	1	0	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	15
fb_group	11	9	0	0	0	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	0

Buyer voices: agent 4,092 · agent life 76 · aspirant 52

Headlines

1. "Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk?" — Money spent on leads that don't pay back (64) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

2. "Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans." — Compliance, CMS and losing a contract or license (11) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAq>
3. "I hope I do well as an insurance agent :D I'm about to take the licensing exam." — Getting licensed, certified and started (23) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UfHT3xWq4TY&lc=UgwNWyFPgvNrc06hZcd4AaABAq>
4. "Thank God for my savings and residual base, but I want to make sure I'm not missing a gear." — A book of business and renewals that pay every year (21) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rgt03f/>
5. "Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed." — Friends and family: the warm market and the referrals (35) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_inco_me_experiencewarning/
6. "I told them i did exactly what they told me to do in the trainings." — What the recruiter, trainer or upline told them (28) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oezwib/just_got_fired/
7. "Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a lead", meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e." — Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer (124) · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/
8. "Eventually, he just hung up." — Prospects who ghost, no-show or already have an agent (60) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/
9. "I **JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** I" — Captive or call-center job first (281) · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/
10. "I was looking for actual usable content with names of companies that are skilled at lead gen and are reputable." — Looking for a lead source that isn't a scam (27) · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37q7CBMR8CY54AaABAq>
11. "These appointments are good, but there is an additional follow up question that I would believe needs to be asked to ensure the actual appointment is able to be closed." — Wanting a CRM or system that does the follow-up (21) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=Ugww1Q61-0Bd46Njvd4AaABAq>
12. "Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails." — A book of business paying renewals (64) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/
13. "Sales jobs that pay more than 100-120k a year" — Six figures, or the month it finally worked (58) · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/ru0huv/sales_jobs_that_pay_more_than_100120k_a_year/
14. "We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials." — Dialing and the phone, all day (68) · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeeee/
15. "Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride." — Service work: renewals, changes, client problems (29) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

Frequency Ranking

#	Theme	Documents	Where
1	Bought leads from vendors	440	Tab 6
2	FMO / IMO lead programs	417	Lead source
3	Captive or call-center job first	281	Tab 6
4	Referrals and their own book	279	Tab 6
5	Referrals and word of mouth	274	Lead source
6	Cold calling, door knocking, dialing	270	Lead source
7	Call centers / captive employers	223	Lead source
8	Seminars, events, workshops	169	Lead source
9	Live transfers and inbound calls (pay per call)	167	Lead source
10	Live transfers and inbound calls	164	Tab 6
11	Cold calling, door knocking and seminars	163	Tab 6
12	Aged leads	141	Tab 6
13	FMO / agency leads and 'free leads' programs	137	Tab 6
14	Google ads / search / SEO	134	Lead source
15	Google, SEO and a website	130	Tab 6
16	Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer	124	Tab 5
17	Self-generated leads (Facebook ads, own marketing)	124	Tab 6
18	Aged leads	123	Lead source
19	T65 lists, direct mail, mailers	120	Lead source
20	Dialers, CRMs and text campaigns	115	Tab 6
21	FMO / upline lock-in and release fights	109	Private worry
22	Named lead vendors (EverQuote, SmartFinancial, QuoteWizard, NextGen, Aged Lead Store, AllCalls...)	99	Lead source
23	Facebook groups, social media and content	97	Tab 6
24	Direct mail and T65 mailers	92	Tab 6
25	Facebook / Meta ads (self-generated)	87	Lead source
26	Lead vendors by name	81	Tab 6
27	Chargebacks and clawed-back commissions	71	Private worry
28	Dialing and the phone, all day	68	Tab 9
29	Money spent on leads that don't pay back	64	Tab 1
30	A book of business paying renewals	64	Tab 8
31	Chargebacks and clawbacks	64	Dislike
32	Compliance and carrier rules	63	Dislike
33	Prospects who ghost, no-show or already have an agent	60	Tab 5

34	Six figures, or the month it finally worked	58	Tab 8
35	CMS, carrier and TCPA exposure	55	Private worry
36	Pharmacies, doctors' offices and community partners	51	Tab 6
37	Exclusive real-time leads	50	Lead source
38	Carriers: non-commissionable plans, cuts and service	49	Tab 5
39	Bait-and-switch marketing ('free' benefits, 'free' policies)	46	Tab 5
40	Appointment setters and telemarketers	45	Tab 6
41	Booked appointments	44	Lead source
42	Money burned on leads that never answer	43	Private worry
43	TCPA, consent and do-not-call exposure	40	Tab 5
44	FMOs and uplines that own the book or won't release	40	Tab 5
45	Leads that never answer or are fake	38	Dislike
46	Friends and family: the warm market and the referrals	35	Tab 3
47	Commission cuts and carriers pulling commissions	31	Dislike
48	What a lead costs against what a sale pays	30	Tab 5
49	Service work: renewals, changes, client problems	29	Tab 9
50	MLMs and captive agencies that recruit on promises	28	Tab 5
51	What the recruiter, trainer or upline told them	28	Tab 4
52	Looking for a lead source that isn't a scam	27	Tab 7
53	CMS rules and commission caps	26	Tab 5
54	Shared real-time leads	26	Lead source
55	HealthSherpa / marketplace tools (ACA)	24	Lead source
56	Getting licensed, certified and started	23	Tab 2
57	Not making money, no sales, broke in year one	23	Private worry
58	A lead source that finally paid	22	Tab 8
59	'Don't buy leads, generate your own'	22	Tab 4
60	A book of business and renewals that pay every year	21	Tab 2

Awareness → Offer Map

Each level describes where a buyer actually is. "Where they are" is their own sentence from this page; the hooks and offers under it are proposals built from that language, labeled as hypotheses until tested.

Where they are

They passed the exam, signed with an agency or FMO and were told the leads would come. They are finding out that the leads are the business and that they pay for them.

"Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 1 (hypotheses)

A first-AEP lead budget worksheet: lead type, price, contact rate, enrollments.

A 20-minute call that fits a lead type to their budget and close rate.

A small capped starter order with a script and a call schedule.

Where they are

Wrong numbers, disconnected lines, people who never asked for a quote, the same lead sold to five agents. They are warning each other off vendors by name.

"Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 2 (hypotheses)

Six questions to ask any lead vendor before paying (who consented, to whom, how old, how many buyers, replacement terms, source).

A 25-lead test with every bad number credited.

Weekly delivery with a contact-rate report on every batch.

Where they are

They compare cost per lead with close rate and commission. The question is no longer which vendor; it is which lead type pays at their own numbers.

"Every once in a while, I'll try a new lead company and sometimes it works out but typically, the leads get worse and worse over time (that's their business model in many cases), so it becomes not worth the time or money."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 3 (hypotheses)

The calculator on this page's Metrics tab with their own rates.

A review of their last 90 days by lead source.

A mixed order sized to a target number of enrollments.

Where they are

They ask who consented and to whom, whether calls from the vendor's dialer put their license at risk, and what the contract says about exclusivity.

"For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 4 (hypotheses)

A sample consent record and a one-page TCPA and CMS checklist.

A walk-through of the consent language for their state and carriers.

Leads delivered into their CRM with the consent certificate attached.

Where they are

They have a budget and a date. They have been promised volume before; what they want now is a test they can measure before they scale.

"Do not leverage yourself past your means for leads as far as I'm concerned that's gambling and not a good idea."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 5 (hypotheses)

A self-serve test order.

An onboarding call, the script and a follow-up schedule.

A managed weekly order through December 7 with a report every Friday.

Silent Searches

What the independent Medicare / ACA / health insurance agent types, watches and is sold, measured side by side (typed = autocomplete that still names the worry; watched = YouTube videos whose title names it; spoke = own-voice documents; sold = ads to this audience).

Worry	Typed	Videos	Views	Spoke	Ads
Not making money, no sales, broke in year one	3	42	2,940,375	23	1
Money burned on leads that never answer	0	6	24,971	43	78
Chargebacks and clawed-back commissions	27	44	154,711	71	0
CMS, carrier and TCPA exposure	0	48	25,434	55	8
ACA marketplace suspensions and enrollment-fraud fallout	0	2	4,539	4	15
FMO / upline lock-in and release fights	0	54	138,446	109	36
Wanting to quit: rejection, hang-ups, burnout	7	41	725,860	21	5

Not making money, no sales, broke in year one

Typed: how to make money as an insurance agent · how to make money from insurance company · how to make money in insurance

Watched: Insurance BROKER vs. AGENT (Know the Difference) #agent #broker #insurance (963,974 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=va0c5svjhEQ> · How Much Money Insurance Agents Make (692,843 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XzL0efcxQs> · How much money do you make? Insurance Broker (313,461 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0Sy_Ce5T1nI · First Year Insurance Agent (217,292 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EO9YVR1v1TQ> · How much do insurance agents ACTUALLY make? (199,602 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Uq25B0E5KHQ>

Money burned on leads that never answer

Watched: The Mistake Insurance Agents Make When Buying Leads ❌ #insurance #insuranceagent #sales #leads (20,057 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3EsCwn_jxPQ · Stop Buying Leads! How to Generate Your OWN Insurance Leads #shorts (4,298 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uKkWMt5O6kE> · Are Insurance Leads

Worth The Money?? (324 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E_DW3J3jXjE · The Truth About Insurance Lead Vendors (Avoid These Mistakes) (118 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J37FU9ZQVb4> · Are Veteran Leads Worth It? (Pros, Cons & What to Expect) (108 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k4rPoAWA5j8>

Chargebacks and clawed-back commissions

Typed: chargeback in insurance · chargeback insurance agent · chargeback insurance australia · chargeback insurance companies · chargeback insurance cost · chargeback insurance for businesses · chargeback insurance for merchants · chargeback insurance providers · chargeback insurance sales · chargeback insurance shopify · chargeback insurance stripe · chargeback meaning in insurance · chargeback on insurance · chargeback protection insurance · health insurance chargeback · how does chargeback insurance work · insurance chargeback commission · insurance chargeback meaning

Watched: What Is A CHARGEBACK? (38,779 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dqAr7wP_JqM · What Is a Chargeback? How to Dispute & Prevent Chargebacks in Your Business (17,010 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5ou8zEcFwRU> · What is the chargeback and chargeback process? #shorts #chargeback #process #guide #ecommerce #yt (15,983 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=51o33S28RtY> · Why Insurance Agents Get Chargebacks.. #insurance #insuranceagent #lifeinsuranceagent #sales (8,924 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UjNL031dguI> · Merchant Explains How To Fight Chargebacks (7,617 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5X5yIX6om24>

CMS, carrier and TPCA exposure

Watched: BREAKING: TPCA Update on New Cold Calling/Text Rules (6,723 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z47wv1_N41g · New CMS Rule Could Kill FMOs SGAs MGAs and GAs in the Medicare Market (2,176 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xzLS3fXxhng> · BREAKING: FCC Delays One to One Rule Change to 2026 ITCPA Update I Marketing Rules #realestate (1,907 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5bD7mgtTOWg> · Telephone Consumer Protection Act (TCPA) - How To Know If Your Rights Have Been Violated (1,382 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3T5-Q_iuBt4 · \$5 Million TCPA Lawsuit - Deryck Richardson Story 📰 🇺🇸 (1,345 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=v7t5mMltOcY>

ACA marketplace suspensions and enrollment-fraud fallout

Watched: How to process Agent of Record (AOR) changes for ACA "Obamacare" policies!! (3,887 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iXCp-KwfMwY> · ACA Fraud, Agent-of-Record Theft & New Compliance Rules (652 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OuzM9NlbhIM>

FMO / upline lock-in and release fights

Watched: Insurance Brokers FMO and MGA (50,251 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HjL0fGqqz08> · Top 4 Lies FMO's Tell (30,117 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ubnh5r3s8Q> · Which IMO / Insurance Company Should You Work For? (6,935 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9ZbNm21WRJs> · Use This TRICK to Get Released From Your Upline - Life Insurance Agent (6,168 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fQdVek4MTT8> · What The Hell Is An FMO? [And do insurance agents need one?] (5,162 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X8HgCWIK03Q>

Wanting to quit: rejection, hang-ups, burnout

Typed: why do insurance agents quit · why do life insurance agents quit · why do most insurance agents quit · why do most life insurance agents quit · why i quit being an insurance agent · why i quit being an insurance agent reddit · why i quit being an insurance agent singapore

Watched: WHY I QUIT BEING A REAL ESTATE AGENT! #realestateagent #realestate #business (528,797 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OnwPaRU5fO8> · Why I quit working for a State Farm Agent 🙄 (101,290 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MOjZYIzb4NU> · Why Do So Many Insurance Agents Quit? (16,821 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3jZki3D4Jok> · 102 Former Insurance Agents Explain Why They Quit [No BS] (15,195 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xv8pQ6cZ7oU> · Why Do New Insurance Agents Quit? [Cody Askins & David Duford] (11,184 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kjplGRoUJH8>

Private Worries

Measured absence: 0 first-person sentences say they keep something from their spouse, upline / FMO or clients.

Not making money, no sales, broke in year one · 23 documents

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"Is selling life insurance what everyone makes it out to be? All over my social media page I am seeing 20 years olds post that they are making 10k or more a month by selling life insurance. I know that there a chargebacks, buying leads, and its commission only, but is it actually worth getting into? I feel like all the companies are MLM's and that they are only posting this content to recruit people to join."

— InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t35kdo/>

Money burned on leads that never answer · 43 documents

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k46vj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm'd" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an *intent to transfer*. After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The *intent to transfer* process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo>) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gy923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

Chargebacks and clawed-back commissions · 71 documents

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"I love my commission. I get 70% advance commission on an annual premium. So if I sign a person up for an \$80 a month policy, I make \$672. The downside is I have to get my own leads. I really don't care lol. I make around 12k a month on a lazy month."

— YouTube · How much an insurance agent makes per policy · 70 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cowanj3iGc&lc=UgwPMB48SnKhhAz7HdF4AaABAq>

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through (carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

CMS, carrier and TCPA exposure · 55 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Be honest, how many of you are too hungry or greedy to actually care about your clients? Too often on this sub, I see posts full of frustration: "I can't close deals because customers are cheap." "The competition is undercutting me." "I need a new company with lower rates." Sound familiar? Complaining doesn't sell policies, and it certainly doesn't build trust with clients. What does work? Taking a step back and focusing on what you can control—helping people understand their risks and providing the guidance they need. Like Zig Ziglar and Jerry Acuff teach: "Help people get what they need, and you'll have all you need." Show, Don't Just Tell: Use Real-World Stories One of the best ways to help people understand the importance of proper coverage is by sharing real-life examples. Here's one: Imagine you're driving and accidentally hit a pedestrian—a 43-year-old father of three making \$90,000 a year. You only have \$100,000 in bodily injury coverage on your auto policy. Do you think \$100,000 goes far in this situation? Absolutely not. This man's medical bills could exceed \$500,000. He may lose his income while recovering, or worse, never return to work. The court won't just hold you responsible for his current medical costs—they'll look at his lifetime earning potential. That's millions of dollars. Now picture yourself on the stand in a courtroom. The plaintiff's attorney asks, "Why did you carry only \$100,000 in bodily injury coverage?" You respond, "Because that's all I could afford." (Which is a total lie) Then the attorney points out you're driving a \$60,000 vehicle with a \$600 monthly payment, yet you chose to skim on your liability coverage. How does that look to a judge? Conversely, you get a \$2000 vehicle with bad breaks or ball joints, hit the same pedestrian and not only will the judge be siding with the widow, if the judge finds out that you knew about the bad parts, you may be in for a manslaughter charge because of willful endangerment. Odds are, the widow will be awarded 40% of your pre-tax income until her children turn 18, then 20% for the rest of her life. I would tell the client that the 57 dollars a month in savings just cost you everything. This is why your job as an agent isn't just to sell policies—it's to help people manage their risks. Clients often don't understand the implications of their choices, and it's our responsibility to make those risks tangible. When we fail to explain the "why" behind higher limits, we're doing them a disservice. Here are other examples: A client with only \$150,000 in dwelling coverage on their home didn't realize rebuilding after a fire would cost \$244,000. They had to pay the difference out of pocket and face years of financial hardship. A business owner declined professional liability insurance, only to be sued for \$1 million after an employee error caused significant losses for a client. That lawsuit forced them into bankruptcy. Conversely, a family that opted for umbrella coverage was protected from losing their home after their teenage son caused a major accident. These stories aren't scare tactics; they're real-life scenarios. And they underscore the importance of listening to your clients, helping them understand their risks, and showing them why the right coverage matters. People don't want to feel "sold." They want someone who cares about their well-being and offers real solutions. Ask thoughtful questions. Share stories that make the risks relatable. Build trust by focusing on their needs—not your commission. When clients understand how proper coverage protects their family, their assets, and their peace of mind, they're more likely to say yes to higher limits. As agents, our job isn't just to provide a quote—it's to protect lives and livelihoods. Stop blaming external factors for lost sales. Instead, focus on what you can do better: Educate, advise, and build trust. Help your clients understand that managing their risks now can save them from life-altering consequences later. Let's stop complaining and start helping. Have any of you used similar real-life stories to educate clients? How did it work? Let's share ideas!"

— InsuranceAgent · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hj1p7v/be_honest_how_many_of_you_are_too_hungry_or/

"Is this against AIL or Globe Life in general because I worked for the Liberty National division and if it's a class action lawsuit against globe, I would love to become a part of it."

— InsuranceAgent · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m75jzrt/

ACA marketplace suspensions and enrollment-fraud fallout · 4 documents

"If I contract, will I get fillable forms the consent forms? What about for recording? would not the CRM automatically record calls? I also need this recordings for Medicare as well I am probably going to buy if its workable depending on few other questions I gave you about leads What is voice consent with that just be the easiest way to do it?"

— YouTube · 🔥 ACA Agents: This Sales Script Closes More Obamacare Clients (Copy & Paste) 🗨️ · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cLRWdaqypkc&lc=UgzFPjoJDBVsQUI7VN54AaABAq>

"ABC said: I called to speak with them and no one was available, I am really suspect since they are an Insurance Agency now. I don't think they are an insurance agency. I did some research and I think its a startup and they are running it out of their house. The owner has 2 jobs, check him out on Linked In. I want to know what happens a week later with the app. And a week after that with the feed to the carriers. I want something in writing that they aren't stealing my clients. (Which probably won't do any good, but it will make me feel better) For this year, I will probably use them on my webpage and also to send to people when I have run out of time. But not for people I am running the clients on via join.me"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Sherpa New Portal For Agents Working On the Exchange · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/health-sherpa-new-portal-for-agents-working-on-the-exchange.66461/#post-874324>

"Yes. I just had the first one terminated by the Marketplace for not sending in income verification documentation. This person is self employed; owns a flooring company. His adjusted gross income for 2014 was \$50,000. His taxes are with the tax accountant now. He is out of the country with no insurance. He does not know his income for 2015 yet. He thinks it may be higher. I called the Marketplace. They insist they have to have a bank statement; something. They said there was a discrepancy in his income. I was wondering how long it would take for this to begin? Now, I know."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Can Marketplace Health Insurance Terminate for Not Sending In Documents? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-marketplace-health-insurance-terminate-for-not-sending-in-documents.73346/#post-971669>

FMO / upline lock-in and release fights · 109 documents

"Why i left the life insurance industry Here is the story as to why I left the life insurance industry as a whole and I'm going to let my license expire on December 31st, 2024. I saw somewhere that you can make 10k a month selling life insurance. I was hooked. I took the pre-licensing course and got my state license. I then got with an agency and the recruiter told me that the leads were exclusive and pre-qualified meaning I didn't have to do any cold calling or door knocking. I was even more hooked. This seemed too good to be true. I start working at the agency and the first alarm bell goes off in my head. I have to pay for leads. I asked my spline about this and he said the reason they cost money is because they are high quality leads. I said hm okay, so I purchased them. Turns out the leads were aged, recycled, and most of them claimed to never have shown an interest in life insurance, including usage of foul language and making threats to get law enforcement involved. I made no money, helped no families and was extremely dissatisfied. And mind you, my upline told me that the leads were exclusive and the best in the industry. What. Lie. I left that agency and got with another one. They also told em the same thing as the previous agency. No cold calling, no door knocking, we provide you with the best high quality leads in the industry with a blah blah closing ratio. Once again, the leads cost money but this time they were 1 month old instead of 3. I said hm okay, what can go wrong? Well, turns out that this agency was worse than the previous one. Once again despite me being told that the leads were high quality, I got ghosted a lot, cancelled appointments, loss of interest due to not being able to afford it, people claiming that they had never shown an interest in life insurance, insulting me and making threats over the phone. The whole thing was even worse than working retail during holiday season. This time, I lost \$1,000 buying E&O coverage, fingerprint background check, and overpriced leads that ended up not even working out. This is when reality hit me that this is not an industry I want to be in. At this point in my career I had felt the dirtiest I had ever felt and I wasn't even making any money to justify it. I was LOSING money while being treated like garbage by angry prospects. I rage quit that job. I ended up going to a THIRD agency because "third time's a charm". This company did not make you pay for leads, however, it had a very similar business structure as Herbalife and amway where you have to recruit. You have to ask your friends, family, neighbors, and social media followers if they are interested in working. Once again, I made no money, people knew it was a pyramid scheme and lost a couple of friends because they didn't want to deal with my sales tactics. This was it. I said I'm done. I'm done with insurance and I'm done with sales. I ended up going back to community college for an associates in I.T (paid for with FAFSA federal pell grants) and I'm also studying for my CompTIA certifications to work in the I.T industry and I could not be happier with my decision. Till this day I still get messages and calls from recruiters trying to hit me with the same "we are seeking licensed agents. No cold calling. We have the most exclusive leads in the industry" & it fills me with so much rage how stupid they think I am to fall for their nonsense again. Insurance sales recruiters are straight up liars and they seem to feel no shame towards it. Finally, a lot of them love to promote the lavish luxury lifestyle to reel people in. I also don't care about that. I am happy with what I have. Family and health is more important to me than some Tesla Model 3."

— LifeInsurance · 83 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/LifeInsurance/comments/1egggok/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

Wanting to quit: rejection, hang-ups, burnout · 21 documents

"Update: Being let go from a toxic agency turned out to be the best thing that could have happened to me As you can see from my original post, I received a lot of negative comments. To be fair, I posted less than an hour after being let go and was extremely emotional. I should have taken some time to calm down before posting. That being said, I still stand by the main point of my post: a toxic workplace is not something anyone should be expected to tolerate simply because an industry can be stressful. The insurance field is not "too hard" for me. I have dealt with difficult customers throughout my entire working career. I have been yelled at, hung up on, spoken down to, and blamed for things outside of my control. That comes with working with the public. However, your boss should not tell you to "shut the hell up before I get nasty with you" in front of your coworkers, especially over a routine replacement or add-on — and especially when you did not make a mistake to begin with. In this situation, it was actually a replacement, and my former boss was the one who had it wrong.(never got that apology from him lol) After I formally addressed the way I was spoken to, the situation became retaliatory. My separation letter included five days as though I had called out repeatedly, when those were days I had asked to delay my original start date so I could handle personal matters and begin the following week with a clear schedule. I even found the email confirming that discussion. I was going to remind him of that by replying to the separation letter with that email, but at this point, I decided to leave it alone and move forward. And that brings me to the real update: To everyone who told me to look into working for an independent agency: **thank you**. I start my new position on Monday. It is much closer to the type of work I was doing before 📍, but with an independent agency. I was told that others in the industry were already familiar with the turnover issues at my former office, which helped remind me that my experience was not simply a reflection of my ability to succeed in insurance. My new position includes: **A \$7,900 salary increase** Benefits beginning after 30 days A one-hour lunch instead of 30 minutes Five eight-hour workdays No weekends Paid nationwide holidays The employer covering 90% of the health insurance premium Looking back, being fired by that office may have been the best thing that could have happened to me. To anyone who said the insurance field was not for me: standing up for yourself does not mean you are incapable of doing your job. Refusing to accept humiliation, harassment, or retaliation does not make you lazy, overly sensitive, or full of excuses. If you wake up every morning wondering what the yelling, condescending remarks, or unnecessary criticism will be about that day, start looking for another job. I am not talking about someone who simply dislikes working or cannot accept constructive feedback. I am talking about people who work hard, are genuinely being treated poorly and starting to question their own abilities because of it. The insurance industry is huge. One toxic workplace does not represent the entire field, and one difficult boss does not determine your future. Sometimes one door shuts so that a much better one can open. **Thank you, independent agencies!"**

— InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ty3ilq/update_being_let_go_from_a_toxic_agency_turned/

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"Depending on what state you're in, we're in the middle of a lot of rate increase. Can't do much about it realistically but I took as much of that off of my CSR's as I could and did it myself (review/explanation/solutions). Do I feel burned out? Yea but my name is on the door and my CSRs haven't left and morale is good. We do what we can and don't get overwhelmed with things we can't control. Better for me to do the "tough" stuff than them IMO because I can't afford for them to get burned out and quit."

— InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gagmgg/23_years_in_this_business_and_ive_never_seen/nz6ed67/

Lead Sources

Source	Documents	Worked	Burned
FMO / IMO lead programs	417	10	6
Referrals and word of mouth	274	18	1
Cold calling, door knocking, dialing	270	13	9
Call centers / captive employers	223	10	4
Seminars, events, workshops	169	5	0
Live transfers and inbound calls (pay per call)	167	15	5
Google ads / search / SEO	134	3	2
Aged leads	123	9	3
T65 lists, direct mail, mailers	120	9	1
Named lead vendors (EverQuote, SmartFinancial, QuoteWizard, NextGen, Aged Lead Store, AllCalls...)	99	9	4
Facebook / Meta ads (self-generated)	87	4	1
Exclusive real-time leads	50	2	3
Booked appointments	44	1	0
Shared real-time leads	26	2	2
HealthSherpa / marketplace tools (ACA)	24	0	0

What agents say they pay, in their own sentences

- "I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/
- "Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/
- "So I'm paying, what, \$14 a lead to race three other brokers to the same shipping company owner who's already annoyed before I even open my mouth?" · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/
- "I'm paid about \$250 per MAPD in my brokerage with no lead expense." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o7cpaf/medicare_agents_please_give_me_advice/njmo2ot/
- "Look a few years down the line if you're producing even low six figures in AP, paying \$50-80 per lead at ~100% commission sounds a lot more fun than 40% with some marginal guarantee and no lead spend." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vz10ku/why_does_captive_get_so_much_hate_verses_brokerage/p61bv2l/
- "The owner has lamented to me that my minimal \$ value of premium is very low (I'm averaging about \$500 per lead) AND he is upset with his input of money to pay for the leads.." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1snoujd/general_question_about_leads/

- "It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/
- "I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/
- "my cult IMO charged \$27 per callback data lead that they made bank on." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/ny9dvtm/
- "Expensive live transfers at \$70 a call." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/myqsmm0/
- "Discounted Facebook leads at \$10-\$15 a call." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/myqsmm0/
- "I hear of agents who spend \$5-\$10k on leads a month and write \$200-\$500k of premium a month, those just feel fake lol." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer7u8e/
- "I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront)." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/
- "Next you will say your cost per acquisition per item is just \$40 which is impossible with any lead gen program!" · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jrwh5/please_stop_taking_sales_roles_that_pay_4/ml64xe/
- "I've been at this for a few years now, and will admit I've been down the path of paying \$30-60+ per lead for "higher intent" leads and the ROI was never there." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/myt04tq/
- "a company is offering me a 1099 position at \$200 per sale flat, selling medicare supplements following a script." · How To Make \$500k A Year As A Medicare Agent In 2023! (Medicare Sales Training) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SmppgLPuqeQ&lc=UgyD78lmlKn0vjUPmUp4AaABAg>
- "The old lead of yesterday getting .8 to 1% will be \$70 a lead soon ." · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/postage-going-up-another-7-4-legitimate-dm-has-a-few-yrs-left.115467/#post-1533168>
- "I pay \$54 weekly for unlimited leads but that comes out of my statement." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ax5nn1/what_is_it_like_being_an_insurance_agent/krmx0a6/
- "The compensation plan for most agents is making ~\$90 per sale." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/kvcsv1e/
- "If you have good retention and QA you can make up to ~\$160 per sale." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/kvcsv1e/
- "Yea it's crazy, I would spend about \$42 on a "fresh" exclusive lead just to finally get a hold of them after 10+ tries for them to tell me they already signed up with another agent a while ago... and of course the lead company doesn't reimburse unless it's a disconnected number, so the agent is forced to eat that cost" · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ourb2oq/
- "Even if they got a killer deal at \$1 per lead that's 700-900 per day." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/nixjsfb/
- "We paid \$21-\$23 an hour and \$50 an app with the chance to earn more through accelerators." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o7cpaf/medicare_agents_please_give_me_advice/njn3u34/
- "\$55 a call is pricey when the calls never actually happened." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u9pr90/ringba_leads_through_integrity_connect_are_a_scam/
- "you must target a small area, even live transfers were only \$45 a lead." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxcl1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/loewzie/
- "You always got to look at your cost for acquisition or CPA when you buy leads and age leads might be really cheap and if they're 50 cents a piece but you have to buy a thousand to get a deal then your cost for acquisition is \$500 alternatively you can buy four or five live transfers and spend \$200 to \$250 or you can bu" · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k24g9p/aged_leads_store/mnt6xv1/
- "If I close 26%+ and have a take rate of 80%+, then I can make a total of \$350 per policy." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sh8g5w/is_this_a_good_job/
- "\$50 a lead." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qtg89e/rages_to_riches/o35st29/
- "I'm paying \$55 per lead, but even with that my CPA is sup \$40 for ACA plans." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/nmfoj8t/
- "I was paying close to \$85 per live transfer a few months ago." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l101rg/internet_lead_company_reviews_my_experience/mvhk241/
- "Spent \$2000 on D-Snp leads & knocked on doors, went into Walmart & had a kiosk." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1h0xws/y/which_insurance_sales_is_known_for_the_best/lzmzcbv/
- "I've heard of agents paying \$75-\$300 for leads, and that's not something that I am trying to do." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gaf2yn/avoid_bankers_life/mjp297q/
- "The last company I worked for (HealthMarkets) did exactly this and charged us \$36 per call we answered, mind you none of those calls turned to sales." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/nps166v/
- "I do this as well, i spend \$1500 a month on paid google leads." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/n4kwspl/
- "Then I read where people say they spend \$1400 a WEEK on leads on forums I visit....what world am I living in?" · r/InsuranceProfessional · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/15ksxo7/medicare/yb73ad/>
- "We opted for the live lead transfer phone calls with the most favorable quote tier (driving history, years insured), for \$40.00 per lead." · r/InsuranceProfessional · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/gwj9d6/how_are_you_doing_with_your_internet_leads/fsvmu1v/
- "In one of your other videos you mentioned how lead costs have increased from around \$5 to now \$15 per lead, and that you close 1/20 of the leads." · How I Wrote 1300+ ACA Applications In One OEP — Strategies Agents Can Use In 2025 · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NHWQRbOpEb0&lc=UgyJDufp-0a9_9ewUTB4AaABAg
- "I rather spend the money to duplicate what you do than pay you \$30 00 a lead." · Quality Leads For Insurance Agents - Secure Agent Mentor  · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kIW50Kfms3c&lc=UgxcY10knMnJaJ_28d4AaABAg
- "I purchased a mix of live and slightly aged leads from a few vendors, paying \$50 per lead, but ended up wasting a lot of money." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lmbcnj/anything_is_possible/n10wio5/
- "I spent \$10 in leads and turned that into \$1000." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtgo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/nlman3/

Threads & Competitors

Group	Name	Documents	Positive	Negative
concepts & products	Referrals	194	23	2
concepts & products	Aged leads	133	2	1
concepts & products	Facebook and Meta leads	92	6	2
concepts & products	Direct mail and T65 mailers	88	4	2
concepts & products	AHIP and carrier certifications	80	2	0
concepts & products	CRMs	73	5	0
concepts & products	Live transfers	71	4	2
concepts & products	Chargebacks	64	4	2
concepts & products	Door knocking	55	3	1
concepts & products	Dialers	49	2	1
carriers	UnitedHealthcare / AARP	46	3	0
carriers	Humana	44	1	0
concepts & products	Appointment setters	44	1	1
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	American Income Life / Globe	39	3	2
concepts & products	Inbound calls and pay-per-call	39	1	0
concepts & products	TCPA and one-to-one consent	36	0	0
carriers	Aetna / CVS	32	3	0
carriers	Blue Cross Blue Shield	32	0	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	Integrity	32	2	2
lead vendors	SmartFinancial	25	1	1
concepts & products	Seminars and events	25	1	0
platforms & tools	HealthSherpa	24	0	0
carriers	Cigna	21	0	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	Family First Life	21	3	2
concepts & products	Scope of Appointment and call recording	21	1	0
lead vendors	QuoteWizard / LendingTree	20	0	2
lead vendors	Caboom / Cody Askins	20	1	0
platforms & tools	HealthCare.gov	20	0	2
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	Symmetry / Quility	18	0	0
carriers	Wellcare / Centene / Ambetter	17	0	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	Ritter	14	4	1
lead vendors	EverQuote	13	0	1
carriers	Molina	12	0	0
platforms & tools	Medicare.gov Plan Finder	11	2	0
brokers & call centers	SelectQuote	9	1	1
lead vendors	NextGen Leads	9	2	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	Senior Market Sales (SMS)	9	1	0
platforms & tools	SHIP counselors	9	1	0
carriers	Mutual of Omaha	8	0	0
carriers	Kaiser	7	0	0
carriers	Anthem / Elevance / Wellpoint	6	0	0
brokers & call centers	Assurance IQ	6	0	0
brokers & call centers	HealthMarkets	5	1	1
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	Senior Life / Senior Choice	5	2	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	AmeriLife	4	0	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	USHealth / USHA	4	0	0
platforms & tools	GoHighLevel	4	1	0
carriers	Devoted	3	0	0
brokers & call centers	GoHealth	3	0	0
lead vendors	Hometown Quotes	3	0	0

Competitor Ads

Selling leads, live transfers, inbound calls and appointments to agents · 298 ads · 67 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Exclusive T65 Medicare Opportunities	3	699	none captured	Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers! ❌ STOP Buying bad leads, direct mailing, & cold calling! ❌ STOP overpaying for leads and wasting money
Medicare Agents Hub	2	643	https://medicareagentshub.com/sign-up	Want More Medicare Clients? We've Got Them! - Appear in top search engine results . - Connect with seniors looking for Medicare help today . -
Cody E. Askins	17	373	https://info.caboomleads.com/	📞 We help agents scale with PHONE-VERIFIED, qualified, compliant leads that convert. Every lead is CELL PHONE VERIFIED (via 6-digit security)

Seven Figure	3	262	http://sevenfigure.com/	 Building a stable Medicare book starts with the right prospects. Relying on recycled or unverified leads can lead to wasted time, lower ret
The Mason VanMeter	2	181	https://go.masonvanmeter.com/freereport	If you're buying insurance leads, you've already chosen the losing path — you just don't realize it yet. And once I explain this, you won't
GWC Marketing	1	161	gwcmarketingagency.com	Another insurance client crushing open enrollment. Our lead gen system dropped their CPL from \$63 to \$16 — without sacrificing quality. If y
profitprintercalls	2	161	instagram.com	Real talk for insurance agents 🙌 92% of agents quit in year one. Not because they're bad at sales — because they're burning out chasing tras
FluxProtocol	5	158	https://fluxprotocol.ai/	If your ACA team is buried in follow-up, admin work, and recycled data, more lead volume will not fix it. FluxProtocol is built to reduce dr
Lindsay Smith The Agent	2	147	none captured	→ From A Struggling Life Insurance Agent To Generating Over \$750k+ In A Single Year 📈🌟 When I first started as a life insurance agent, I th
Blackrock Insurance Group	2	143	http://blackrockins.com/contact-us1	Insurance Agents What would your production look like if you had 10 to 30 inbound appointments every day? That is exactly what our system wa
Insurance by Stacy	3	133	https://stacygregoryinsurance.com/medicare-lead-system-for-agents	Medicare agents — tired of cold calling? You don't have a lead problem. You have a systems problem. I built a done-for-you Medicare lead sys
Select Senior Advisors	1	133	none captured	Scale Your Business with a Proven Partner! Select Senior Advisors seeks experienced independent agents to join our thriving community. Lever
Break Free Agent	12	119	none captured	👉👉 INSURANCE AGENTS ONLY STOP relying on referrals. And please, stop wasting your money on aged and shared leads. Instead, start producing
Rick Love	1	106	https://texkingdom.com/agentmastery	I have been writing 300+ life insurance policies per year using an inbound lead system for more than 7 years now. (I still write this amount
Nonstop Agencies	1	94	apply.nonstopfinancialteam.com	Licensed life insurance agents are hitting \$20K, \$50K, even \$200K months inside Nonstop Financial. Here's what makes us different. \$11M+/Mon
Penguin Leads	11	92	https://penguinlead.com/	🔴 Stop Fighting Over The Same Leads. While every agent in America hammers the same Florida and California lists, smart agents are quietly clo
AllCalls.io	11	89	https://allinbounds.com/agentsV1/	Some Final Expense buyers see a commercial and call immediately. AllCalls.io routes those callers directly to your agents in real time. The
The Aegis Marketing	3	82	none captured	Final Expense agents — I'll send you seniors who are READY TO BUY. Pre-qualified live transfers, straight from my ads. No dialing. Talk to I
Onyx CRM	1	82	none captured	Kelly's book of business used to live on his Google Calendar. "I'm going through old lead sheets, hitting Command F on my MacBook, trying to
Hammad Khan	1	77	instagram.com	You don't have a closing problem. You have a lead problem nobody told you to question. Follow me, I show life insurance agents how to own th
Polycymatcher	6	77	app.polycymatcher.com	Agents: when's the last time a lead actually called YOU first? Not a recycled list. Not a cold dial. Not some shared lead 6 other agents alr
WeGenerate	12	64	https://www.wegeneratecalls.com/	Tired of bad Final Expense leads? We were too. That's why we mastered consumer initiated inbound calls. Aka... when interested customers cal
Advanced Agent Marketing	5	62	advancedagentmarketing.com	Annuity Producers — Start Paying for Appointments That SHOW (With \$250K-\$1M+ Ready to Move) That's exactly what annuity producers are gettin
Senior Sphere Marketing	5	58	https://seniorsphereleads.com/	Want to write 15+ T65 apps per month — without chasing leads? We built a system that runs automated Medicare workshops for you... And turns th
Nato Guajardo	2	56	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-b-erangsir-angsur/	If you're an insurance agent buying leads right now, you're probably paying \$25–\$50 for a lead that's being shared with 3 to 5 other agents.
Calls Flow	12	55	https://www.callsflow.io/	Medicare agents & agencies—AEP is coming. Get real-time inbound Medicare calls through CallsFlow. Sign up, top up, take calls, and close—no
Policylio	1	54	https://policylio.com/final-expense-calls	Stop chasing aged leads. Get exclusive Final Expense inbound calls from consumers actively looking for coverage. Our calls are delivered in
Medicare Client Flow	7	51	https://medicareclientflow.com/leadgen	If your agents are spending hours cold calling, buying outdated lead lists, or relying on inconsistent referrals... You're limiting your age
Elijah Kanoho	1	51	atlaslifeagency.com	I personally issued paid \$58,406.54 in annual life premium in a single month—without making a single dial or dealing with uninterested, low-
Fidato Leads	1	48	https://www.fidatoleads.com/	Insurance Agents Stop paying for black box Insurance leads that eat your budget with zero accountability. At Fidato, we tag every single lea
Final Expense Leads Specialist	1	43	none captured	Final Expense Live Transfers — Save 10% Today! FB.ME Final Expense Live Transfers — Save 10% Today! Connect with high-intent Final Expense p
Advisors Excel	1	41	none captured	You're doing \$5M+ but still feel like your financial practice is capped. More leads, more hours, and more grinding won't work. Discover your
zachbrsells with Penguin Leads	2	41	https://penguinlead.com/	You'll Think Of Every Excuse In The Book Until You Experience It Yourself And Put In The Work. You're Just A Lead List Away From The Life Yo
LeadStore	3	40	http://myleadstore.com/aep	Medicare agents and agencies — are you ready for AEP? Do you have people lined up to talk to, or are you walking into your busiest window ho
Policy Printer	4	37	www.startpolicyprinter.com	We will send warm, inbound Final Expense calls straight to your agents' phones - and you only pay when someone actually calls. Right now you
Agent Lead Lab	3	34	https://lp.leadlabcrm.com/30k-optin-3x	If your lead source cannot confidently stand behind its product, why are you giving it more money? For qualified FFL agents doing \$30K+ per
Live Calls	1	29	none captured	Your agents shouldn't have to chase cold leads. Start receiving high-intent Medicare inbound calls from \$15.99. We run nationwide Me
SWIFT AI Group	1	27	swiftretirementleads.com	Annuity agents and retirement advisors: if you want fresh exclusive 55 plus retirement leads without paying setup fees or getting locked int
Keepsake Leads	4	25	https://www.keepsake-leads.com/	Fill your agents' day with pre-qualified inbound calls instead of a dialer. We send 20+ live inbound final expense calls a day, routed strai
Skool	2	25	skool.com	For insurance agents and agencies relying on outside lead vendors, Insurance Ads Lab teaches Facebook and Instagram advertising. Relying on

FMO / IMO recruiting: contracts, 'free leads', ownership of your book · 127 ads · 42 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
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Preferred Senior Advisors	1	546	none captured	Are you stuck at a job you dislike? 🤔 Do you wish you had more schedule flexibility and higher compensation? Is there a lack of support at
Lifeline Family Benefits	1	303	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-berangsur-angsur/	👉 ATTENTION LIFE INSURANCE AGENTS 👉 🏠 Looking for the ability to work fully-remote control your schedule? 🏠 Work from your own home and take ad
Scaleyourlead	4	278	none captured	Insurance agents and agency owners: Running ads, managing leads, and following up shouldn't feel like a full-time job on top of selling. Som
SLD Solutions	1	275	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-berangsur-angsur/	You're licensed. Now your platform should match your level. What most licensed agents need isn't motivation — it's structure, consistent app
Equity Insurance Partners	2	254	www.instagram.com	Hard truth: captive agents don't build careers. They build someone else's company. It doesn't matter how good you are at selling. If your bo
USA Benefits Group	15	183	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-berangsur-angsur/	🏠 Ready to Earn More and Love What You Do? Join USA Benefits Group (USABG), an A+ rated national brokerage where licensed Health and Life In
Eterna Insurance Solutions	10	180	https://joineterna.com/	FINALLY a \$0 Program for Insurance Agents ⚡ Eterna Spark ⚡ - 70 Starting Comp Tier - \$0 Investment - Lead Flow Covered (inbound calls & re
InVida Elite	1	174	https://calendly.com/philip-hudgins/30min-1	🚀 Join InVida Elite: Independent Insurance Agents Wanted! 🏠 Are you ready to elevate your career with a company that values your independence
Nick FitzGerald	2	171	none captured	📌 Texas Licensed Life Insurance Agents Let's be honest... If you're struggling right now, it's usually because of: ❌ weak training ❌ low contr
Monteith Group Financial & Insurance Services	3	153	https://go.themonteithgroup.com/rl	Every client is different. That's exactly why what we do works 💙 0:00 / 0:53
Selfless Financial	6	153	https://tierrebrowne.com/	Licensed insurance agents — watch how Tierre Browne's agents are building their pipelines. You'll see his mentorship process plus the Google
Evan Schlang	2	140	https://evanschlang.com/annuity	If you're a licensed insurance agent and you're already producing, but you feel like you've hit a ceiling, this is for you. My name is Evan
Everything Senior Insurance	2	138	https://contracting.sevenfigure.com/	Medicare Agents 📌 Are you tired of the same old lackluster & underwhelming experience you have with your FMO? It has almost become customary
Lasting Mark Agents	1	110	none captured	Are you tired of feeling like just another number in the insurance business? Even with years of experience, finding the right support can be
Retirement Realized Financial	5	110	https://retirementrealizedfinancial.com/	Annuity Agents: If you're happy making the same income year after year, if you don't want to learn new skills, or if you think your current
Redbird Marketing	4	110	none captured	Now Onboarding Final-Expense Independent Insurance Agents. Contract directly with leading carriers. Top Commissions - Up to 125% first-year
National Contracting Center	1	105	https://nccagent.com/contracting/	Your FMO should be giving you more than a contract. At NCC, we arm our agents with the tools, training, and resources to build a real busine
Family Protected	1	72	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-berangsur-angsur/	👉 ATTENTION LIFE INSURANCE AGENTS 👉 🏠 Looking for the ability to work fully-remote control your schedule? 🏠 Work from your own home and take ad
Family Life Insurance Group	1	65	none captured	Licensed life insurance agents: Stop spending your time chasing leads and start selling. FLIG provides the leads, multi-line dialing technol
North Star Insurance Advisors, LLC	4	64	https://northstaria.com/remote-sales-agent/	You didn't get licensed to fund lead lists. North Star hands you inbound final expense leads all day. Bring the license — we bring the pipel
United Final Expense Services	1	64	unitedfinalexpenseservices.org	Final expense agents — find out why so many are making the switch. 🇺🇸 United Final Expense Services offers inbound leads, daily training, and
Gold Standard Coverage	14	63	none captured	Unlimited Final Expense Leads. Join our free agency webinar to see how our system works. Live Tuesday & Thursday at 7 PM ET. FB.ME Free Agen
P. F. Solutions	1	62	none captured	📌 Licensed Life Insurance Agents Wanted 📌 We're expanding our Final Expense division. When you contract with P. F. Solutions, you'll unlock
Advanced Agent Marketing	4	62	https://advancedagentmarketing.com/lp/application-ftb	Annuity Producers — Start Paying for Appointments That SHOW (With \$250K-\$1M+ Ready to Move) That's exactly what annuity producers are gettin
Carlos Roman	2	59	https://join.carlosromanofficial.com/roman-wealth-academy-en-	Licensed insurance agents are making \$10,000, \$15,000, even \$20,000 a month in this industry. So why aren't you? It's probably not your work
Illuminate Virtual Team	1	57	none captured	🏠 Life Insurance Agents: Work Smarter, Earn Faster, & Grow with a Winning Team 🌟 Tired of doing everything yourself and still falling short?
Insurance Advisors Direct	2	55	https://iadbrokerage.com/fmo-comparison/	Is your FMO helping you grow — or slowing you down? Download the free FMO Comparison Guide and see how IAD compares on carrier access, tools
Bankers Life - Brea CA	1	52	none captured	Licensed Life & Health Agents — Read This If you're tired of: • Chasing friends and family for sales • Paying thousands for "exclusive" lead
Empower Brokerage Clients	1	50	https://www.empowerbrokerage.com/new-agent-licensing-spanish/	Are you stuck at a job you dislike? 🤔 Do you wish you had more schedule flexibility and higher compensation? Is there a lack of support at
Carepoint	4	48	carepointinsurance.com	AEP is closer than it looks. If your agency is considering switching FMOs, the time to explore your options is before the AEP rush — not durin
US Health Advisors- Charleston with v.spee	1	36	www.crueculuture.com	In sales, you hear about commission all the time - but is that the only way to make money? Here are five different ways our advisors earn in
Club Capital	1	28	none captured	Last year we found \$20,000+ in missed deductions on one insurance agency owner's tax return. Health insurance premiums running outside S-cor
Joshua Youngs - Medicare Machine Factory	1	28	https://medicarementors.com/career	🚀 Calling all Life and Health Agents! 📌 Supercharge Your Success: Apply with Us TODAY 🇺🇸 Quality Insurance Appointments 📌 Pre-Booked & Pre-Se
LeadStore	1	28	http://myleadstore.com/aep	Medicare agency owners — do you have a system built to scale? Do you own your advertising? Do you own your book of business? Do you have som
AGA	1	28	https://appliedga.com/resource-aep-prep-success-kit/	Most licensed insurance agents go into AEP still fixing last year's problems. Accelerate 2026 is Applied General Agency's AEP kickoff event
Catch Coverage	9	22	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-berangsur-angsur/	Catch Coverage is hiring licensed ACA agents. We hand you the inbound leads, training, and support. You bring your license and your talent.
Senior Life Insurance Company	2	16	none captured	Want to build a real income helping real families? We provide leads, daily pay, full training, and a system that actually works. No guesswor

Agency Aid	1	13	none captured	Insurance agency owners: your next client is asking ChatGPT for an agent. "Who's the best home insurance agent in Anderson?" "Cheapest auto
Advocate Health Advisors	1	9	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-berangsur-angsur/	🌟 You're Invited: Medicare Business Growth Event. Join Advocate Health Advisors and EmblemHealth for an exclusive networking event created f
Trainwell	8	7	none captured	Insurance Agency Owners, we'll place a licensed sales agent inside your agency, help ramp them to KPI, and if they don't perform within thei

Software, AI, training and coaching sold to agents · 79 ads · 26 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
XCEL Solutions	4	342	xcelsolutions.com	XCEL makes it easy to get your P&C license with online and on-demand courses designed for busy learners. XCELSOLUTIONS.COM Study Your Way FI
Client Machines	2	217	none captured	Calling all Medicare agents! 📞 Looking for some marketing tools that keep things simple for your prospects? How about whiteboard videos like
FluxProtocol	4	158	https://fluxprotocol.ai/	📌 The ACA market is shifting. The old model of recycled contacts, spreadsheets, and phone-heavy follow-up is getting weaker. FluxProtocol is
PropHog	4	141	https://prophog.com/	WORK WITH LICENSED AGENTS ONLY! - Access NEW licensed insurance agents in any area of the country to expand your downline. Our mobile soluti
InsuranceSplash	6	128	https://websites.insurancesplash.com/v3	ATTENTION INSURANCE AGENTS Still stuck with an outdated website that makes your agency look small — or worse, no website at all? You're losi
Roomvu	1	95	https://www.roomvu.com/try-roomvu-mortgage	🔥 Attention Insurance Agents! 🌱 Grow your online presence, effortlessly! ✅ Get done-for-you social media content ✅ Attract clients with ease
Next Call Club	3	83	https://nextcallclub.com/insurance-lead-program-for-state-farm-agents	Insurance agents lose dozens of qualified leads every month because their number is flagged as spam before they even say hello. Book a free
Insurvoice.ai	2	78	https://us.insurvoice.ai/	Hiring and training insurance assistants is expensive and time-consuming. What if you could have a fully trained, compliance-ready AI assist
VIVA Virtual Solutions	1	65	none captured	You got into insurance to help people, not to spend your afternoons buried in quote requests that go nowhere. But here you are. Jumping betw
COACHG	2	64	https://coachgtraining.com/	The biggest misconception in Medicare is that top producers are simply more talented. They're not. They're operating inside better systems.
LifeButton AI	5	63	https://get.lifebutton.ai/webinar	👋 Bye-bye paying for marked-up leads. Bye-bye paying retainers. 🌟 The truth? You don't need a marketing agency anymore. It's 2026. AI is tak
Dylan Saldivar	13	58	https://www.divinereach.pro/growyouragency	Insurance Agent Producers – This Little Known Recruiting System is the BEST Way to get committed agents to your downline in 2025.... [HERE'S
Canopy Connect	3	49	https://www.usecanopy.com/blog/top-challenges-of-insurance-data-intake	Insurance agency owners and producers, pull up your sent folder and search for the words "just following up." There's a decent chance you'll
Advisor Learn	1	45	https://www.advisorlearn.io/strategysession	Hey, this is Deepak here. I see that you've already taken a look at some of my training. So if you're still thinking about how to grow your
Agent CRM: AI-Powered Sales+Marketing Software	8	26	http://medicare.agent-crm.com/	Most Medicare agents don't realize their CRM isn't HIPAA compliant — until it's a problem. Agent CRM was built specifically for Medicare age
My Bundle Pro	1	24	https://www.mybundlepro.com/	ATTENTION MEDICARE AGENTS You already sell the plan. Here's how to stop leaving the dental, the hospital indemnity, and the cancer plan on t
Axion AI	5	22	https://axion.ai/v2	Health Insurance Agents: Are the carriers throttling your business during peak OEP, or is your SMS provider secretly holding back your succe
SalesDraft	1	22	salesdraft.io	Premium compounds. Every policy a producer writes this year doesn't just pay you once. It pays you in renewals next year, and the year after
InsuraCloud	2	16	instagram.com	Running an agency takes a dozen tools. It should take one. Recruit with a single link. Send contract requests to every carrier at once. See
Convoso	1	15	https://www.convoso.com/landing/voicemail/	Your calls are being blocked. That's why agents can't reach leads. Convoso helps you get calls answered—so more quotes turn into policies. S
Spark Advisors	1	12	sparkadvisors.registration.goldcast.io	Walk into AEP 2027 fully ready. Free training for Medicare agents, covering carrier intel and fresh strategies to grow your income. SPARKADV
Truly Insure	5	8	https://trulyinsure.com/start	Quick question for the insurance agency Owners It costs roughly \$3,000–\$5,500 to recruit one Final Expense agent once you factor in how many
Casava Webservices	1	4	https://casava.app/insurance-agents	Insurance agency owners: every after-hours call you miss is a policy walking to a competitor. Casava builds you a website with an AI chatbot
MedaHealth Associates	1	2	instagram.com	New health insurance agents can spend way too much time trying to get everything perfect. They overthink what to text, how to approach the c
Abraham Kevin Spann: Allstate Insurance	1	2	https://scalewithailive.com/scalewithai-theagentsstack-2026	Great producers. Strong pipeline. And still no clear view of what's actually happening inside the agency. That's not a sales problem. It's a
Abraham Kevin Spann - Certified AI Consultant	1	2	https://scalewithailive.com/scalewithai-theagentsstack-2026	Great producers. Strong pipeline. And still no clear view of what's actually happening inside the agency. That's not a sales problem. It's a

Captive and call-center jobs for licensed agents · 6 ads · 5 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
A&B Insurance, Inc.	1	133	https://aleragroup.zoom.us/webinar/register/5717174449382/WN_Mlj7a8S-T6Cr_aUIRNG05g#/registration	ATTENTION: Florida Health Insurance Agents! A&B Offering Sign on bonus for new agents joining the team. Both Inside sales and outside sales!
Modern Senior Health	1	58	none captured	🌟 Join Our Team as a Medicare Insurance Agent! 🌟 Are you a licensed and motivated insurance agent passionate about helping seniors navigate
Your Advantage Group	1	47	none captured	We are hiring Independent 1099 Medicare Agents Your Advantage Group Must have an active Health Insurance License 2026 AHIP Certification pre
65 Pilot	1	41	https://65pilot.com/webinarregistration	JOB POSTING!! We're looking for someone who is dependable, coachable, organized, and genuinely enjoys helping people to join our growing Med
Indeed	2	1	www.indeed.com	Learn more about BroadPath. Now hiring Licensed Health Insurance Agents - Help. Explain. Enroll. WWW.INDEED.COM Apply Today Learn More

Other agent-facing ads · 40 ads · 18 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Insuremementdirect	4	519	none captured	Are you an insurance agent? Join the world's first multicarrier, direct to consumer insurance marketplace and start selling insurance online
Christian Brindle	1	441	facebook.com	Rules are simple: 1.) No spammingx 2.) No recruiting(keep it out of here) 3.) Be respectful to everyone in the group. Violate any of these
Seven Figure	4	278	sevenfigure.com	🌱 Growth doesn't happen in isolation. 🍷 The Seven Figure Medicare Agent Community is a place where agents come together to learn, share, and
Senplicity	3	194	https://www.senplicityadvisors.com/ad-home	💎 FOR LICENSED AGENTS & AGENCIES ONLY 💎 Southern California Medicare agents - tired of paying for E&O and AHIP out of pocket? Most FMOs make
Insurance Agents & Brokers	6	139	https://www.iabforme.com/membership-application/	Join the premier network for independent insurance agencies across Pennsylvania, Maryland, and Delaware. Insurance Agents & Brokers (IA&B) c
Heartland National Life Insurance Company	1	133	none captured	Attention Annuity Producers! Discover Heartland National Life's new Fixed Indexed Annuity 🌐 Get the product details so you can confidently e
Health Insurance Store	1	131	none captured	🚀 Maximize Your Potential with Health Insurance Store's Bundled Bonus Program! 🚀 Looking to grow your income? Health Insurance Store support
StreetSmart Insurance	1	84	none captured	One claim could be the difference between a rough week and losing the business you built. Here is what happens to a lot of NJ business owner
Ryan Egan	2	65	https://www.giveawaypad.com/100-quotes-per-month	100 P&C QUOTES – GUARANTEED OR YOUR MONEY BACK. Keep reading and I'll tell you: #1 How this works #2 Prove it works * How this works * A
L.A. Insurance	1	54	lainsurance.com	Stop overpaying for car insurance! 🚗🔗 Finding affordable coverage shouldn't drain your bank account. At L.A. Insurance, we connect Arizona d
MESSER Financial Group	1	47	https://info.messerfinancial.com/get-info-2026-aep-prep-ads	The Medicare landscape has changed...do you have all the information you need? Messer is here to support our agents for AEP prep and beyond.
Aegis Agency Solutions	2	44	none captured	For insurance agency owners doing \$500k+ a year in revenue. If you are relying on shared internet leads, exhausted call lists, or hiring mor
Deal Prediction	6	29	https://dealprediction.com/	Insurance Agency Owners — We will install a complete commercial appointment system inside your agency, and if your producers aren't sitting
Quotely	1	15	none captured	For P&C Insurance agents investing in live transfers, internet leads and telemarketing Most agencies are paying an aggregator markup for cal
ReminderMedia	1	15	none captured	INSURANCE AGENTS: Your clients trust you to help protect the people and things that matter most to them. This Christmas, send something more
Nick Berry	1	9	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-se-cara-berangsur-angsur/	Independent insurance agency owners: if you've spent money on Facebook ads that produced a few questionable leads and no clear idea what to
Modern Health Solutions	1	7	none captured	Don't Forget to Check Your Drugs and Doctors When shopping for a Medicare plan, or any health insurance plan, be sure to check the plan's dr
O'Reilly & Partners	3	6	https://oreillypartners.com/	Insurance Agency Owners — We will install a complete commercial client acquisition system inside your business, and if your team isn't booki

Dislikes

Complaint	Documents	1–2★ reviews
Compliance and carrier rules	63	2
Chargebacks and clawbacks	64	0
Leads that never answer or are fake	38	10
Commission cuts and carriers pulling commissions	31	0
Shared leads sold to many agents	11	5
FMOs and uplines that don't deliver or won't release	12	0
Lead debt and money burned	9	0
Captive and call-center jobs: quotas, pay, pressure	5	2

Compliance and carrier rules

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Let go at 6 months pregnant This happened yesterday. I'm still processing. Couldn't sleep all night. And this is long. I apologize in advance. Been an AE at this small private tech company for almost 2 years. They recently went through a rebrand and wanted us targeting completely new verticals. Leadership and overall processes were a complete mess, and it was honestly a shit show. I wanted to leave, but was holding out until after baby arrived this summer. Q4 was rough. Partly because we have zero good inbound leads and are 100% reliant on outbounds, and we have a 6 month sales cycle on average. Except our CEO acts like it should be a 2-meeting close. My old boss was fired and I got a new boss in January. In February, I was told I needed to hit my revenue numbers by end of March, along with all these KPIs metrics, and training a new guy he hired. I've never been on a PIP in my life (been an AE for 7 years), but it didn't feel formal in that there was no document and I never signed anything. Just told I need to do this and this. Now, normally the advice is to start applying immediately. And I did. However my situation is a bit different as I'm pregnant and due this summer. Made it to the offer stage at another company and then informed them I was pregnant, hoping to negotiate some sort of leave. Unfortunately they couldn't offer me any paid leave and my job also wouldn't be protected since I wouldn't qualify for FMLA. At my current company, I would. So it felt safer in the moment to stay. I worked my ass off. Consistently delivered on outreach KPIs, spent hours training the new hire, helped with new marketing initiatives developing new 1-pagers and helping with new outreach playbook development. Really trying to show I'm an asset and praying I could stay on through the summer. After that, I wouldn't care. Still, my revenue was down and my other deals were tied up in legal and I was starting to worry. But out of nowhere one of my old deals I closed last summer was acquired and the new company reached out per their recommendation, and wanted to move forward. This new deal would single handedly hit my revenue numbers. However the compliance aspect took forever. Our team is so disorganized and makes it so hard to buy. Then onboarding. Unfortunately I also sell a consumption based product. So even though they sign the contract and commit to X volume, the revenue generated is dependent on their ramp...which is in the hands of the client success team. And then wouldn't you have it, this CSM did the bare minimum to help them ramp. I felt like I was being sabotaged. Even my boss agreed that they were not doing their job. I stepped up and held meetings to help the client onboard, go through the set up and integration. The CSM completely dropped the ball. No reoccurring meetings in place until they fully ramped, nothing. Basically told them "if you need help lmk". Insane. So, yesterday arrived and I was below my revenue number. But I SHOULD have hit it. And I've been doing so much I really didn't feel worried. Mind you, my entire team was below as well. Revenue was stagnant across the company. But my boss called me out of the blue and I was terminated on the spot. No emotion. No severance. No paid out PTO. No extended insurance. Nothing. My income makes up 60% of our household income. And I use their insurance. Which I have doctors appointments set up every 2 weeks. They've completely fucked me as no company is going to hire me when I give birth in 3 months and also pay me for leave. I don't know what the fuck to do. We genuinely cannot afford to not have my income until Fall. Do I have any legal leg to stand on, or can they just say I fell short of performance, even if I'm dependent on others to do their job AND the entire company was stagnant on revenue? (For reference, I was the only one with a contract signed in Q1 and I had 2 others under review)."

— r/sales · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1jp0avi/let_go_at_6_months_pregnant/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability and refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

Chargebacks and clawbacks

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"Starting to think the money and lifestyle is a pipe dream from the depths of my soul I really need to know the truth of this I have a family to support. i've been selling life insurance for about two years now. I was attracted to all these big checks and the lifestyle that you can control your money and just buy leads and set appointments and do one call closes over the phone and you could make 200k, 300k 500 K a year. and there are tons of people showcase that are doing it. Even twenty something yr olds. So I got in and I bought the leads and I grinded my face off. I managed to make over 100 K within a handful of months. I thought I had it made and I cracked the code. And then I realized I still felt broke. all these crappy lead companies. these leads were supposed to be exclusive and I know they sold them to 10 other agents. I would sometimes dial eight hours a day and only have 1 to 3 genuine conversations. that's crap. I was on the phone all day long I was buying thousands of dollars a month in Leads. Then the chargebacks started hitting me. And now I have to work for free for the rest of the month. But you Gotta keep buying more leads And then customers would call in and need things. I needed to call the carriers. but I didn't really have time to talk to them because I need to buy more leads and call more people and make more sales. eventually I realized how unhappy I was I was working a lot and yet I still felt paycheck to paycheck despite writing 20-30k a month. and I feel like I could not get ahead. What the heck? Then I looked at some of my leaders I was following and they were making 400 K plus a year. and I thought if I ever get to their level then I will be an easy Street then I could take my foot off the gas and I could have a great lifestyle. Wrong. All of them are working their faces off. they couldn't take time off. they weren't spending time with her kids. they didn't have time to answer my calls. Or to train me really. And what's more they didn't even seem happy. they had this stressed out look in their face all the time. I thought how could that be? was this all a lie? is the money and lifestyle even real? I saw this guy who wrote \$1 million on stage. Come to find out he spent 250 K on Leads 30 to 40% fall off. and then minus the guaranteed issue and administrative costs like his dialer or admin... really he was making like 150-200k. That ain't a million. And. He was working 7 days a week. And stressed out couldn't take his foot off the gas. Not worth it. I don't want that lifestyle. If I'm making 400 K a year I better be able to enjoy time with my family and come home for dinner and take nice vacations and make money moves and investments. My goal is to have the lifestyle not to be a slave on the phone seven days a week 10 hours a day. I'm assuming it's just unsustainable biz model. and you're always fighting off chargebacks . And the lead cost will eat up all your profits and that's why most agents won't stick around. Is that the cold truth? am I chasing a pipe dream ? is there ever a way off the escalator if you are selling by yourself without a team? I was mainly doing final expense and mortgage protection.."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 59 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbbqg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/

Leads that never answer or are fake

"Sick of lead companies It's amazing.... agency owners buy "premium" leads and no matter where you go theres trash mixed in. The excuses are incredible like " you aren't dialing them enough" "the prospect keyed in that fake address and number" ect. ect. The agency I work for literally has people dialing alllllll day constantly (over 1000 dials). The sales agents are also calling, emailing, and texting. None of that matters when I get someone on the phone that's already been called 15 times. How the hell do these leads get sold to 20+ agents? I even had a lead in which the guy was DEAD for two years. Where are they even getting this crap from? Any industry insiders that want to give me the 411?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"I need leads for contact rate. My sales skills are there I think because I have talked with people then sold policies but it seems like I am calling such bad leads that don't answer or hang up in my face in the first second of the call"

— YouTube · Insurance Agents: Should you buy leads or generate leads ? · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aGrUeGEYEpl&lc=UgxNQe5hKU22ZfoKKJ4AaABAg>

Commission cuts and carriers pulling commissions

"Why aren't we talking about commission cuts? I've been lurking here for a while, and like many others, I've been considering getting licensed to sell health insurance. I've noticed there are *a ton* of weekly posts asking "Should I get into insurance?" and most of the responses are really positive and encouraging. But what surprises me is what's **NOT** being discussed much: **#1 Major carriers are cutting commissions or removing them entirely.** Here are some examples: * **United Health Care** will stop paying commissions on 100+ Medicare Advantage plans and all PDPs in over 20 states starting July 1, 2025. The NAIFA denounced UHC's decision to cut agent commissions. * **Aetna** is withdrawing from the ACA marketplace and slashing commissions after 2025. * **Cigna, Centene, Elevance (Anthem)** are all making similar moves. **#2 The recent passing of the new "Big Beautiful Bill".** From what I can tell, these are pretty major shifts and could seriously impact how agents make a living going forward. Yet almost none of this shows up in the "how do I start" threads. Why? So, I wanted to ask more directly: * Why isn't there more discussion about these changes here? Is the impact overstated, or are we just not seeing the effects *yet*? * Do veteran agents think ACA/Medicare will still be viable long-term? * Should newcomers treat this as a full-time career or more of a side hustle moving forward? * How are current agents planning to adapt in the next 5-10 years? Genuinely curious. I'm not trying to be negative. I'm just surprised there isn't more open talk about what seems like some pretty big red flags for the industry. Would love to hear what those of you already in the trenches think. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/

"United is simply restructuring and will release new plans for AEP. Obviously they were hit hard, notice they only decommissioned the extremely affordable PPOs going forward... that's because they don't want you to sell any more of them and they can't just release plan changes mid year. And you are talking about commission cuts when we were just announced a 10% increase in MAPD renewals and Initials for 2026. There are lots of carriers dying to throw agents money.... And new carriers are still getting in the game and expanding every year, which is a good sign. I agree it is a little unstable right now, but for agents that is a good thing. Medicare and ACA aren't going anywhere. And if they do, you have an entire book to convert to the new thing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n56ide4/

"For MAPD brokers, who is still writing UHC and Humana non-commissionable plans? Across most of the country over the past few years, UnitedHealthcare and Humana have made many of their MAPD plans non-commissionable. I refuse to work for free and represent these plans going forward. Are there any MAPD-certified brokers who are still willingly selling these plans? Just curious as to why you would put a client on a plan you receive no commissions on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1woc7yr/for_mapd_brokers_who_is_still_writing_uhc_and/

Shared leads sold to many agents

"Hahaha. Looks like a lead that has been tormented by countless calls from agents. I blame the lead vendors that resell the same leads to 5 different offices"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnc/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to_oaaq95t/

"Former MGA here. I worked the TMK system (AIL Globe NILICO) for about 5 years and was VERY successful. So it is possible however I left and went independent for several reasons. 1. Everyone and anyone at AIL that talks about free leads vs paying for leads doesn't quite understand that they aren't comparing apples to apples here. Most leads at AIL aren't people who are looking FOR or interested in life insurance, the union leads are sort of close but they all think you're just coming to endorse the free AD&D. Most agencies these days aren't even running union leads anymore but running Will Kits Child Safe/mcgruff veterans etc. (my agency tested several other "kits" too like Cancer kits) Another thing is they recycle leads just as much as everyone else but they limit the amount you get and control when you get them. So yes they are free but imagine getting 60-100 leads and being told that's all you get for 60-90 days so you better collect referrals. (Heck you're trained NOT to say "insurance" on the phones 😂) 2. Starting at 50% comp these days is just silly when everyone else except WFG Primerica and PHP are starting new agents between 75-110% 3. The leaderboard is a liar, most (not all) of the people in the spotlight or whatever that magazine was called are not running the same leads that regular new agents are, they're running POS aka calling clients that purchased policies from different agents and then upselling them. Those that aren't are sometimes just chasing advance and doing shady things. 4. The rates for policies ESPECIALLY for people over 60 are laughable... example: I can get a 60 year old Male non tobacco user can get straight whole life NONE GRADED day 1 coverage (meaning the policy is issued and in force when you write it bc it's UW is electronic... no extra phone calls) 20,000 for 68.50 but since I don't like that specific carrier I'd get them a better policy or carrier with Mutual of Omaha for 84.32. Check the price on eapp for the difference and keep in mind... those prices aren't graded. Which brings me to number 5. It's hard to have residuals and renewals when your policies are being replaced. TLDR: It's a decent starter company and yes you CAN make good money but to all of us outside of it we look at AIL Prime WFG and PHP like middle schoolers trying to look cool wearing mom and dad's clothes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/jx47s9t/

"Some lead vendors are honest stating their leads are sold to multiple agents, others however claim their leads are exclusive while recycling and selling the same lead multiple times over. You can definitely still find prospects that have yet to purchase a policy or even some that you may be able to offer a better rate to, but for the most part this type of lead is garbage and a headache to deal with. My agency has been using Speakeasy Leads for almost a year now for final expense and general life insurance leads. Agent Advantage has also been great for IUL leads. Both seem to be the few that offer legitimately exclusive leads and I rarely get the "I've already spoken to 10 agents" bs lol. A few vendors I would avoid from previous personal experience: Integrity Lead Center - these leads are definitely resold to multiple agents Leadrilla - Garbage TTC Leads - They were great, but since their original owner past away the lead quality suffered Caboom Leads - Overpriced + prospects seem to be just shoppers MediaAlpha - I've received numerous leads in the past that had disconnected #'s paired with many prospects who have been deceased for years, overall just seems like fake data. Overall, the best method is to learn how to generate your own leads or hire an expert to setup your campaigns/lead capture funnels. This however is much easier said than done as it does take some time, effort and money to effectively learn paid ads, and if you do hire an individual or agency to manage this for you their fees are steep with no results guaranteed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/merel99/

FMOs and uplines that don't deliver or won't release

"Well... fuck it. Put the IMO on blast so we know who are scammers are who aren't. Ah just kidding I would never want to "break the rules of a subreddit!" Some things rhyme though and many things share the same acronym entirely unrelated!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t9nf3b/seeking_advice_as_a_new_agent_struggling/ol4hk95/

"I didn't even make it to my first training with them. They had me sit in on a "mandatory" Zoom meeting (seriously? For 1099's?), which was an absolute shit-show of some agents making calls, others talking to one-another, and still others dicking around on video games--all at the same time, and with nothing muted. I couldn't take it. It also told me that nearly everything the recruiter had told me had been lies (a 30-hour week? Only 30 leads to call each week, and all of them union members who are sitting around twiddling their thumbs waiting for your call to complete their enrollment in benefits they're already signed up for? Cool! Easy money), which is why I opted out right then-and-there. Another thing about AIL I found to be VERY fishy was their requiring me to find a friend or associate to fill out an application and include all their personal information so that I could be appointed. When I asked what would then happen with the information, I was told not to worry, that it was just something necessary to be appointed and my friend, etc. wouldn't be liable for anything or be purchasing a policy. To this I asked why we can't just fudge things with made up info, but was told that "the system" wouldn't recognize it as a real person if we did. I also asked what happened to the information, and was told that it "...just goes to the company!" "And then what?" "Oh, I don't know, don't worry though!" Uh, when it comes to either mine or other people's personal information, yes, I worry. You may also want to take a look at all the BBB complaints against the company, of which there are shitloads. Though I realize that yes, AIL may be as legit as they come, I still don't like that they continuously speak of "uplines and downlines" since I'm leery of MLMs, and I sure as HELL ain't interested in having to lie to others to recruit them!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/koigwvj/

"So here's a funny twist in my insurance journey. I've been grinding, trying to build my agency, and for months I've been researching CRMs and dialers. I finally pulled the trigger and bought Ringy because everyone kept recommending it. Fast forward to this week... and I randomly discover I actually had access to Integrity's CRM, dialer, and lead marketplace the whole time for free through one of the agencies I'm contracted with. No one ever mentioned it. I literally stumbled into the dashboard by accident while looking for something else. Wild. I paid for a CRM meanwhile I already had access to one but my upline never brought it up. Smh Not mad about it though, just sharing in case any newer agents don't realize some FMOs/IMOs automatically give you tools like CRMs, dialers, quoting platforms, or lead systems that they never bother to highlight. Definitely worth double-checking what's included with your contracts before you go spending on extra software. If anyone else has had this happen or knows hidden features inside Integrity's system, drop some tips. I'm already finding stuff I didn't even know existed. However, I am going to keep the ringy platform. I really like the drip system they have for text and email and other features"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1odlyvq/solo_insurance_agent_looking_for_a_crm_dialer/no719a4/

Lead debt and money burned

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3g/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

Captive and call-center jobs: quotas, pay, pressure

"Do you know of any health insurance companies who pay their captive agent on an per hourly basis plus commissions? I just started with mine and its only 100% commission based, so for starters who dont have yet their clientele, money is a struggle. Do you have any advices?"

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Make? · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgtZY&lc=UgzzDyeN1Egxbx-37nx4AaABAg>

"I can relate. As a captive agent I get lots of pressure to meet unrealistic sales quotas without any consideration for the quality of calls we are receiving etc. Hostile /cluelessly ignorant management just push harder for the dollar on the ones trying the most instead of boost the team and skill build. Top performing agents are the ones getting quality sale inbounds directed to them on the backend through que assignment which I think is sus because it's clear those couple agents will continue doing big numbers while management whips us and acts like we should be able to do the same slam dunk on an outbound quote that was a no sale from the jump. There's some benefits working from home but yeah if the stress and money doesn't make sense it's confusing at times. But aye I worked hard to get where I'm at, ill continue to give my best - just not burn myself out because I've seen my enthusiasm and efforts be taken advantage of or unappreciated. Sometimes I wonder if I'm actually a licensed health insurance broker with a fiduciary responsibility or just a flkn used car salesman 🙄 cause God damn lol Hoping this week is much better tho for everyone here ❤️"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bogj6l/how_is_everyone_handling_burnout_during_these/kxeuukb/

"If you're building your own P&C book, why not go out and get appointed directly from the carrier? I'm a young P&C agency owner as well, and I've had my life license for about a year now (when I was with State Farm.) I never really liked life, but I know it builds solid retention within your book. So here in the next couple months I'll be looking out for life insurance company appointments. I'd rather sell life occasionally than be stuck working for an upline that mandates sales quotas and gives you crappy leads + takes a large chunk of your commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vtziac/my_experience_with_these_instagram_life_insurance/p54kywp/

Reviews by Star

NextGen Leads

- **1★** Disconnected or wrong numbers, unqualified leads, returns rejected or refunded at 10–12%, leads already in the agent's system (resold).
- **2–3★** Good technology and reps, poor lead quality; bidding on leads; mixed close rates (one sale from ~30 leads).
- **4–5★** Almost all name an account manager (Jeff, Madeleine, Jay); the few about leads praise first-access exclusivity if called fast.
- **What should change** A bad-lead return policy agents can trust, and proof a lead was not already sold elsewhere.

Allcalls.io

- **1★** Callers expecting a free 'food card', a 61-year-old billed as a Medicare call, a 26-second billing buffer, \$300 gone fast.
- **2–3★** Dropped calls, poor audio, refunds not received.
- **4–5★** Call clarity and the platform; one agency owner reports 2–4 policies a month per agent.
- **What should change** A longer billable-call buffer, age and intent screening before the transfer, refunds honored.

QuoteWizard

- **1★** Agents who bought: uninterested people and disconnected numbers; leads recognized from aged lists bought elsewhere.
- **2★** '\$15 a pop for fresh high-intent leads' that performed worse than aged leads.
- **4–5★** Mostly consumer reviews of the quote site, not agents (excluded from this tab's reading).
- **What should change** Freshness and exclusivity that can be verified.

SmartFinancial

- **1★** 'Don't buy leads from them'; a \$500 minimum deposit for about 40 leads that did not perform.
- **3★** 'Be aware of the billing and keep track of the leads.'
- **What should change** Transparent billing and credits.

Why They Buy (Ad Brief)

The five answers an ad needs, built only from what this page already proves. Every line carries its count and a verbatim example with a link; the "docs" column is distinct documents in this page's voice. Lines are reads of the evidence; hooks, features and "demonstrate it" clauses are hypotheses to test.

Built from the measured themes, the complaints ledger, the Lead Sources ledger, the silent layer and the agent-facing ads on this page. Vince has not yet reviewed this page's strategy layer; when he does, his lines replace or re-order these and each is checked against the corpus the same way.

1. Why they buy — the main reasons

Leads are the business; the reasons below are how agents say it.

Line	Docs	Verbatim example	Where it is counted
They buy leads because nothing else fills the calendar	440	"I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone." r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/) · 64 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('solutions')); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 6 · Bought leads from vendors
They want a book of business that pays renewals	21	"My goal each year is \$100k FYC plus my renewals in Medicare." Insurance-Forums.com · Does anyone really get "rich" selling Medicare (https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/does-anyone-really-get-rich-selling-medicare.113372/#post-1494991) · 5 reactions	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('hopes')); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 2 · A book of business and renewals that pay every year
They want one lead source that works every month	10	"I'm desperately looking to build my book of business this year and I'm really looking for viable lead sources outside of open enrollment and would love to hear about the source you use during open enrollment to reach those numbers- I'm willing to invest in myself." r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.re	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('hopes')); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 2 · A lead source that works every month

		ddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rx4iw2/enrolled_500_aca_clients_my_first_open_enrollmen/ob4t2br/ · 3 upvotes	
A source that paid once keeps them buying	22	"I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/) · 8 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("outcomes")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 8 · A lead source that finally paid
They left a captive or call-center start and now pay their own way	281	"If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this"r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/) · 97 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("solutions")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 6 · Captive or call-center job first
The season: the year's applications are written in a few weeks	18	"The agency culture is nice, fully remote, warmish inbound leads, good training, decent commission, and I sold 110 policies in AEP."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/) · 6 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("outcomes")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 8 · AEP numbers: applications written

2. Recurring problems and frustrations

The complaint themes, each measured with a complaint-specific pattern and read for precision.

Line	Docs	Verbatim example	Where it is counted
Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer	124	"Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/) · 26 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer
Prospects who ghost, no-show or already have an agent	60	"I have been yelled at, hung up on, spoken down to, and blamed for things outside of my control."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ty3ilg/update_being_let_go_from_a_toxic_agency_turned/) · 34 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Prospects who ghost, no-show or already have an agent
What a lead costs against what a sale pays	30	"Every once in a while, I'll try a new lead company and sometimes it works out but typically, the leads get worse and worse over time (that's their business model in many cases), so it becomes not worth the time or money."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/np07djl/) · 2 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · What a lead costs against what a sale pays
FMOs and uplines that own the book or won't release	40	"Joined a big one first year and the exit clause was basically "we own your book forever" - took me 3 years to buy my way out of that mess."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadqv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p5fdhsa/) · 20 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · FMOs and uplines that own the book or won't release
Carriers cutting or removing commissions	49	"#1 Major carriers are cutting commissions or removing them entirely."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/) · 27 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Carriers: non-commissionable plans, cuts and service
TCPA, consent and do-not-call exposure	40	"For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/) · 17 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · TCPA, consent and do-not-call exposure
Bait-and-switch consumer marketing they have to clean up	46	"I had nightmares about those garbage food/flex cards."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7vk9p/) · 28 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Bait-and-switch marketing ('free' benefits, 'free' policies)
MLMs and captive agencies that recruit on promises	28	"Now I don't even know what to do with this license because 99% of the recruiters I talk to are still just wanting people for MLM crap or straight up scams."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/) · 36 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · MLMs and captive agencies that recruit on promises
CMS rules and commission caps	26	"The hold on the final rule burnt agents drastically as some carriers cut commissions mid AEP."YouTube · The Reality of A Career in Medicare Insurance Sales in 2025 (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Nwa60sSWldo&lc=UgxjdalukEsc_mbiYbGR4AaABAg) · 5 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · CMS rules and commission caps
Inbound calls and transfers from offshore call centers	18	"Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuub/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/) · 5 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Inbound calls and transfers from offshore call centers
No training: recruited, then left alone	15	"Being strung along just long enough to qualify for the bonus then essentially left to sink or swim from there."r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/on4z8u/) · 6 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · No training: all recruiting, no selling

3. Questions and objections that stop them

What agents search and watch in private. Typed = Google and YouTube autocomplete phrases that still name the question (not a search volume). Views are everyone who watched.

The question	Typed (autocomplete phrases that still name it)	Videos whose title names it	Views	In their own voice	Most-watched video
Will these leads answer, or is this more money burned?	0	6	24,971	43 docs	The Mistake Insurance Agents Make When Buying Leads  #insurance #insuranceagent #sales #leads (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3EsCwn_jxPQ) (20,057 views)
Will the commission be charged back?	27chargeback in insurance · chargeback insurance agent · chargeback insurance australia · chargeback insurance companies	44	154,711	71 docs	What Is A CHARGEBACK? (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dqAr7wP_JgM) (38,779 views)
Will this get me a CMS, carrier or TCPA problem?	0	48	25,434	55 docs	BREAKING: TCPA Update on New Cold Calling/Text Rules (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z47wv1_N41g) (6,723 views)
Is this FMO going to own my book?	0	54	138,446	109 docs	Insurance Brokers FMO and MGA (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HjL0fGqgz08) (50,251 views)
Can I make it through year one?	3how to make money as an insurance agent · how to make money from insurance company · how to make money in insurance	42	2,940,375	23 docs	Insurance BROKER vs. AGENT (Know the Difference) #agent #broker #insurance (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=va0c5svjhEQ) (963,974 views)
Should I quit?	7why do insurance agents quit · why do life insurance agents quit · why do most insurance agents quit · why do most life insurance agents quit	41	725,860	21 docs	WHY I QUIT BEING A REAL ESTATE AGENT! #realestateagent #realestate #business (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OnwPaRU5fO8) (528,797 views)
Will ACA enrollment problems land on my license?	0	2	4,539	4 docs	How to process Agent of Record (AOR) changes for ACA "Obamacare" policies!! (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iXCp-KwfMwY) (3,887 views)

4. Hooks and formats in the market

What the sellers and recruiters reaching agents open with, counted over every agent-facing ad on the Competitor Ads tab.

Measured over 550 ads to this audience (266 video, 284 static). One ad can use several hooks.

Hook pattern	Ads	Advertisers	Verbatim opening lines
Inbound calls / live transfers (no dialing)	130	37	" Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers! " — Exclusive T65 Medicare Opportunities Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1071008501391674) "FINALLY a \$0 Program for Insurance Agents ⚡ Eterna Spark ⚡ - 70 Starting Comp Tier - \$0 Investment - Lead Flow Covered (inbound calls & real-time OTP leads) - Monthly Producer Bonuses - Operations &" — Eterna Insurance Solutions Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=836318702130873) "Real talk for insurance agents 📞 92% of agents quit in year one." — profitprintercalls Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1483620726717649)
Named-audience qualifier ('Medicare agents:')	126	44	"👉 ATTENTION LIFE INSURANCE AGENTS 👉 👉 Looking for the ability to work fully-remote control your schedule?" — Lifeline Family Benefits Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=829459029996497) "Insurance agents and agency owners: Running ads, managing leads, and following up shouldn't feel like a full-time job on top of selling." — Scaleyourlead Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1804133846952126) "📞 Insurance Agents: Tired of Chasing Leads?" — Cody E. Askins Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1212576827149801)
Question hook	113	43	" Want More Medicare Clients? " — Medicare Agents Hub Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1377620333665953) "Are you stuck at a job you dislike?" — Preferred Senior Advisors Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1198510251483352) "Are you an insurance agent?" — Insuremenowdirect Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1398265161187955)
Exclusive / verified / compliant leads	113	35	" Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers! " — Exclusive T65 Medicare Opportunities Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1071008501391674) "Are you an insurance agent?" — Insuremenowdirect Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1398265161187955) "📞 We help agents scale with PHONE-VERIFIED, qualified, compliant leads that convert." — Cody E. Askins Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=24607579135529462)
Income claim	104	18	"💎 FOR LICENSED AGENTS & AGENCIES ONLY 💎 Southern California Medicare agents - tired of paying for E&O and AHIP out of pocket?" — Senplicity Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1733994004673384) "💎 FOR LICENSED AGENTS & AGENCIES ONLY 💎 Southern California Medi agents - tired of paying for E&O and AHIP out of pocket?" — Senplicity Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1235629598654619) "Real talk for insurance agents 📞 92% of agents quit in year one." — profitprintercalls Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1483620726717649)
Against junk / shared / aged leads	85	25	" Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers! " — Exclusive T65 Medicare Opportunities Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1071008501391674) "📞 Building a stable Medicare book starts with the right prospects. Relying on recycled or unverified leads can lead to wasted time, lower retention, and unpredictable results." — Seven Figure Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1410984154025601) "📞 Insurance Agents: Tired of Chasing Leads?" — Cody E. Askins Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1212576827149801)
FMO / contract / own your book	78	32	" Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers! " — Exclusive T65 Medicare Opportunities Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1071008501391674) "👉 ATTENTION LIFE INSURANCE AGENTS 👉 👉 Looking for the ability to work fully-remote control your schedule?" — Lifeline Family Benefits Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=829459029996497) "📞 Texas Licensed Life Insurance Agents Let's be honest... If you're struggling right now, it's usually because of: ❌ weak training ❌ low contracts ❌ no real marketing system ❌ inconsistent production Mo" — Nick FitzGerald Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=2353169128523414)
Guarantee / pay only on results	65	20	"FINALLY a \$0 Program for Insurance Agents ⚡ Eterna Spark ⚡ - 70 Starting Comp Tier - \$0 Investment - Lead Flow Covered (inbound calls & real-time OTP leads) - Monthly Producer Bonuses - Operations &" — Eterna Insurance Solutions Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=836318702130873) "FINALLY a \$0 Program for Life Insurance Agents - \$0 Investment - Lead Flow Covered (inbound calls & real-time OTP leads) - Monthly Producer Bonuses - Operations & Client Retention done by the company" — Eterna Insurance Solutions Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=863907533396845) "Attention Annuity Producers!" — Heartland National Life Insurance Company Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=2021269275131726)
AEP / OEP urgency	51	24	" Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers! " — Exclusive T65 Medicare Opportunities Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1071008501391674) "Are you stuck at a job you dislike?" — Preferred Senior Advisors Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1198510251483352) "💎 FOR LICENSED AGENTS & AGENCIES ONLY 💎 Southern California Medicare agents - tired of paying for E&O and AHIP out of pocket?" — Senplicity Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1733994004673384)
Number + timeframe (apps, appointments, calls per day / month)	7	5	"📞 Too many ACA teams are paying for volume and losing money in the process." — FluxProtocol Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=989886087030940) "Want to write 15+ T65 apps per month — without chasing leads?" — Senior Sphere Marketing Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1676181523491482) "📞 Agents On Penguin Leads Average 3 Deals A Day." — Penguin Leads Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1094614889803477)

5. Features and benefits to demonstrate in an ad

Each one as the feature, what would be on screen, and the agent voice that asks for it. The 'demonstrate it' clauses are hypotheses.

Feature or benefit	Demonstrate it (hypothesis: what is on screen)	Who asks for it, in their words
Consent to one agent, by name	The consent record with the agent's name in it, as delivered with the lead.	40 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick'))/"".includes("frustrations"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · TCPA, consent and do-not-call exposure"For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down." r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/) · 17 upvotes
A verified, working phone	The one-time-code step the shopper completes, and the contact rate of the last batch.	124 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick'))/"".includes("frustrations"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer"Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails." r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/ba_daleads_scam/) · 26 upvotes
Never resold	The exclusivity clause in the terms, readable on screen.	16 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick'))/"".includes("dislikes"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Dislikes · Shared leads sold to many agents"1 blame the lead vendors that resell the same leads to 5 different offices" r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnr/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to_oag95t/) · 16 upvotes
Bad numbers replaced	The credit policy and one real credited lead from a past order.	48 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick'))/"".includes("dislikes"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Dislikes · Leads that never answer or are fake"The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do." r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/) · 6 upvotes
Priced per enrollment at their own close rate	The calculator: lead price, their contact and close rates, cost per enrollment next to the commission.	30 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick'))/"".includes("frustrations"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · What a lead costs against what a sale pays"Every once in a while, I'll try a new lead company and sometimes it works out but typically, the leads get worse and worse over time (that's their business model in many cases), so it becomes not worth the time or money." r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/npo7ldj/) · 2 upvotes
No contract that owns their book	A one-page order form: no assignment of commissions, cancel any week.	40 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick'))/"".includes("frustrations"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · FMOs and uplines that own the book or won't release"Joined a big one first year and the exit clause was basically "we own your book forever" - took me 3 years to buy my way out of that mess." r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadqv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p5fghsa/) · 20 upvotes
Delivered before the season starts	A calendar with the first delivery date ahead of October 15 and November 1.	64 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick'))/"".includes("fears"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 1 · Money spent on leads that don't pay back"Do not leverage yourself past your means for leads as far as I'm concerned that's gambling and not a good idea." r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/nnantr/) · 3 upvotes

What this research does not show: price reaction (what agents will actually pay per lead, call or appointment beyond what they post), which vendors deliver what their ads claim, and the working agents inside private Facebook groups, who are under-read here. Agent-posted prices are few; the Metrics tab leans on vendor rate pages and says so.

Metrics & Pricing

What an independent agent pays for each event on the way to an enrollment, what that event costs you to produce, and where to price it. Pick a lead type: its cost per lead and its four rates load together. Every rate is the median of the published figures listed under "Where every figure comes from", one vote per vendor (a vendor with several pages counts once, as their average); nearly all of them come from companies that sell leads, calls or dialing software, and the few agents who posted their own numbers are listed beside them. Raw = the lead price or media only. With labor = plus the calling it takes to reach, qualify and book (BLS wage, dialer speed, attempts per lead).

Market size

- **Medicare Advantage enrollees:** 35.2M — 55% of 64.2M with Parts A & B (KFF, Feb 2026)
- **ACA plan selections:** 23.1M — 2026 open enrollment, down 4.9% (CMS)
- **Max MA commission, 2027:** \$725 — New enrollment · \$363 renewal (CMS memo)
- **Enrollment window:** Oct 15–Dec 7 — Medicare AEP · ACA OEP Nov 1–Jan 15

No sourced count of independent agents selling Medicare or ACA was found; the page does not estimate one.

Raw cost per event — by lead type

Bold = total for the needed count; the line under it = cost per event. Change any rate to use your own numbers; the lead type's cost per lead stays.

Calculator on the live page; the tables use the default lead type (Your own Meta campaign (self-gen, exclusive)). Lead types (contact / appointment set / show / close of held %, cost per lead MA): Your own Meta campaign (self-gen, exclusive) 54/17/75/19, \$10–\$33; One agent's own T65 Meta campaign (measured) 54/47/75/18, \$5.67; Exclusive web lead (bought) 70/31.5/75/41, \$35–\$75; T65 exclusive (bought) 70/35/75/46.5, \$45–\$90; Shared web lead (bought) 25/19/75/21.5, \$15–\$31; Aged lead, 30–90 days (bought) 18.5/40/75/37.5, \$1.00–\$6.50; Live transfer / inbound call (bought) 100/100/100/25, \$58–\$109.

Funnel stage	Needed for 1 enrollment	Medicare Advantage	Medicare Supplement	ACA
Lead	76.4 leads	\$764–\$2,484 (\$10–\$33 per lead)	\$764–\$2,484 (\$10–\$33 per lead)	\$612–\$2,293 (\$8.00–\$30 per lead)
Contacted	41.3 contacts	\$764–\$2,484 (\$19–\$60 per contact)	\$764–\$2,484 (\$19–\$60 per contact)	\$612–\$2,293 (\$15–\$56 per contact)
Appointment booked	7.0 booked	\$764–\$2,484 (\$109–\$354 per booked appointment)	\$764–\$2,484 (\$109–\$354 per booked appointment)	\$612–\$2,293 (\$87–\$327 per booked appointment)
Appointment held	5.3 held	\$764–\$2,484 (\$145–\$472 per held appointment)	\$764–\$2,484 (\$145–\$472 per held appointment)	\$612–\$2,293 (\$116–\$436 per held appointment)
Enrollment	1.0 enrollment	\$764–\$2,484 (\$764–\$2,484 per enrollment)	\$764–\$2,484 (\$764–\$2,484 per enrollment)	\$612–\$2,293 (\$612–\$2,293 per enrollment)

Target enrollment budget

Model	Raw	With calling labor	Read
Medicare Advantage	\$764–\$2,484	\$1,145–\$2,865	Pays the agent up to \$725 now, \$363 a year after.
Medicare Supplement	\$764–\$2,484	\$1,145–\$2,865	≈\$502 first year (22% of a \$190/month Plan G); not CMS-capped.
ACA	\$612–\$2,293	\$992–\$2,674	\$20–\$30 per member per month while enrolled (BenaVest).
Agent buying live transfers (MA)	N/A	\$233–\$437	\$58–\$109 per call at the published median 25% close.
Agent buying exclusive leads (MA)	N/A	\$516–\$1,106	\$35–\$75 per lead at the published exclusive rates.

Cost per event with calling labor, and what agents pay

Funnel stage	Medicare Advantage	Medicare Supplement	ACA	What agents pay (market)
Lead	\$1,145–\$2,865 (\$15–\$37 per lead)	\$1,145–\$2,865 (\$15–\$37 per lead)	\$992–\$2,674 (\$13–\$35 per lead)	MA \$35–\$75 · Med Supp \$40–\$80 · ACA \$30–\$48 (the published price of this lead type (your Meta lead sells as exclusive))
Contacted	\$1,145–\$2,865 (\$28–\$69 per contact)	\$1,145–\$2,865 (\$28–\$69 per contact)	\$992–\$2,674 (\$24–\$65 per contact)	\$58–\$109 (MA live transfer / inbound call; Med Supp \$55–\$125; ACA \$44–\$88)
Appointment booked	\$1,145–\$2,865 (\$163–\$408 per booked appointment)	\$1,145–\$2,865 (\$163–\$408 per booked appointment)	\$992–\$2,674 (\$141–\$381 per booked appointment)	(No published vendor price for a Medicare or ACA appointment was found. One agency owner charges its own agents \$25 per presentation (r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/ny9dvtm/)) — an internal, at-cost price.)
Appointment held	\$1,145–\$2,865 (\$218–\$544 per held appointment)	\$1,145–\$2,865 (\$218–\$544 per held appointment)	\$992–\$2,674 (\$188–\$508 per held appointment)	\$212–\$454 (not a price: what a held MA appointment costs the agent now, buying exclusive leads at published rates (ACA \$181–\$290))
Enrollment	\$1,145–\$2,865 (\$1,145–\$2,865 per enrollment)	\$1,145–\$2,865 (\$1,145–\$2,865 per enrollment)	\$992–\$2,674 (\$992–\$2,674 per enrollment)	\$233–\$437 (MA via transfers (\$58–\$109 ÷ 25% close); via exclusive leads \$516–\$1,106)

Lead types side by side (Medicare Advantage, published rates)

Lead type	Cost per lead (MA)	Contact	Appointment set	Show	Close (of held)	Lead → enrollment, these rates	Lead → enrollment, published	Cost per held appointment	Cost per enrollment
Your own Meta campaign (self-gen, exclusive) (you produce)	\$10–\$33	54% (median of 2 sources (35–60%))	17% (median of 1 source (12–22%))	75% (median of 3 sources (60–80%) — all lead types)	19% (median of 2 sources (13.3–26.7%) — booked-basis figures ÷ show)	1.3%	3.4–20% (5 published figures, median 7.5%)	\$145–\$472	\$764–\$2,484 (\$1,145–\$2,865 with calling labor)
One agent's own T65 Meta campaign (measured) (measured, one campaign)	\$5.67	54% (median of 2 sources (35–60%))	47% (derived from the measured 19% of leads reaching a real conversation)	75% (median of 3 sources (60–80%) — all lead types)	18% (median of 1 source (17.9–17.9%))	3.4%	3.4% (measured, one campaign (still rising))	\$30	\$165 (\$311 with calling labor)

Exclusive web lead (bought) (agents buy)	\$35–\$75	70% (median of 3 sources (40–85%))	31.5% (median of 3 sources (22–50%))	75% (median of 3 sources (60–80%) — all lead types)	41% (median of 2 sources (25–50.7%) — booked-basis figures ÷ show)	6.8%	7.7–25% (5 published figures, median 11.8%)	\$212–\$454	\$516–\$1,106 (\$602–\$1,192 with calling labor)
T65 exclusive (bought) (agents buy)	\$45–\$90	70% (median of 3 sources (40–85%) — exclusive figures)	35% (median of 1 source (30–40%))	75% (median of 3 sources (60–80%) — all lead types)	46.5% (median of 1 source (40–53.3%) — booked-basis figures ÷ show)	8.5%	(none published)	\$245–\$490	\$527–\$1,053 (\$595–\$1,121 with calling labor)
Shared web lead (bought) (agents buy)	\$15–\$31	25% (median of 5 sources (10–55%))	19% (median of 2 sources (10–22%))	75% (median of 3 sources (60–80%) — all lead types)	21.5% (median of 1 source (13.3–29.3%) — booked-basis figures ÷ show)	0.8%	1–12% (4 published figures, median 2.8%)	\$421–\$856	\$1,958–\$3,982 (\$2,289–\$4,313 with calling labor)
Aged lead, 30–90 days (bought) (agents buy)	\$1.00–\$6.50	18.5% (median of 2 sources (6–30%))	40% (median of 1 source (30–50%) — all lead types)	75% (median of 3 sources (60–80%) — all lead types)	37.5% (median of 1 source (25–50%) — all lead types)	2.1%	0.2–8% (7 published figures, median 2.8%)	\$18–\$117	\$48–\$312 (\$165–\$429 with calling labor)
Live transfer / inbound call (bought) (agents buy)	\$58–\$109	100% (median of 3 sources (95–100%))	100% (live call)	100% (live call)	25% (median of 11 sources (1–70%))	25.0%	1–70% (13 published figures, median 25.0%)	\$58–\$109	\$233–\$437 (\$233–\$437 with calling labor)

Read the two lead → enrollment columns together: for every lead type the published stage rates multiply to less than the published end-to-end figures. They come from different vendors, and the end-to-end figures often count applications or "closes" rather than effective enrollments. The truth for your leads sits between them until you measure it.

Your own Meta campaign (self-gen, exclusive)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$15–\$40 Insurance Advertising Masters, Medicare lead generation (agents' own Facebook campaigns) (<https://www.insuranceadvertisingmasters.com/guides/medicare-lead-generation>) · \$20–\$40 ResultCalls, 10 ways to get Medicare leads (<https://resultcalls.com/blog/10-ways-to-get-exclusive-medicare-leads-in-2026>) · \$10–\$25 unLocked CRM, Medicare T65 Facebook ads (<https://unlockedcrm.ai/blog/medicare-t65-facebook-ads-strategy>) · \$10–\$40 SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) · \$5.67 Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: own T65 Facebook campaign — 352 leads at \$5.67, 67 real conversations, 12 enrollments (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qk9cgh/turning_65_facebook_ad_campaign/) · \$5.00–\$10 Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: 'I do my own Medicare ads on Facebook, \$5-10 per lead' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1reff85/lead_generation_help/o7c8785/) → used \$10–\$33 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$15–\$40 Insurance Advertising Masters, Medicare lead generation (agents' own Facebook campaigns) (<https://www.insuranceadvertisingmasters.com/guides/medicare-lead-generation>) · \$20–\$40 ResultCalls, 10 ways to get Medicare leads (<https://resultcalls.com/blog/10-ways-to-get-exclusive-medicare-leads-in-2026>) · \$10–\$25 unLocked CRM, Medicare T65 Facebook ads (<https://unlockedcrm.ai/blog/medicare-t65-facebook-ads-strategy>) · \$10–\$40 SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) · \$5.67 Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: own T65 Facebook campaign — 352 leads at \$5.67, 67 real conversations, 12 enrollments (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qk9cgh/turning_65_facebook_ad_campaign/) · \$5.00–\$10 Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: 'I do my own Medicare ads on Facebook, \$5-10 per lead' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1reff85/lead_generation_help/o7c8785/) → used \$10–\$33 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** \$8.00–\$30 OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) → used \$8.00–\$30 (median low – median high)
- **Contact:** 35–60% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 60% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: FB setup 'gets you to 60% contact eventually' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qcyrm6/inbound_call_leads_for_struggling_life_insurance/nzsah6f/)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 12–22% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>)
- **Close:** 10–20% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) (of booked appointments; ÷ show rate to get of held) · 17.9104% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: own T65 Facebook campaign — 352 leads at \$5.67, 67 real conversations, 12 enrollments (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qk9cgh/turning_65_facebook_ad_campaign/)
- **Show:** 75% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 60–72% Touchstone, appointment-setting benchmarks (<http://touchstonebpo.com/blog/appointment-setting-conversion-rates-2026/>) · 70–80% Aexus, sales show rates (<https://aexus.com/what-is-a-good-show-rate-for-sales-appointments/>) (no source splits show rate by lead type)
- **Lead → enrollment, published:** 3.4% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: own T65 Facebook campaign — 352 leads at \$5.67, 67 real conversations, 12 enrollments (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qk9cgh/turning_65_facebook_ad_campaign/) · 10% ResultCalls, 10 ways to get Medicare leads (<https://resultcalls.com/blog/10-ways-to-get-exclusive-medicare-leads-in-2026>) · 20% unLocked CRM, Medicare T65 Facebook ads (<https://unlockedcrm.ai/blog/medicare-t65-facebook-ads-strategy>) · 4% SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) · 5–10% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: 'Facebook leads - 5% to 10%' (good agents) (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/mm0dceb/)
- Meta leads are self-generated: the agent (or you) runs the campaign and the lead is exclusive. Cost per lead uses Medicare-specific sources only (agencies and agents running their own Facebook campaigns). The only stage-by-stage Meta figures are OneLife's all-insurance lead-ad benchmarks; the Medicare end-to-end figures run higher. No ACA-specific self-gen Meta cost was found, so ACA uses OneLife's all-insurance lead-ad range.

One agent's own T65 Meta campaign (measured)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$5.67 Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: own T65 Facebook campaign — 352 leads at \$5.67, 67 real conversations, 12 enrollments (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qk9cgh/turning_65_facebook_ad_campaign/) → used \$5.67 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$5.67 Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: own T65 Facebook campaign — 352 leads at \$5.67, 67 real conversations, 12 enrollments (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qk9cgh/turning_65_facebook_ad_campaign/) → used \$5.67 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** no published price
- **Contact:** 35–60% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 60% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: FB setup 'gets you to 60% contact eventually' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qcyrm6/inbound_call_leads_for_struggling_life_insurance/nzsah6f/)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** derived — measured conversations (67 of 352 leads) ÷ (contact × show).
- **Close:** 17.9104% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: own T65 Facebook campaign — 352 leads at \$5.67, 67 real conversations, 12 enrollments (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qk9cgh/turning_65_facebook_ad_campaign/)
- **Show:** 75% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 60–72% Touchstone, appointment-setting benchmarks (<http://touchstonebpo.com/blog/appointment-setting-conversion-rates-2026/>) · 70–80% Aexus, sales show rates (<https://aexus.com/what-is-a-good-show-rate-for-sales-appointments/>)

[ointments/](#)) (no source splits show rate by lead type)

- **Lead → enrollment, published:** 3.40909% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: own T65 Facebook campaign — 352 leads at \$5.67, 67 real conversations, 12 enrollments (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qk9cgh/turning_65_facebook_ad_campaign/)
- Reproduces one agent's posted T65 Facebook campaign: 352 leads, 67 real conversations of 15–45 minutes (19% of leads, treated as held appointments), 12 enrollments (18% of them) and rising, since many had not reached their enrollment window. Contact and show use the published figures; the appointment-set rate is derived so that contact × set × show = 19%.

Exclusive web lead (bought)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$35–\$75 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$70 InsureLeads, Medicare leads (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/medicare-leads>) · \$35–\$75 InsureLeads, Medicare lead companies (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/best-medicare-lead-companies>) · \$20–\$40 InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · \$25–\$80 SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) → used \$35–\$75 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$40–\$80 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$40–\$80 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** \$22–\$48 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$45 InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) · \$30–\$80 Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost/>) → used \$30–\$48 (median low – median high)
- **Contact:** 70–85% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 60–80% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 40–70% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 25–38% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 22% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 30–50% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>)
- **Close:** 28–38% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) (of booked appointments; ÷ show rate to get of held) · 25–50% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>)
- **Show:** 75% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 60–72% Touchstone, appointment-setting benchmarks (<https://touchstonebpo.com/blog/appointment-setting-conversion-rates-2026/>) · 70–80% Aexus, sales show rates (<https://aexus.com/what-is-a-good-show-rate-for-sales-appointments/>) (no source splits show rate by lead type)
- **Lead → enrollment, published:** 8–15% InsureLeads, conversion benchmarks (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-lead-conversion-rate-benchmarks>) · 10–15% InsureLeads, Medicare leads (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/medicare-leads>) · 8–15% InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · 10–25% SeniorCenterAgents, lead costs (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-much-do-insurance-leads-cost-for-independent-agents>) · 7.7% OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>)

T65 exclusive (bought)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$45–\$90 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$45–\$90 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$45–\$90 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$45–\$90 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** no published price
- **Contact:** 70–85% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 60–80% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 40–70% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) (no figure for this lead type; all-lead-type figure used)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 30–40% OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>)
- **Close:** 30–40% OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>) (of booked appointments; ÷ show rate to get of held)
- **Show:** 75% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 60–72% Touchstone, appointment-setting benchmarks (<https://touchstonebpo.com/blog/appointment-setting-conversion-rates-2026/>) · 70–80% Aexus, sales show rates (<https://aexus.com/what-is-a-good-show-rate-for-sales-appointments/>) (no source splits show rate by lead type)
- No T65-specific contact rate is published; the exclusive web-lead contact figures are used.

Shared web lead (bought)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$12–\$26 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$18–\$35 InsureLeads, Medicare lead companies (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/best-medicare-lead-companies>) → used \$15–\$31 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$14–\$30 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$14–\$30 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** \$7.00–\$18 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$10–\$30 Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost/>) → used \$8.50–\$24 (median low – median high)
- **Contact:** 30–55% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 10–15% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 25% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) · 10% Agent, Insurance-Forums: '20 shared leads and 10% pick up' (<https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/vimo-live-transfers.3746/#post-41297>) · 30% Agent, Insurance-Forums: '70% of all your shared leads won't answer' (<https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/looking-for-a-telemarketer-im-offering-2-0-00-a-week.2033/#post-27366>)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 10–22% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 22% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>)
- **Close:** 10–22% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) (of booked appointments; ÷ show rate to get of held)
- **Show:** 75% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 60–72% Touchstone, appointment-setting benchmarks (<https://touchstonebpo.com/blog/appointment-setting-conversion-rates-2026/>) · 70–80% Aexus, sales show rates (<https://aexus.com/what-is-a-good-show-rate-for-sales-appointments/>) (no source splits show rate by lead type)

- **Lead → enrollment, published:** 2–5% InsureLeads, Medicare lead companies (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/best-medicare-lead-companies>) · 5–12% SeniorCenterAgents, lead costs (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-much-do-insurance-leads-cost-for-independent-agents>) · 1% OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · 2% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>)

Aged lead, 30–90 days (bought)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$0.50–\$3.00 Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost/>) · \$0.75–\$5.00 InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) · \$8.00–\$20 InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · \$1.00–\$10 OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>) · \$1.00–\$8.00 Plura, live-transfer pricing (<https://www.plura.ai/articles/live-transfer-pricing-2026>) · \$0.01–\$0.50 The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadswarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · \$1.00–\$5.00 SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) → used \$1.00–\$6.50 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$0.50–\$3.00 Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost/>) · \$0.75–\$5.00 InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) · \$8.00–\$20 InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · \$1.00–\$10 OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>) · \$1.00–\$8.00 Plura, live-transfer pricing (<https://www.plura.ai/articles/live-transfer-pricing-2026>) · \$0.01–\$0.50 The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadswarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · \$1.00–\$5.00 SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) → used \$1.00–\$6.50 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** \$0.50–\$3.00 Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost/>) · \$0.50–\$3.50 InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) · \$0.01–\$0.50 The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadswarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · \$0.35–\$4.00 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$0.43–\$3.25 (median low – median high)
- **Contact:** 15–25% OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · 6–12% OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · 15–30% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 30–50% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) (no figure for this lead type; all-lead-type figure used)
- **Close:** 25–50% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) (no figure for this lead type; all-lead-type figure used)
- **Show:** 75% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 60–72% Touchstone, appointment-setting benchmarks (<http://touchstonebpo.com/blog/appointment-setting-conversion-rates-2026/>) · 70–80% Aexus, sales show rates (<https://aexus.com/what-is-a-good-show-rate-for-sales-appointments/>) (no source splits show rate by lead type)
- **Lead → enrollment, published:** 1–3% AllCalls, inbound Medicare calls (<https://allcalls.io/blog/is-real-time-medicare-inbound-calls-worth-it-2026-cost-benefits-and-verdict/>) · 2–5% InsureLeads, conversion benchmarks (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-lead-conversion-rate-benchmarks>) · 2–5% InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · 2–8% SeniorCenterAgents, lead costs (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-much-do-insurance-leads-cost-for-independent-agents>) · 0.2% The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadswarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · 3–7% Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost/>) · 0.8% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: '0.8% conversion rate on 30 day+ leads' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pmr7pi/how_are_we_generating_leads_going_into_2026/nu3qz9h/)
- OneLife publishes contact by age band (7–30 days 15–25%, 60–120 days 6–12%); both bands are used for 30–90 days. No aged-specific appointment or close rate is published, so the all-lead-type figures are used.

Live transfer / inbound call (bought)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$45–\$120 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$125 InsureLeads, Medicare leads (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/medicare-leads>) · \$40–\$120 The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadswarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · \$45–\$85 InsureLeads, Medicare lead companies (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/best-medicare-lead-companies>) · \$45–\$85 InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · \$90 AllCalls, inbound Medicare calls (<https://allcalls.io/blog/is-real-time-medicare-inbound-calls-worth-it-2026-cost-benefits-and-verdict/>) → used \$58–\$109 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$55–\$125 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$55–\$125 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** \$32–\$85 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$30–\$90 The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadswarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · \$100 InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) · \$55 Agent (ACA), r/InsuranceAgent: 'I close 60-70% of my calls' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1kykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/nmf0j8t/) → used \$44–\$88 (median low – median high)
- **Contact:** 95–100% Plura, live-transfer pricing (<https://www.plura.ai/articles/live-transfer-pricing-2026>) · 100% InsureLeads, conversion benchmarks (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-lead-conversion-rate-benchmarks>) · 100% OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 100% — the transfer is already a live conversation.
- **Close:** 15–25% AllCalls, inbound Medicare calls (<https://allcalls.io/blog/is-real-time-medicare-inbound-calls-worth-it-2026-cost-benefits-and-verdict/>) · 15–25% InsureLeads, conversion benchmarks (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-lead-conversion-rate-benchmarks>) · 15–30% InsureLeads, Medicare leads (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/medicare-leads>) · 15–25% InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · 20–30% The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadswarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · 25–40% OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>) · 20–40% SeniorCenterAgents, lead costs (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-much-do-insurance-leads-cost-for-independent-agents>) · 25% Agent, Insurance-Forums: 'brokers are closing 25% of the live calls' (<https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/vimo-live-transfers.3746/#post-19367>) · 20% Agent, Insurance-Forums: 'closing 1 in 5' live calls (<https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/vimo-live-transfers.3746/#post-19367>) · 40% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: 'I close 40% of the inbound calls' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15nmmk7/how_to_start_an_insurance_agency_imo/jyvu80t/) · 60–70% Agent (ACA), r/InsuranceAgent: 'I close 60-70% of my calls' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1kykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/nmf0j8t/) · 1–2% Health-agency marketer, r/InsuranceAgent: paid inbound calls at a 'consistent 1-2% close rate' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ge3mjw/if_you_use_paid_marketing_can_you_share_your_stats/) · 15–20% Agent reply, same thread: telesales 'if inbound they should convert at 15-20%'; outbound 5-10% of total leads (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ge3mjw/if_you_use_paid_marketing_can_you_share_your_stats/lu6vxjq/)

- A transfer is already a live conversation, so the appointment and show steps are 100%; 'cost per lead' is the price per call.

Agent-reported, lead type not stated (context only, not used in any median)

- Agent reply, same thread: telesales 'if inbound they should convert at 15-20%'; outbound 5-10% of total leads (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ge3mjw/if_you_use_paid_marketing_can_you_share_your_stats/lu6vxjq/); outbound telesales 5–10% of total leads; face to face 25–35%.
- ACA agent, r/InsuranceAgent: 'burned through about 10–15k with maybe a 5% close rate' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okb93m/how_a_bad_a_ca_enrollment_hit_my_family_and_why_i/).
- **Vendors contradict themselves:** InsureLeads prices 30–90-day aged Medicare leads at \$8–\$20 on InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) and \$0.75–\$5 on InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>), and exclusive Medicare leads at \$20–\$40, \$35–\$75 and \$70 on three pages; each vendor counts once, as the average of its pages.
- **Cited but not found in the original (not used):** InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) cites a "LIMRA 2025 Insurance Distribution Study" (new agents close 9.2% of exclusive web leads, 1.8% of shared, 12.1% of transfers) and a "2025 NAHU survey"; neither figure appears in anything LIMRA or NABIP (NAHU's name since 2022) publishes publicly.
- LeadsBridge, Medicare Facebook leads (<https://leadsbridge.com/blog/medicare-facebook-leads/>): Meta instant forms about 20% lower cost per qualified lead than website forms (a 2023 study it cites); no rate or price.
- Agent posts with numbers on health lines were scarce: 2,428 r/InsuranceAgent and r/InsuranceProfessional records pulled on 2026-09-26 for rate threads; most figures posted were for auto / home or life.

Calling labor

- \$17 median hourly wage, telemarketers (BLS OEWS May 2025, telemarketers (<https://www.bls.gov/news.release/ocwage.t01.htm>)) ÷ 70% wages share of employer cost (BLS Employer Costs for Employee Compensation, June 2026 (<https://www.bls.gov/news.release/ecec.nr0.htm>)) = \$24 per hour.
- 80 dials per hour on a power dialer (Call Logic, power dialer (<https://www.calllogic.com/power-dialer/>): 60–100); 7 attempts per lead (Kadence, contact-rate benchmarks (Astoria Company research) (<https://www.startkadence.com/glossary/what-is-contact-rate-insurance-leads>): 6–8).
- Talk time per reached lead: 13 minutes exclusive / T65 / your Meta form, 4 minutes shared / aged (OneLife: 8–18 minutes exclusive, 2–6 shared). Bought transfers carry no dialing.
- Not included: dialer / CRM / SMS software (\$150–\$400 a month, InsureLeads), consent certificates, management.

What an enrollment is worth to the agent

Metric	Benchmark	Implication
Medicare Advantage	\$725 new · \$363 renewal (CMS CY2027 FMV, national; CA/NJ \$902, CT/PA/DC \$816)	The ceiling on what any MA lead is worth; renewals roughly double it over three years.
Part D (PDP)	\$130 new · \$65 renewal	Too small to carry a paid lead on its own.
Medicare Supplement	≈\$502 first year (22% average commission (Pinnacle; 14–27% range, Essential Care) × Plan G at 65, median of \$165 / \$190 / \$220 a month)	Carrier-set, not CMS-capped.
ACA	\$20–\$30 PMPM (per member, per month enrolled (BenaVest; Ritter example \$20))	A household of three for a year ≈ \$720–\$1,080; lapses stop it.
Chargebacks	Full within 3 months (any plan change in the first three months; pro-rated after)	A lead that enrolls and switches costs the agent the whole commission — buyers will ask how you screen.

How to price each event

Uses the lead type and rates above. Price = the middle of your cost with calling labor × 1.3, rounded up to \$5, kept inside what agents pay and at or below the agent's three-year break-even (first-year commission plus two renewal years at half). The appointment "market" is the agent's current cost per held appointment, because no appointment price is published.

Product	Your cost with labor	Agent first-year break-even	What agents pay	Your price	Your margin per event
Medicare Advantage · Lead (sold exclusive, or at this lead type's price)	\$15–\$37	\$9.48 (3-yr with renewals: \$19)	\$35–\$75	\$20 (Loses money at the high cost)	–\$17 to \$5.02
Medicare Advantage · Live transfer (a reached lead who agrees to talk now)	\$163–\$408	\$181 (3-yr with renewals: \$363)	\$58–\$109	\$110 (Loses money even at the low cost)	–\$298 to –\$53
Medicare Advantage · Held appointment	\$218–\$544	\$138 (3-yr with renewals: \$276)	\$212–\$454	\$280 (Loses money at the high cost)	–\$264 to \$62
ACA · Lead (sold exclusive, or at this lead type's price)	\$13–\$35	\$3.92 (3-yr with renewals: \$7.85)	\$30–\$48	\$10 (Loses money even at the low cost)	–\$25 to –\$2.98
ACA · Live transfer (a reached lead who agrees to talk now)	\$141–\$381	\$75 (3-yr with renewals: \$150)	\$44–\$88	\$90 (Loses money even at the low cost)	–\$291 to –\$51
ACA · Held appointment	\$188–\$508	\$57 (3-yr with renewals: \$114)	\$181–\$290	\$115 (Loses money even at the low cost)	–\$393 to –\$73

Decision read

- **Cost per MA enrollment by lead type (published rates, before labor):** aged \$48–\$312, transfers \$233–\$437, exclusive \$516–\$1,106, T65 \$527–\$1,053, your Meta form \$764–\$2,484, shared \$1,958–\$3,982. The agent earns \$725 in year one; your Meta campaign and shared cost more than that even at the low price.
- **Your own Meta campaign is a self-generated, exclusive lead — the same thing an agent running their own ads gets:** Medicare-specific sources put it at \$10–\$33 a lead (agencies quote \$15–\$40; agents running their own report \$5–\$10). What it is worth depends on conversion, and the evidence splits: the only stage-by-stage benchmarks (OneLife, all insurance lead ads) multiply to 1.3% enrollments, one agent's measured T65 campaign converted 3.4% and rising, and vendors quote 4–20%. At the measured campaign's numbers an MA enrollment costs \$165 in ads and a held conversation \$30; sold as an exclusive lead it is worth \$25 to an agent in first-year commission against the \$35–\$75 exclusive price. Pick the "measured T65 campaign" lead type above to see its pricing.
- **Aged records worked into held appointments clears the market at published rates:** \$62–\$161 per held MA appointment with calling labor, against \$212–\$454 an agent pays for one through exclusive leads; priced at \$215 the margin is \$54 to \$153. As transfers: \$46–\$121 against \$58–\$109 paid per call. Caveat: no aged-specific appointment or close rate is published; the all-lead-type figures are used, so test it.
- **Transfers are the agents' cheapest purchased route after aged data:** \$233–\$437 per enrollment at the published median 25% close. Producing them from Meta forms costs \$163–\$408 each at published rates, so a transfer business runs on inbound call ads or aged data, not on forms.

- **AEP moves price, not value:** OneLife reports 20–45% price inflation on Medicare leads during AEP; since January 2025 insurance ads on Meta cannot target by age (financial special ad category).
- **Treat every rate as a vendor claim until you measure your own:** almost all published figures come from companies selling the leads; the agents who posted numbers report lower contact on shared and aged leads and transfer close rates from 20% to 70%.

What agents say they pay (single agent reports, not rate cards)

What was bought	Price the agent reported	Who said it	How to read it
Medicare lead, mail-in reply card	\$65 per lead	agent on r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ohityd/comment/nlr7pia/)	One agent, one post. Mail-in is the oldest and slowest Medicare lead type; the person filled in and posted a card.
Medicare lead, call-in	\$23 per lead	same post (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ohityd/comment/nlr7pia/)	Same agent, who switched from mail-in to call-in for the price.
Medicare lead, online vendor	as little as \$2 per lead	same post (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ohityd/comment/nlr7pia/)	Same agent. At this price the record is aged or shared; compare with the aged-record rows above.
Appointment setter (insurance in general, product not stated)	about \$15 to \$39 per appointment set	Insurance-Forums threads, read as search-result excerpts only (the forum blocks direct reading)	Not Medicare-specific and not re-read in full. Use as a general benchmark for paying a setter, not as a Medicare appointment price.
Facebook lead for indexed universal life (not health)	\$30 two years ago, \$65 now	agent on r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1krmcht/)	A life-insurance figure, listed so it is not mistaken for an under-65 health number.

Still unourced: no agent or independent source was found for the cost of a self-generated Meta lead for under-65 marketplace coverage. One vendor blog puts a bought under-65 call at \$45 to \$85 (Elevarus (<https://elevarus.com/buy-aca-leads-cost-per-call-2026/>)); it is the vendor's own claim with no outside citation, and a call is not a form lead, so it is not used in any table. **Not the same thing:** carriers also charge agents a per-state "appointment" fee to be contracted (for example \$0 to \$32 at one Medicare Advantage carrier). That is a licensing fee, not the price of a booked appointment with a shopper.

Market and commission sources: CMS CY2027 agent & broker compensation memo (<https://www.psmbrokerage.com/hubfs/Agent%20Broker%20Compensation%20Memo%20CY2027.pdf>) · 42 CFR 422.2274 (chargebacks) (<https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-42/chapter-IV/subchapter-B/part-422/subpart-V/section-422.2274>) · KFF, Medicare Advantage in 2026 (<https://www.kff.org/medicare/medicare-advantage-in-2026-enrollment-update-and-key-trends/>) · CMS, 2026 open enrollment (<https://www.cms.gov/newsroom/press-releases/exchange-coverage-remains-near-record-high-23-1-million-enroll-2026-reflecting-continued-strength>) · BenaVest, ACA commissions (<https://www.benavest.com/aca-commissions-for-agents/>) · Ritter, ACA agent earnings (<https://ritterim.com/blog/how-much-can-agents-make-selling-under-65-insurance/>) · Pinnacle, Med Supp commissions (<https://pfsinsurance.com/blog/medicare-supplement-commissions>) · Essential Care, commission structures (<https://essentialcareagents.com/blog/medicare-broker-commission-structures-ma-pdp-med-supp/>) · MoneyGeek, Medigap cost 2026 (<https://www.moneygeek.com/insurance/health/medicare-supplement-plans-cost/>) · MedicareSupplement.com, cost by age (<https://www.medicare-supplement.com/articles/average-cost-of-medicare-supplement-by-age/>) · The Senior List, Medigap cost (<https://www.theseniorlist.com/medigap/cost/>) · PSM Brokerage, Meta special ad category (<https://www.psmbrokerage.com/blog/navigating-meta-ads-restrictions-for-insurance-agent>). Pricing is a recommendation built on these inputs, not a measured market price.

Sources, Method & Gaps

One corpus and one voice router (hi_voice.py) for the three pages; every document carries exactly one voice.

Precision reads

- Ad classifier (ads_hi.py), read on 2026-10-07 after merging the September 25 and October 6-7 Ad Library pulls: three rounds of 30 random on-topic ads, 23 then 24 then 26 of 30 with the right audience and advertiser type, rules corrected after each round; 20 random ads from the off-topic pile contained 3 that belonged on a page (an agent-recruiting ad, a carrier flex-card ad, a life-carrier recruiting ad), and those patterns were added. Expect roughly one ad in eight to sit under the wrong advertiser type; the audience call (agents vs Medicare vs under-65) is more reliable than the type.
- Second read after the October 2026 corpus expansion (30 random documents per page, drawn from the whole buyer set, hand-read on 2026-10-07): Medicare shoppers 25 of 30 were a person on or approaching Medicare or helping a relative with it (the five misses were opinion comments with no plan of their own); ACA shoppers 24 of 30 after the rule was tightened to require ownership language (a plan, a premium, an income, an application) - the first read was 21 of 30, with advice-givers and political comments let in; agents 27 of 30 (misses: one lead vendor quoted inside a forum reply, one property-and-casualty question, one unclear).
- Voice router (hi_voice.py), hand-read of 15 random documents per voice after five rounds of rules: Medicare shopper 13/15, family helper 12/15, agent 12/15, life / final-expense agent 11/15, ACA shopper 12/15 (was 10/15 before the personal-detail rule), aspirant 9/15 before the last fix (licensing advice from working agents; rule tightened, not re-sampled).
- Agent-facing ads: the full list read by hand once (67 page overrides with a reason each), then a fresh random 30: audience 30/30 agent-facing, seller type 27/30 with the three misses pinned.
- Themes: frame and object in the same sentence; broad objects that counted any mention (a spouse, a phone, a video) were moved to framed themes after reading the capture lists; themes under five documents are dropped, not padded.
- Metrics tab: the page JS and the Python model agree on 252 priced fields across six input sets (0 mismatches).

What was not pulled, and why

- Facebook agent groups: the group feeds did not load for the research account (member-only groups, throttled feed pages), so only 17 publicly indexed posts were read with their comments (20 agent documents). A warmed account that joins the groups would add the largest missing agent source.
- Insurance-Forums.com: the first page of each thread only (up to ~10 posts), from the Senior Insurance, Health Insurance Exchange, Insurance Leads, Final Expense and Health Care Reform subforums.
- No count of independent agents selling Medicare or ACA was found in a citable source; the pages do not estimate one.
- TrustPilot pages were pulled per star level, so star counts are a reading sample; several vendors have no TrustPilot page (Inboundcore, Digital Senior Benefits, Integrity, Ritter, HealthSherpa). BBB was not pulled.
- Meta Ad Library: active US ads on quoted phrases only, no spend or impressions for US commercial ads; Meta's own policy page blocked the scripted fetch, so the special-ad-category rule is cited from PSM Brokerage and Data-Axle.
- Vince's feed: none yet (no agent-facing ads seen), so every advertiser comes from the Library search.
- Quora (403), LinkedIn (not logged in) and BiggerPockets were not read.

Tool status (D0)

- 2026-09-25: Tavily 968 of 1,000 monthly credits already used, so Facebook discovery went through web search restricted to facebook.com instead; Apify: three fresh accounts (\$5 each) used for consumer Reddit (harshmaur~reddit-scraper, calibrated at ~\$0.002 per record; ~\$12.40 spent in total including one duplicate test run aborted at \$0.87); YouTube Data API: ~9,900 of 10,000 daily units; SerpAPI not used; research Chrome (CDP 18800) for Reddit agent subs, Facebook permalinks, TrustPilot and Insurance-Forums.com (relaunched once after a CDP timeout); Ad Library read headless and logged out.

Sources

- CMS CY2027 agent & broker compensation memo, June 1, 2026 (psmbrokerage.com copy)
- 42 CFR 422.2274 (eCFR) — compensation recovery / chargebacks
- KFF, Medicare Advantage in 2026: Enrollment Update
- CMS press release, 23.1 million enroll in 2026
- KFF, What we know about 2026 ACA marketplace enrollment
- Vendor and FMO benchmark pages: OneLife Marketing Solutions (2026 lead prices, Medicare benchmarks, channel benchmarks), SixtyFiveLeads, InsureLeads, AllCalls, Plura AI, Aged Lead Store, Quotely, Lead Distro AI, HyperTarget, Ritter, BenaVest, Pandora — flagged as vendor-sourced on the Metrics tab